The Essence of the Meaning of the Secret Wisdom of the Heart of All the Tathāgatas: The Sūtra of the Awareness That Gathers All the Wrathful Vajra Families, the Tantra of Accomplished Yoga, a Great Vehicle Sūtra

Sarvatathāgatacittaguhyajñānārthagarbha Krodhavajrakulatantra Piṇḍārtha Vidyāyogasiddha Nāma Mahāyānasūtra · Toh 831 · Derge Kangyur

དེ་བཞིན་གཤེགས་པ་ཐམས་ཅད་ཀྱི་ཐུགས་གསང་བའི་ཡེ་ཤེས་དབོན་གཉིས་པ་ཁོ་ནོ་རང་རྟོགས་ཀུན་འདུས་རྣོ་གཁའ་མེད་རོལ་འབར་རྩེ་གཟུང་པའི་རྒྱུད་ཅེས་བྱ་བ་ཐེག་པ་ཆེན་པོའོ་མེད་

This text is known in English as the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness, or more fully the Great Vehicle Sūtra called the Essence of the Meaning of the Secret Wisdom of the Heart of All the Tathāgatas, the Sūtra of the Awareness That Gathers All the Wrathful Vajra Families, the Tantra of Accomplished Yoga; its Sanskrit title is given as Sarvatathāgatacittaguhyajñānārthagarbha Krodhavajrakulatantra Piṇḍārtha Vidyāyogasiddha, and in Tibetan it begins De zhin shek pa tam ché kyi tuk sang wé yeshé dön gyi nyingpo, the Wrathful Vajra Family All-Gathering Awareness Sūtra. Although it calls itself a sūtra, it is a tantra of the Ancient tradition, set in a visionary assembly where the Blessed One, glorious Samantabhadra in the form of a wrathful heruka and lord of the supreme secret, teaches the secret meaning of the wrathful vajra families. Across its thirty-three chapters it sets out the view, practice and ritual of this secret path, and its closing chapters describe in detail the vajra empowerment, with its royal emblems, mantras and conditions for a worthy disciple, before ending in the assembly's song of praise to the tantra as a mirror of all phenomena. It is Toh 831 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the section of Ancient (Nyingma) Tantras, among the scriptures the Nyingma tradition associates with its higher classes of inner tantra.

In the language of India: sarvatathāgatacittaguhyajñānaarthagarbhe krodhavajrakulatantra piṇḍārtha vidyāyogasiddha nāma mahāyānasūtra

In the language of Tibet: The Great Vehicle Sūtra called the Essence of the Meaning of the Secret Wisdom of the Heart of All the Tathāgatas, the Sūtra of the Awareness That Gathers All the Wrathful Vajra Families, the Tantra of Accomplished Yoga.

Homage to the Blessed One, the glorious Liberator, the King of Compassion.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One of all the tathāgatas, glorious Samantabhadra, Vajra Saṅa Heruka, lord of the supreme secret, sovereign of blessing, the array of the inexhaustible treasury, who moves with sublime conduct for the great purpose, was dwelling in the place where this very marvelous meaning is taught. That place is the secret of secrets, the palace of the dharmadhātu (the expanse of phenomena) that is the ground of all, the expanse where the drops of light are spread out. It is the celestial mansion of primordial vastness, marvelously renowned, unbounded in its extent in every direction. There, from the sky of dharmatā, clouds of miracles gather everywhere and the rain of awakening pours down; the torment of the afflictions is cooled, and the shoots of wisdom spring forth. It is without edge or center, its pinnacles everywhere equal in extent, adorned with the king of jewels, and beautiful with strands of pearls, hanging tassels, and pendants. It is lit by the great sun, inlaid by the great moon, and studded with the stars and the brightest stars, in a sky made radiant all around by the light of vajra jewels.

There a mass of black wind spreads evenly, unbounded in its extent; a mass of blood surges in billowing waves, unbounded in its extent in every direction; there are places of outcastes and raised mounds; and upon a ground covered evenly in every direction with heaps of bones stands a blazing celestial palace, radiating light everywhere. Its walls are of stacked skulls, with nails of meteoric iron driven in tightly. On all its rafters, suns and moons, risen and not yet risen, swing to and fro. Its great beams are great fish, crammed with small fish. Its column bases are moons, its column capitals suns, its column ornaments are garlands of serpents, and so forth. Thunderbolts of hūṃ and a rain of fire pour down. It is adorned with canopies of dharmatā, hung with pendants of wisdom, and covered with vajra ornaments and banners. In all the spaces between, sloping down with fringes of black snakes and eaves like the shadows of black clouds, it is beautiful with jewels, pearls, and flowers. The maṇḍala of saṃsāra is spread out there, adorned all around with whole corpses large and small, dried carcasses upper and lower, limbs long and short, garlands of sense organs, and vajras, and it is illuminated all around by nine gates.

In that place there were gathered the Vajra of Aversion called Vajra Regent, the Jewel of Pride called Vajra Gophur, the Lotus of Desire called Vajra Kiṃkara, the Variegated One of Jealousy called Vajra Karma, the Holder of the Signs of Warmth called Vajra Crow, the Attendant of Harmonious Engagement

called Vajra Juncture of Time, all the vajra siblings, all the vajra names, all the vajra vidyādharas, all the vajra bodies, all the vajra yogas, all the vajra speech, all the vajra actions, all the vajra minds, all the vajra mothers, all the vajra kiṃkaras, all the vajra ḍākas, all the vajra swift-goers, all the vajra sorceresses, all the vajra all-blazing women, all the vajra yakṣas, all the vajra rākṣasīs, all the women such as the vajra household women, courtesans, and servant women, and all the vajra wrathful ones such as the vajra envoys. Together with all the buddhas of the vajra family, he was dwelling majestically and without fear upon the vajra seat, together with a great retinue, namely:

The buddha called Great Miracle, Lord of Space; the buddha called Great Miracle, Bestower of Liberation; the buddha called Great Miracle, Proclaimer of Liberation; the buddha called Great Miracle, All-Accomplishing; the great yoginī called Daughter of Space, the Powerful Lady; the great yoginī called Daughter of Space, Gatherer of Joy; the great yoginī called Daughter of Space, the Tormentress; the great yoginī called Daughter of Space, Tārā; and the others, the retinue of the utterly great secret.

And further, the retinue of the great samaya, namely: the buddha called Great Samaya, Vajra Essence; the buddha called Great Samaya, Jewel Essence; the buddha called Great Samaya, Lotus Essence; the buddha called Great Samaya, Essence of the Array; the great yoginī called Great Samaya, Sovereign Lady of the Vajra; the great yoginī called Great Samaya, Sovereign Lady of the Jewel; the great yoginī called Great Samaya, Sovereign Lady of the Lotus; the great yoginī called Great Samaya, Sovereign Lady of Ornaments; and the others, the retinue of the great, utterly inviolable.

And further, the retinue of the immeasurables, namely: the buddha called Great Secret, Essence of Loving-Kindness; the buddha called Great Secret, Essence of Compassion; the buddha called Great Secret, Essence of Joy; the buddha called Great Secret, Essence of Equanimity; the great yoginī called Great Secret, Sovereign Lady of Bliss; the great yoginī called Great Secret, Sovereign Lady Who Crushes; the great yoginī called Great Secret, Sovereign Lady of Joy; the great yoginī called Great Secret, Pervading Sovereign Lady; the retinue of the utterly immeasurable.

And further, the retinue of the great play, namely: the buddha of great play called Yakṣa Heruka; the buddha of great play called Rakṣa Heruka; the buddha of great play called Bhigśa Heruka; the buddha of great play called Viśva Heruka; the yoginī of great play called Yakṣa Śorikā; the yoginī of great

play called Rakṣa Śorikā; the yoginī of great play called Bhigśa Śorikā;

and the yoginī of great play called Viśva Śorikā; the retinue of the utterly great play.

And further, the retinue of the great terrifiers, namely: the buddha of great terror called Teśa Heruka; the buddha of great terror called Keśa Heruka; the buddha of great terror called Paśa Heruka; the buddha of great terror called Viśva Heruka; the yoginī of great terror called Teśa Śorikā; the yoginī of great terror called Keśa Śorikā; the yoginī of great terror called Peśva Śorikā; the yoginī of great terror called Viśva Śorikā; and the others, the retinue of the utterly great terrifiers.

And further, the retinue of the great crushers, namely: the buddha of great crushing called Tragśa Heruka; the buddha of great crushing called Hriśa Heruka; the buddha of great crushing called Kaśa Heruka; the buddha of great crushing called Bagśa Heruka; the yoginī of great crushing called Tragśa Śorikā; the yoginī of great crushing called Triśa Śorikā; the yoginī of great crushing called Kaśa Śorikā; the yoginī of great crushing, Bagśa Śorikā; and the others, the retinue of the utterly great crushers.

And further, the retinue of the great devourers, namely: the buddha of great devouring called Ruti Heruka; the buddha of great devouring called Ragti Heruka; the buddha of great devouring called Khahi Heruka; the buddha of great devouring called Saha Heruka; the yoginī of great devouring called Ruti Śorikā; the yoginī of great devouring called Tagti Śorikā; the yoginī of great devouring called Khahi Śorikā; the yoginī of great devouring called Saha Śorikā; and the others, an exceedingly numerous retinue of yoginīs, together with inconceivable herukas, infinite, every one of them.

And further, the retinue of the secret maidens, namely: the secret maiden called Gaurī; the secret maiden called Caurī; the secret maiden called Pramohā; the secret maiden called Vetālī; the secret maiden called Pukkasī; the secret maiden called Caṇḍālī; the secret maiden called Ghasmarī; the secret maiden called Gathering of Mothers; and the others, the inconceivable retinue of the utterly secret maidens.

And further, the retinue of the maidens of joy, namely: the maiden of joy called Siṃhamukhī, the Lion-Faced; the maiden of joy called Gṛdhramukhī, the Vulture-Faced; the maiden of joy called Vyāghramukhī, the Tiger-Faced; the maiden of joy called Śṛgālamukhī, the Fox-Faced; the maiden of joy called Śvānamukhī, the Dog-Faced; the maiden of joy called Charnel-Bird-Faced; the

maiden of joy called Kākamukhī, the Crow-Faced; the maiden of joy called Darkness-Faced; and the others, the inconceivable retinue of the utterly joyful maidens.

And further, the retinue of the utterly devoted maidens, namely: the utterly devoted maiden called Horse-Faced; the utterly devoted maiden called Pig-Faced; the utterly devoted maiden called Monkey-Faced; the utterly devoted maiden, She Who Grinds to Dust; and the others, the retinue of the utterly devoted maidens.

And further, the retinue of the sons, the utterly great slayers, namely: the utterly great slayer called Glorious Tiger-Neck; the utterly great slayer called Glorious Yak-Neck; the utterly great slayer called Glorious Deer-Neck; the utterly great slayer called Glorious Leopard-Neck; the utterly great slayer called Glorious Hayagrīva, the Horse-Neck; the utterly great slayer called Glorious Wolf-Neck; the utterly great slayer called Glorious Lion-Neck; the utterly great slayer called Glorious Bear-Neck; the utterly great slayer called Glorious Boar-Neck; the utterly great slayer called Glorious She-Bear-Neck; the utterly great slayer goddess called Vajra Slayer; the utterly great slayer goddess called Vajra Charnel Ground; the utterly great slayer goddess called Vajra Mortar; the utterly great slayer goddess called Vajra Caṇḍālī; the utterly great slayer goddess called Vajra Arrow-Proud; the utterly great slayer goddess called Vajra Sound-Maker; the utterly great slayer goddess called Vajra Devourer; the utterly great slayer goddess called Vajra Guide; the utterly great slayer goddess called Vajra Remover; and the exceedingly numerous retinue of the utterly great slayer goddesses.

Together with these and others, as many as the finest atoms, he was in union. The consort Vajra Samantabhadrī, Sanga Śorikā, too, entwined herself about his body and, gazing face to face, was in union with him.

Then that Blessed One, the Lord of the Supreme Secret, knowing that all phenomena dawn within the intention of sameness, entered into absorption in the state called non-referential sameness of body. He fully entered the state called non-referential sameness of speech. He fully abided in the state called non-referential sameness of mind, and apprehended no entering, no withdrawing, and no full turning back.

Then, as that Blessed One, the Lord of the Supreme Secret, rested unmoving in the state of the expanse, the consort Vajra Samantabhadrī sang this song of emptiness and roused him:

By the power of the utter yoga of emptiness beyond existence and nonexistence,
From what is like the sky, come forth to the sacred pledge;
Ocean of wisdom, expanse of complete liberation,
Arise from the nonabiding, non-referential expanse of space!

Having roused him thus, that Blessed One, the Lord of the Supreme Secret, knowing that all phenomena dawn as the mind of awakening, brought forth his vajra body from the state of emptiness, just as the stainless moon rises in a clear sky. Then he looked upon the consort Sanga Śorikā and smiled, just as a thousand suns send forth their rays of light.

Then from those rays of light, clouds of awakening gathered thickly, and as they let fall a rain of play, there came thunder of every kind of play, lightning of every kind of play, offerings of every kind of play, songs of every kind of play, dances of every kind of play, drums of every kind of play, conches, cymbals and flutes, ornaments of every kind of play; the grace and the flirting of every kind of play, embracing and lying close, union, dissolving and delighting; feasting and tasting through every kind of play, chewing and bliss, rejoicing, savoring and entering; and he brought about entry into the great joy of every kind of play.

Then the consort Samantabhadrī, with eyes half closed in the manner of one bowing low, gazed upon the Blessed One, the Lord of the Supreme Secret, and with the hands of yogic union cast her whole body to the ground and made supplication with this song of great play:

Deity of the expanse, heart pledge, who has perfected the two great accumulations,
Body of great play, who perfects enjoyment,
Vajrasattva, glorious and fortunate one, you, my lord,
Through the play of skillful means, arise from the expanse of great bliss!

Then that Blessed One, the Lord of the Supreme Secret, understanding that he was roused by that song, rose from that state of great bliss into a great miracle, and with majestic bearing, with splendor, with the great mudrā of dance, with various expressive gestures, with stretching and bending of his legs, with shifts of his bodily posture, and with changing knits of his brow, he filled the whole of space with the rays of light of his emanations.

Then that Lord of the Supreme Secret pervaded each and every thing, all signs, forms, existence and nonexistence, and abided as their very nature.

Then Vajra Samantabhadrī was filled with wonder, and again, with the hands of the yoginī, cast her whole body to the ground and made supplication with this song of the arising of miracles:

Body that plays through the illusion of wisdom,
You who have gained mastery of great means and wisdom,
Noble lord, source from which many emanations arise,
Sugata, maker of the going in bliss, please arise!

Then that Blessed One, the Lord of the Supreme Secret, entered absorption in the samādhi called Suchness of Vajra Play, and remained without speaking at all.

Then the consort Vajra Samantabhadrī, and the great samaya Vajrasattva, and the others, the exceedingly numerous retinue, were filled with wonder, and all of them, with one voice, roused him and made supplication with this song of the suchness of vajra play:

How wonderful!
From the supreme wish-fulfilling body, which is like space,
You perform the vajra dance of all-pervading blessing;
Body swelling with the play of massed clouds of splendor,
You display the miracle of unobstructed vajra play.
How wonderful!
From the supreme wish-fulfilling speech, which is like an echo,
You utter the vajra of melodious blessing;
Speech arrayed with an inexhaustible ocean of qualities,
With a lion's roar you teach the ocean of secret mantra.
How wonderful!
From the essence of wisdom, which is like the sun,
You bestow the vajra bliss of wisdom's blessing;
Mind that is the bindu free of elaboration, nonconceptual,
You display the miracle that ascertains liberation itself.
Beings sunk in the mire of unknowing, folly and delusion,
Bound by the ocean of suffering, you free through skillful means;
Those blinded by the darkness of ignorance, you open through the meaning;
With the boat of play you carry them across the ocean of saṃsāra.
Great mind of all the tathāgatas,
Endowed with the supreme essence of the meaning of wisdom,
Tantra of the yoga of the Great Vehicle, the gathering of all vajras:

Please explain it at length to the assembled host!

Crying a la la ho, they bowed down in certainty and made supplication.

Then that Blessed One, the Lord of the Supreme Secret, knowing that they had made supplication with that song of the suchness of vajra play, looked upon the whole retinue and smiled. As he smiled, from the expanse of his utterly pure mind, he caused suns of awareness to rise, pervading boundless space, with rays of light beyond counting, beyond even beyond counting. From each one of those rays of light he sent forth a host of exceedingly many vajra herukas. And from each one of those, he spontaneously brought forth a hundred thousand buddhas, each with their own retinue and attendants. From these a rain of suns of awareness fell, and it illuminated every expanse of darkness. There arose the thunder of the Dharma of awareness, the rain of the Dharma of awareness, the many songs of the Dharma of awareness, many dances, and the many offerings of the Dharma of awareness, and in boundless space many sounds, back and forth, high and low, interwoven and calm, and the rest, rang out vividly, pervading everywhere. A rain of offerings also fell. Inconceivable marvelous bodies also appeared vividly; marvelous minds too were brilliantly clear. Inconceivable marvelous speech also resounded, crying a la la ho. And the hundred thousand buddhas too, with inconceivable melodious voices, proclaimed as one sound, "How wonderful! The marvelous meaning of the Dharma of play has come forth!" The hundred thousand members of the retinue and the many kinds of disciples were moved to joyful wonder; they trained the skill of awareness and drew forth the greatness of the meaning; struck with amazement and wonder, all of them remained close by.

Then once more that Blessed One, the Lord of the Supreme Secret, entered absorption in the samādhi called Vajra Ornament That Purifies the Retinue. Having entered that absorption, he spoke these words of vajra mantra:

hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ
The vidyādharas of the great samaya,
Gathered into the vajra assembly,
Take their seats in the rows of the vajra secret
In due order of higher and lower.
One not of the family becomes one outside the family.
This samaya of the fortunate

Shall not fall to the unfortunate.
If one transgresses it, it destroys him.

hūṃ krodha jvala samaya rakṣa jvala samaya yakṣa jvala samaya citta jvala samaya

As soon as he had spoken these words, from the great blazing mass of light of his tongue there came forth, one after another, wrathful ones in blazing garlands of light, rākṣasas in blazing garlands of light, yakṣas in turbulent garlands of light, and devourers in blazing garlands of light. By these, the rudras, māras, rākṣasīs, yakṣas, rākṣasas, Craving to Enter, Without Craving, Īśvara, Bala, monkeys, goats, ludé, bees, ravens, fire-bearers, saṃsāra, water, earth, space, fire, sound, evil intentions and the rest were destroyed and left without a place to remain, and he made it a marvel indeed.

Then those rays of light coiled in the sky, and the many members of the retinue, greatly afraid, made supplication: "How wondrous! O Blessed One, we pray you, bless us!" At this supplication, that Blessed One, the Lord of the Supreme Secret, let forth the radiance of his face, and those rays of light became the peaceful, coiling light of wisdom, beautiful and blissful. Delighting all, they purified them into fit vessels, and then those lights dissolved back into the place of light.

Then that Blessed One, the Lord of the Supreme Secret, rose decisively from the expanse of great nonabiding wisdom, and with a sound like the lion's victorious roar he taught, with this sound, the arrangement of the meaning, the secret certainty, the commentary on the tantra, the play of signs, the great scripture of vajra majesty:

a o oṃ samaya adhi guhya puti aho kula ma toṅ byiṅ ta pa dra amogha īśvar samayana guti a la la ho

Saying this, he spoke nothing at all. He did not speak in any way; he did not speak whatsoever. He did not prevent speech; it was not a stopping. In that very not speaking, he abided as the essence of extensive teaching. Abiding thus, he turned his face to the great samaya Vajrasattva and urged him with a smile.

Then the great samaya Vajrasattva, recognizing that he was being urged, rose from his own seat, touched his own emblem to the five places, placed his tongue upon the lotus, made the prostration of casting his body to the ground

in the manner of yoga, and, with the gaze of a lion, looked into the face of the Teacher:

Vajra King, Lord of the Assembly, please heed us!
King of Dharma, unmoving, you act in the manner of a victor;
Supreme victor, king, by the power of the King of Dharma,
Please teach at length to the assembled host!

With a la la ho he made supplication, and that Blessed One, the Lord of the Supreme Secret, in order to bless that vajra command of activity, entered absorption in the samādhi called Vajra Emanation, and declared:

vajra karma cakra satva raṃ

As he said this, a single wheel of crossed vajras descended into the hand of Sattvavajra, and he obtained the empowerment of the activity vajra. He became one of great play, with exceedingly exalted confidence. Having been blessed, he became wholly undistracted and greatly conscientious.

Then that Sattvavajra took that emblem of activity in his hand, and with various poses and dances, singing various songs in vajra words, he turned that wheel of crossed vajras of activity twelve times, and by turning it through two and five counts, all the realms shook: they shook, shook strongly, shook strongly everywhere; they quaked, quaked strongly, quaked strongly everywhere; they rocked, rocked strongly, rocked strongly everywhere; they churned, churned strongly, churned strongly everywhere; they roared, roared strongly, roared strongly everywhere; they resounded, resounded strongly, resounded strongly everywhere. All the realms became nothing but secret maṇḍalas, and all the beings within them became the mahāmudrā. In a manner of fierce majesty, he remained before the Teacher, in stately bearing, on a seat marked with a lion and a vajra.

Then the great majority of the assembled retinue said this to the Blessed One: "Ah, Blessed One, this Sattvavajra, so mighty, so greatly blessed, so vast, so learned, so clear and profound, has been born from the mind of the Blessed One."

When they had said this, the Blessed One declared: "Great assembled host, this Sattvavajra is the grandmother of all awakening minds, the lord of all compassion, the sovereign of all buddhas, the father of all bodhisattvas and vidyādharas, the great forefather of all yogins, the guide of all who pass into nirvāṇa, the great māra even over all māras, the treasury of all dharmas, and

has become the great source of all wisdom. And why is that? From the time of sameness without beginning or end, from beyond even the farthest limit, immeasurable and inconceivable, from boundless time, he has done what was to be done and accomplished the deed, and is manifestly and perfectly awakened. Because he is joined with and abides in the nature of all phenomena, he is born from the mind of all the victors and has become the father of all. So it is."

At these words the whole assembled retinue was filled with wonder: "This Blessed One is so wondrous! This Sugata is wondrous!" They bowed separately to the sublime Sattvavajra, made the prostration of casting the body to the ground in the manner of yoga, made offerings of marvelous flowers and many kinds of gaṇa offerings, and said:

So marvelous and wondrous are you,
Victor born from the mind of the buddhas!
How is it that you appear in this realm?
Son of the victors, who has become the father of yoga,
Since you act in such wondrous ways,
Fully turning the wheel of the word,
The sublime and supreme path of accomplishment,
Indicate it in words and make it clear!

With a la la ho they made supplication.

Then the sublime Vajra turned the vajra and, having twirled it, spoke majestically, indicating the meaning in words:

oṃ āṃḥ hūṃ a la la ho
The son of the victors speaks nothing at all;
By not speaking, he teaches at length.
This Dharma that cannot be taught
Has not been taught by the victors.
So too the Teacher, the supreme victor,
Does not wish to give it voice,
Yet intends to teach it at length.
Phenomena that are unborn
Are held, though unborn, to be the essence.
Whatever has become the meaning of the essence,
It is not good to speak it out in words.
"In elaboration itself lies deviation":

So the victors have rightly taught.
Therefore the Vajra King himself
Intends to give no pronouncement.
Whoever draws out the meanings of the intention,
Just like a reflection in a mirror,
The meaning of the intention appears to awareness.
By the meaning of the unborn essence,
Though it is not to be elaborated in words,
For yogins of signs and words,
Meticulous about words and coarse about meaning,
Of weak skill, whose minds follow after words,
In order to guide them and gladden their thoughts,
The miracle of the referential from the nonreferential,
Indicated by words, is this:
The mind of all sugatas and victors,
That very secret, the meaning of the essence,
Sameness, awakening, the Great Vehicle,
Clearly set out and declared with certainty.
Listen, vast assembled hosts!
I am the essence of all the victors
Who abide in the three times.
For this meaning hidden in emptiness,
With the key of words illustrated by examples,
I open the door to the awareness of sameness,
Draw out the hidden meaning and make it clear.
Like a lamp shining amid rice husks,
Cleared away and lifted, its light is found and stays vivid.
Because they delight in profound conduct,
For whoever is familiar with the meaning,
The nature of the conduct of secret mantra
Is set out by ten matching examples,
And the yogin should understand it:
Illusion, mirage and dream,
Reflection, the city of the gandharvas,
Echo, the moon in water, optical illusion,
Bubble, and the false appearance of a firebrand.
Practice, and the conduct of secret mantra,

Accomplishment, and the abodes,
The sound of recitation, and mudrā: consider these;
Samādhi, view and miracle: examine these.

Just as with the character of an illusion,
From the efforts of people
And the application of medicines and mantras,
Whatever appears that captivates the senses,
How could there be any coming or going in it?
So too the character of practice:
From the application of syllables and substances,
Though it appears accomplished, it has no intrinsic nature.
Just as with the character of a mirage,
In the months of the farming season,
From the conjunction of warmth and sunlight,
In the nature of tormented, childish beings,
Whatever perception of water arises,
How could it ever bring their being satisfaction?
So too the distinctions of the names of secret mantra:
Upon emptiness, whose nature is not apprehended,
Conventions of signs are imputed as names;
Since that itself is empty, names are not apprehended.
For example, the nature of a dream:
When a person falls under the power of sleep,
For a moment, an instant, a little while,
Or likewise for a year and more,
One experiences pleasure and pain alike,
Yet on waking finds nothing at all.
So too the conduct of mantra:
In the nature of emptiness,
Whatever forms of conduct appear,
When examined, are free of all reference.
The character of the appearance of a reflection:
For example, from a face and a mirror,
Dependently an image of the face arises,
Yet how could the face have moved across?
So too the accomplishments of mantra:

In dependence on practice, samādhi and implements,
Though accomplishments arise in some manner,
How could there be any object granted or received?
The nature of the gandharvas' dwelling:
On the surface of the sky or the sky of the mind,
Wherever the forms of gandharvas arise,
Their city too arises there;
And having arisen, it too is impermanent.
So too the abodes of accomplishment in secret mantra:
On the surface of the dharma sky or the sky of the mind,
Wherever the yogin generates the Lord of Secrets,
The celestial palace where he dwells
Arises, yet he does not come to dwell in it.
The sign of an echo resounding:
For example, with sound as its condition on a cliff face,
An echo arises just like the sound;
Though it arises, there is no sound heard to apprehend.
So too the sound of reciting the mantra words:
Relying on signs imagined, as it were, as existent from the nonexistent,
It is empty sound,
Taught as mere utterance.
Just as with the moon in water,
The moon rises in an unobscured sky,
And its reflection appears in clear water;
Though it appears, there is no thought of grasping it.
So too the mudrā that appears as form:
Clear as a body from the sky of the mind,
The mudrā appears before the vidyādhara;
Though it appears in this way, it is free of thoughts of grasping.
Just as with a stream of rain,
Bubbles arise from the water,
And from that single form
Many kinds in many numbers arise,
Gather, and break apart again into fragments;
So too, for the yogin's practice,
Samādhi is held to be of many kinds.
The nature of delusive appearance:

From the empty thing free of elaboration,
A life force, a potent one, an agent,
A sentient being and the rest appear,
As things appear like substances to diseased eyes;
It is nothing but delusion appearing.
So too the view of mantra:
However many miracles are displayed,
In the nature without appearance,
It is nothing but various delusions appearing.
Thus does the yogin view it.
Just as with the nature of a firebrand:
Whoever holds a firebrand in hand
And whirls it, it appears as an unbroken wheel,
Yet there is no nature of a wheel in it.
So too the miracle of mantra:
From the nature of the sameness of the unequal,
The meaning arises just as it is focused on,
And various miracles flow unceasing.
Therefore all phenomena with signs
Are one within the state of signlessness;
Whatever habitual tendencies of thought arise,
Since all phenomena are one within the expanse,
All signs of thought, of its movement and elaboration,
Within the unarisen, unborn expanse itself,
Do not stir, and yet miracles arise.
Whoever sees this treasure jewel
From which various qualities abundantly arise,
All the qualities of all the buddhas
Gather in that one in a single instant.
Therefore take up this wish-fulfilling jewel
Without turning back.
Supreme treasure of the genuine ultimate,
Supreme wealth of all yogins:
Whoever realizes it gains it, the one alone;
For others without connection it is hard to obtain.
Selfless, free of duality, expanse of great bliss,
The great bliss of all the buddhas,

Primordially spontaneous and uncompounded,
Bindu, the nature of reality, primordially boundless,
All-pervading and all-spreading, it gathers into the essence:
The nonreferential awakening mind free of elaboration.
This definitive meaning, appearing as the profound,
Is like a knot in space, its depth hard to fathom.
Yogins bound to reference, of small intellect,
Whoever is of weak skill and thinks about it,
Examining it in a wavering way,
Will not realize it, even though they examine.

For example, if with the faculty of the eye
One closely examines the core of the sun,
One does not realize what one examines,
But the eye is dazzled by its rays.
Just so, by the nature of the childish,
However they examine the profound meaning,
They do not see that genuine meaning;
Dull-minded children grow weary and faint.
Phenomena that cannot be examined
Are not realized by those with conceptual thought;
For whoever does not realize that meaning,
How is it any different from falling over a cliff?
Unheard from the very beginning, it is supremely virtuous;
Being free of thought, leave it just as it is.
This dharma left unexamined
I have not taught to the childish.
Even if it were taught, they would not understand it;
It cannot be taught and is hard to understand.
Free of all expression in words,
How could it be pointed out as "this"?
Being nonexistent, the object of teaching cannot be singled out.
Train the mind in the nonreferential dharma,
And when the mirror of the mind is made clear,
If one closely examines pure space,
The nature without appearance
Becomes itself just like space.

The nature of reality is like space,
And space too has no characteristic.
Whatever name gives expression to space,
That expression itself is a thing;
Yet though one utters the name of that thing,
It does not become an obstruction to space.
Likewise, what gives expression to nonconceptuality,
That expression itself is a concept;
Yet though one utters the name of that concept,
It does not become an obstruction to nonconceptuality.
In just that way, look at the mind as well:
Mind itself is not established as something else,
And likewise phenomena are not established either.
Mind and the nature of reality are not two;
Whatever is mind itself is the nature of reality,
And the nature of reality is just the same.
To be endowed with the nonduality of phenomena and mind
Is taught to be the great unsurpassed awakening.
Mind is like space;
Free of concepts, what does it not realize?
Likewise, like the great earth,
It grows the sprout of unsurpassed awakening.
Since it appears like the nature of fire,
It burns up the firewood of delusion.
Since it is the nature of wind,
It clears away all the dust of unknowing.
Since it is the nature of water,
It cools all the torment of the afflictions.
Since it is the nature of medicine,
It draws out the chronic sores of saṃsāra.
Likewise, being the nature of nectar,
It descends as nourishment for the living.
Likewise, being the nature of a sharp blade,
It cuts through the ocean of suffering.
By appearing like the sun,
It clears the dark house and shows the light.
Being by nature like Mount Meru,

It is steadfast, unchanging and unmoving.
Being by nature like the ocean,
Its blessing on the unmoving is great.
Because mind works its miracles in this way,
Saṃsāra and nirvāṇa
Do not appear as two;
From the good and bad nature of the mind
The perception of two is set apart and shown.
From mind arises genuine wisdom;
From it likewise arise happiness and suffering.
From it arise the Dharma and the wisdom of the buddhas,
And so too does the Saṅgha.
From this arise the perfections and the accumulations,
Awakening, and the lotus.
From this arise Vajrasattva,
The stainless Jewel, and the Giver of Courage;
Likewise the Vajra Immeasurable
And the Various Victor arise from this.
From this arise the various mudrās
And all the heart essences of awareness.
From this arise attachment, aversion,
Suffering, pride and jealousy,
And delusion likewise.
From this arise all the three realms,
Men, women and those of neither sex.
From this arise desire and the torment of desire,
The afflictions, torment and attachment.
Mountains and beings likewise,
Space and the winds,
And burning fire fully arise.
From this arise earth and water,
Stone, seed and sprout.
Likewise lightning and stars,
Sun, moon and clouds arise.
Likewise all that acts and all that does not act,
Each and every thing comes to arise.
For example, from the nature of space,

Clouds, mist, fog and vapor,
The moon, the sun and the hosts of stars,
Though they appear, remain just like space.
Likewise, from the sky of the mind,
Whatever miracles of signs arise,
The yogin should see them
As remaining like the space of the nature of reality.
Such is mind itself;
In its nature, realized or not realized,
Views are seen to differ one from another.
To those with conceptual thought,
Thought appears as the very essence of delusion.
To those on the path of the close placements,
It appears entirely as a heap of particles.
To those who practice the accumulations and the close placement of compassion,
Everything is like the nature of illusion.
When one abides knowing it as sameness itself,
One abides seeing the nature of space.
In the space of wisdom's self-appearance,
It simply appears as space itself.
Beyond expression, without seeing, free of reference:
This meaning of non-seeing
Was taught by the victors of the past.
In the awakening of the essence of the sugatas
There is no intention other than this.
While one is endowed with that view,
In the samaya that is like space,
Free of the sides of keeping and not keeping,
There is nothing to keep, saying "this."
However many kinds of keeping
The victors of the three times have taught,
The sūtras on keeping are gathered into one:
The yogin who is like space
Keeps the samaya that resembles space.
And that too is bliss, when there is nothing to keep.
Others, those of the lesser vehicles,

Guard the boundaries of keeping
And adopt and reject among phenomena of fault and virtue.
Phenomena free of keeping,
Since there is nothing to keep, leave just as they are.
In the samaya of suchness,
Rest the mind just as it is;
With mind itself, which never forgets,
Bind yourself within the state of nothing to keep.
This samaya of space, with nothing to keep,
According to the nature in which it is known,
Appears separately as vows and moral discipline.
The childish bind themselves with oaths;
The Teacher is known to teach the two truths in the causal vehicle;
In the unsurpassed supreme vehicle, samaya is practiced.
Though not moving from the single meaning,
It is known separately according to those to be trained.
The supreme samaya is endowed with suchness;
Whoever is endowed with it is sublime,
And whoever transgresses it will be burned.
Therefore the great samaya
Has been taught by the hero to be like space.
For all the victors and heroes
There is nothing whatever beyond this samaya.
As for the distinctions of conduct:
In the nature of reality, free of all doing and seeking,
There is no reference to what is accomplished or to accomplishing.
Beings who strive to cut off delusion
Go wrong by bringing a mind of suffering and striving
Into nonreferential awakening, great bliss.
In the nature of reality, where there is nothing to do,
To practice afflicted effort where there is no doing is delusion.
While the self-arisen, the spontaneously present, abides,
What need is there to seek through childish conduct?
Whoever desires it, what is it they would accomplish?
Whatever one practices, accomplishes or seeks,
It is suffering itself, and there is no awakening.
For hell, the great buddha,

Suffering is the very path of awakening.
The two grounds of the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas,
And whatever distinctions of vehicles have been taught,
All that involves doing and striving is delusion.

And is a great obstacle to unsurpassed awakening.
The meaning of great bliss, which is not to be sought:
If it is not seen through this expanse of mind,
Whatever accomplishment and striving one may practice,
The childish wander in futility, to no purpose.
In an intrinsic nature that cannot be sought,
What is there to do by a conduct of striving?
In the nature of reality, which is without grasping,
There is no mistaken striving that clings to words.
In the nature of reality, which cannot be traversed,
The maṇḍala of traversing is free even of a name.
In the nature of reality, which cannot be conceived,
There is no object for the thinking of conceptual mind.
In the nature of reality, which is free of seeking,
The unsought is spontaneously present from the very beginning.
Having no edge and no center, its expanse is great.
Having no outside and no inside, it is primordially clear and all-pervading.
Without faults or virtues, it is spontaneously complete.
Since there is nothing to accomplish, it is free of a seeking mind.
Since there is nothing to grasp, it is free of any object of reference.
Since it knows all, its blessing is great.
From the very beginning it abides in the heart of awakening.
Such is the distinction of conduct.
Therefore, although there is nothing but the one,
In the nature of striving that conforms to conduct,
Conceptual conducts appear as separate.
All delusion is conduct within saṃsāra;
Unfailing cause and effect is conduct in the true meaning;
The nonreferential is conduct in space.
Though one may practice all these conducts in this way,
The ultimate meaning is itself the supreme conduct.
For all who have become sublime,

There is no sublime conduct other than that.
Thus has the supreme being declared.
Know it, free of doubt!

Unfabricated awakening is suchness.
In the nature of reality, which cannot be meditated upon,
Meditation has no object of reference,
And it cannot even be designated "samādhi."
Even if one meditates, it is not found;
Likewise, if one does not meditate, it is not lost.
However various the objects of meditation that appear,
Once they are meditated upon, one does not abide in its state.
Therefore they are the domain of the childish.
For example, children, by their very nature,
Make various shapes out of earth and the like,
Make them beautiful, and look at them for an instant.
Even as they are seen, they are not established;
In a single instant they fall apart
And appear as the dust of earth and the like.
Likewise childish yogins
Meditate on various things such as forms.
In the instants of the mind's particulars,
Various movements of mentation arise.
Even as they arise, they are not established.
When, in mindfulness of the instant of mind,
The objects of mentation are cut off,
One abandons the extreme of cutting off the awareness of what arises,
And focuses on phenomena as being like space,
Inexpressible and uninterrupted.
Unerring with regard to that meaning,
Unforgetting samādhi is the supreme meditation.
Why? Because the very realm of phenomena (dharmadhātu)
Is unconditioned, like space.
Since it cannot be conceived, it is like space.
Since it cannot be expressed, it is free of form.
In the all-ground, which is space throughout,
Mentation is like the sun rising in the sky.

Consciousness is covered by the clouds of affliction,
And, stirred everywhere by the wind of formations,
It brightens and arises, enters, clears and ceases.
Through consciousness's conceptions of signs,
The space of the all-ground is not allowed to be seen.
To see the all-ground is itself the dharmakāya.
Not forgetting the sky that is this meaning
Is the great samādhi, uninterrupted.
Whoever holds this meaning in mind,
However the things of form may appear,
That one's mind has passed into nirvāṇa from the very beginning.
All the buddhas of great bliss
Have no intention whatsoever other than this.
While this space, which is without appearance,
Abides as the great samādhi,
What would one seek apart from it?
Even if the Victors sought it, they would never find it.
Whoever seeks somewhere other than this
Is worn out in the very seeking.
The other, or lesser, doors
Err by bringing a grasping samādhi
Into the nature of reality, which is without samādhi.
Whatever is practiced in them
Is like threading a most fine thread
Through the eye of a needle into space.
What the childish do,
The mighty ought not to do.
The space in which the mighty move
Will not fit within the space of a needle's eye.
Therefore this is not taught to others;
If it were taught, the childish would be undone.
The space-like reality of the nature of reality
Is made clearly manifest by the sun of a thousand rays.
The mere garlands of the light rays of blessing,
Appearing like an illusion, are taken as signs.
The unmoving, signless reality of intrinsic nature,
By those who have not seen it with unborn mind,

Appears as a game that deceives children.

The mind itself, which is the great accomplishment,
Is the jewel from which whatever one wishes arises.
However one focuses on it, it is transformed accordingly,
And all the great aims of accomplishment are fulfilled.
If mind sees the way of mind,
What is called accomplishment comes from that.
Who bestows it, and who receives it?
Neither what is bestowed nor a bestower is found.
For example, water, a mirror,
The sky, a sword, crystal and the like,
Whose nature is to make things clear,
Are clear to look at when undisturbed, and so on;
That is the nature of water and the rest,
And there is nothing very wondrous in it.
In the clear water and the sky of the mind,
If it is not muddied by the clouds of affliction,
The accomplishments spread out like the sun, the moon and the hosts of stars,
And unobscured, blessings dawn naturally.
That all-ground, the essence of space,
Is piled deep with the clouds of affliction.
To want, without scattering them with the wind of wisdom,
To clear away the obscurations and make the nature of reality clear
Through the antics of a jester
Is like children wet with water
Who, when the sun is thoroughly obscured
By the shadow of the clouds,
Blow with the breath of their mouths
At the heaped mass of great clouds,
Wanting to clear the clouds and make the sunlight bright.
Therefore the lord of yogins
Should examine the meaning of the mind itself
And come to know the root, the all-ground.
When one looks at that mind itself, it is clear.
Whatever possesses a root,
Though times and seasons and years go by,

Produces branches, leaves and fruit;
The seed of the root does not become nothing.
Just so, when yogins of application,
With childish minds, wish to take
Accomplishments marked by strenuous effort,
They too are gratified by signs.
For example, the nature of fire,
Which burns the earth and the forests,
From the truth of the coming together of causes,
Appears as the truth of existence arising from nonexistence.
Likewise, the yoga of signs, too,
Wishing to attain the miracles of signs,
From the coming together of the causes of signs
Appears as signs that gratify signs.
For the Victors, who shine exceedingly like stars,
And greatly practice the conduct of awakening,
By focusing intently on the ultimate meaning,
The accomplishment of the supreme secret awareness is swift.
Understanding the great and profound meaning
Through a nature that does not conceive of signs,
One should settle it by the definitive meaning
And have confidence in the meaning of equality.
Just as "space" is spoken of as a mere word,
And by its very nature is free
Of the conventions of expression and of what expresses it;
Just as a shimmering mirage
Is nonexistent even as it appears;
So the nature of all phenomena is clear,
And even in its clarity it is not apprehended.
The great skillful means, the deep path of wisdom,
Free of elaboration, has passed beyond the narrow defile of signs.

Since its reach is exceedingly vast, it is free of two paths.
The path of equality, where neither center nor extreme is apprehended:
Having entered it, as one, into equality,
Free of objects and of a seeking mind,
And having abandoned both extremes of adopting and rejecting,

One abides in the manner of not abiding.
Because all is of one taste in the expanse of the nature of reality,
Knowing and the knowable are not two.
If knowing itself has known phenomena from the very beginning,
What need is there to seek the nature of reality elsewhere?
For example, just as illusory pleasure and pain,
Once cleared away, are neither of them apprehended,
So the changing pleasure and pain of saṃsāra
Are equal, equal in the meaning of their intrinsic nature.
Just as, when all times
Have been realized as equality,
If one does not follow after the words of discussion,
How could the times that have become equal be apprehended?
Just as space, being naturally without form,
Cannot be caught as an object of reference,
So mind cannot fathom the unborn meaning.
Having understood the dividing of faults and virtues into two,
And having abandoned the meaning of two,
If one rests in the meaning of natural equality,
"Meditation" is nothing but a name that is spoken.
Because a dualistic view has never arisen,
Whatever perceptions of duality may occur,
Phenomena, self-arisen, peaceful and unobstructed,
Are clear in the meaning of the primordially unfabricated.
The unborn, utterly pure mind of awakening (bodhicitta)
Is equal to the mind of non-abiding wisdom.
Through the distinction between awareness and unawareness,
Saṃsāra and nirvāṇa appear in dependent relation.
Because there is no conceptual thought, there is nothing to pacify.
It is not grasping, and it is not "free of elaboration."
Except for teaching the provisional meaning,
In truth it cannot be expressed in words.
In a nature that appears yet does not exist,
No mind arises that thinks a knowing intellect exists.
In this meaning of equality and emptiness,
One does not superimpose an emptiness that has a meaning.
For one who possesses the knowing, free of conceptions of signs,

Of the unfabricated, peaceful intrinsic nature,
If one does not apprehend even the mere "it does not exist,"
How could one grasp at the awareness of what arises?
Since everything is non-abiding awakening,
Although it is not accomplished by seeking,
Just as one is free of delusion once an illusion has cleared,
One abides in the heart of wisdom free of elaboration.

To conceive of it as saṃsāra is poison.
If one does not know the suffering of saṃsāra,
How could happiness come from drinking poison?
Well compounded, poison itself becomes medicine.
The actions of saṃsāra appear in just that way.
Like the stabbing pain of poison, deluded appearance hard to bear,
The suffering of saṃsāra, born of ignorance, appears.
When, through the unending magical illusion of a dream,
One is utterly worn out and tormented,
It is like being seized by Māra, the Lord of Death,
And no other protector or holy one can help.
Like an elixir that dispels the māras,
One should realize the perfect, supreme path.
Just as, when one is purged of poison, sickness and madness,
Unable to bear it for even an instant,
One strives with medicines and physicians,
Yet once cured, these are no longer apprehended,
So in delusion, where saṃsāra is not apprehended,
Like striving to cure a sickness in a dream,
Though one strives at accomplishment and samādhi,
To realize saṃsāra as empty is itself awakening.
Just as the cause and effect of an illusion do not fail,
So it appears to the foolish and the deluded.
For those who have the skill of the awareness of equality,
Saṃsāra is a mere word for delusion;
The unerring path of awareness is clear in their minds,
And they have no conceited thought of attaining it by effort.
If one is not equal with the meaning of the mind itself,
Equality in words does not fathom the meaning.

Although deluded saṃsāra has never moved from equality,
Wrong conceptions appear, merely in the manner of an illusion.
Having known the mind itself as primordially awakened,
Diligently applying oneself to the meaning of awareness,
And gathering the power of self-arisen qualities,
How could one be bound up with delusion?
When the intention that possesses the mind of awakening is complete,
There is the body of equality, possessing supreme wisdom;
The empowerment of the master, possessing supreme samādhi;
And, through bodily conduct possessing the supreme accumulation of virtue,
The form body, possessing supreme merit.
One does not look on it as accomplished by way of ripening,
Nor does one obtain it by seeking:
The very time of the cause is the supreme result.
The samādhi of the examining mind itself
Engages the meaning at the very time of being a sentient being.
One does not travel across the spontaneously present ground;
Knowing the ground of saṃsāra, one abides in bliss.
Even the suffering of saṃsāra, in which one does not abide,
Is bound up with awakening, the path through saṃsāra.
The way in which the characteristics of illusion are not blocked
Is self-arisen, free of conception, equal as one.
Firmly in the meaning of equality,
The nature of reality is clear even within the nature of reality.
Although one speaks the words "equal through equality,"
That does not accord with the meaning of equality.
That awakening, too, is not apprehended.
Whatever one speaks of as "non-abiding,"
While grasping at a place to abide and a place of reference:
That is what is called apprehended and apprehender.
If there were no illusion-like mind of awakening,
Then the teaching that the empty, free of things and without objects,
Does not abide intrinsically in space,
Would not exist.

Making the body the chief thing in meditative concentration,
And the places, and all the mudrās of the body,

Arise from fixated clinging to signs.
In the signless mind there is no seeking of things to do.
If the body has become like a mirage,
There is no reference to places or to mudrās.
They are taught for the sake of action and conduct,
Yet there is nothing to do, nor even a reference to doing.
Since suchness is unborn and without a basis,
There is no adjusting the body for a pleasant place.
To practice the path of contrivance out of attachment
Is itself the conceptuality of apprehended and apprehender.
The bodily solitude of meditative concentration is not solitude;
Solitude of mind in space is the supreme solitude.
The mind itself is the place of solitude;
This is the supreme place for the conduct of yoga.
A roofed hut or a mountain cave is not the celestial palace;
The mind itself, boundless, is the supreme celestial palace.
This is the marvelous palace of jewels.
Without outside or inside, it is inside throughout.
Those gathered together in a gathering are not the assembly;
The gathering of wisdom in the mind is the supreme assembly.
Since all phenomena are gathered there, nothing is left out:
It is the assembly that delights countless Victors.
Conventional riches are not the requisites;
The mind itself is the riches, endowed with the substances.
If one knows this supreme and special substance,
There is no doubt that practice will here be accomplished.
To perform meditation is not meditation;
There is nothing to think of as an object of reference.
Meditating thus on the secret of mind,
To meditate on mind in truth is the supreme samādhi.
"Guard," it is said, yet nothing to be guarded is apprehended.
That mind itself, which is hidden in emptiness:
If, having passed beyond signs, one knows the words,
That is the sublime secret to be guarded.

To say "equal" in words is not to apprehend equality.
Beyond the self-purified equality of the mind itself,

There is no further meaning of equality.
To know this meaning as equal is the meaning of equality.
The conduct of ascetic discipline is not the conduct;
The playful conduct of mind settling into mind,
Of great and vast skillful means, is the supreme conduct.
Since, as the source of the meaning of awakening,
It abides primordially in the source of mind,
No name of signs, of petitioning or attaining, is apprehended,
And the great accomplishment is uninterrupted.
When mind thus sees mind,
Wisdom sees the nature of reality.
At all times there is no arising or ceasing.
One comes to see a meaning never seen before,
And yet one sees no thing at all.
All is without intrinsic nature,
Merely flickering in the intellect.
When one sees a meaning such as this,
There is nothing whatever seen as a sign.
Knowing its way to be a mere illusion,
The meaning equal to space appears.
Some have doubts about that meaning:
"If nothing at all is seen,
Why is it designated 'appearing'?
That contradicts the meaning of nonexistence."
To them: since that very meaning, which is not seen,
Appears before mentation,
For that reason it should be called "appearing."
Therefore, so long as delusion is not exhausted,
That space which is not seen,
Though it appears to mentation,
Does not appear as form.
If the mind itself is not truly seen,
The signless meaning clear to mentation
And the deluded movement of signs, these two,
Move intermingled and do not come apart.
If that very thing comes to be truly seen,
Then, in the very next instant,

The movement of mentation is cut off,
One is free of the former deluded phenomena of signs,
And by that the truth is seen.

Therefore, great gathered assembly,
The mind is itself the perfect path.
Like the trackless path of a bird in the sky,
The Guide has called it the path without deviation.
That path explained in this way,
So that everyone may realize it,
Is taught by indicating it in words,
Yet it is nonreferential and beyond the domain of words.
Since that is its nature,
Moving from the ground of the intrinsic nature into signs,
And because names are applied to what has no name,
Doubts arise as to what is and what is not.
From that it becomes a basis for dispute,
And to dispel this, through the many categories
Of the collections of words of signs,
Countless doors have been taught.
Through these the definitive meaning is traced,
And the meaning is sought by the lamp of words
Brought forth from the expanse of the enlightened mind.
If one asks what the path itself is like:
If one follows after arising thoughts,
One circles in the abode of saṃsāra.
Whatever blocks the movement of arising thoughts
Becomes mere cessation.
To be dull, without any arising thoughts,
Is to become the dark path of the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas).
If one holds to a single "this" as mind,
It is a mountain of conceptions of signs.
If one cuts it off, saying, "There is no before and after,"
That is "nonexistence," the extreme view of annihilation.
Whatever arising and ceasing occurs,
Moving even for an instant from the meaning of the ground,
Increases the path of enumerations;

How could it be the nature of reality of the path?
For example, wherever they go, children
Seek to be pure by getting rid of their shadow;
But since it arises from themselves by its very nature,
If they search, they do not find themselves shadowless.
While the meaning itself abides from the very beginning,
To seek that meaning to the point of exhaustion
With the mind's various sufferings
Is pointless, the work of Māra.
To express the meaning in words
Is like arguing about space.
Though medicine and treatment are explained in words,
That does not help the crowd of the sick.
If one does not know the mind itself in truth,
Though one expresses the meaning in words, one does not realize the meaning.
To abandon saṃsāra and seek nirvāṇa
Is like discarding the body and looking for its shadow.
If one asks what the path itself is like:
Ignorance and wisdom are not different;
Non-realization and realization are one as the path.
Since this mind appears as manifold,
The manifold is one as mind.
For example, from what is one as gold,
Shapes and forms that differ
Are known by children under separate names;
Though so known, they are one in the essence of gold.
Likewise, in the nature of mind,
Through the distinction of deluded and undeluded,
Though everything appears there however one looks,
Even as it appears, nothing other than mind is apprehended.
A jewel blazing like a lamp,
Even if it is hidden in a foul pit,
Since its very qualities shine by themselves,
Its light becomes clear in the sky.
Likewise, the mind itself, the jewel lamp,
Though body and speech have sunk into saṃsāra,

Since it is self-arisen and self-pacified and shines brilliantly,
Wisdom is clear in the sky of the nature of reality.
The mind itself is just like space:
All-pervading, empty and clear, from it the manifold arises.
All awareness of what arises, all movement and stopping,
Arise by their nature and subside of themselves.
In brief, since it changes just as one examines and thinks,
Everything appears as an entity.
In the unfabricated, which is itself without movement,
The manifold movements and arisings are not faults,
And the miraculous display is unceasing and without fear.
It is simply resting the mind, undistracted,
In the nature of space, just as it is.
That is the great purpose of the supreme being.
That mind is the essence
From which the buddhas of all three times arise.

When, for a long time, one has come
To know and be familiar with such a meaning,
The experiential warmth of seeing the definitive meaning,
The great signs of meeting the meaning,
Dawn as eight, according to the scripture of the pith instructions,
And one will certainly experience three meanings.
These are taught as the signs of the great warmth
Of having arrived at the point.
The warmth that arises incidentally from that:
The mind of awakening, of compassion
For the phenomena of saṃsāra, will arise.
A perception of distrust arises
Toward phenomena conceived as signs.
A perception of wonder and inquiry arises:
"Phenomena being like this,
How amazing it is to be deluded like this!"
Such a perception will arise as this:
"Beings who do not know this meaning,
Through great means of difficult striving and accomplishment,
Seek the true meaning on so long a path;

Though there will be a result of what they accumulate,
They will never be able to see that meaning."
The experiential warmth of knowing in this way:
For any person who has the good fortune,
Without the progression of the tantra being explained in words,
Hundreds of thousands of teachings arise from mind,
And everything is clear at the doors of speech.
One is able to bring forth, indicating them in words,
Reasons that are certain about the meaning.
That is inseparable and nondual
With the dharmakāya, equality.
It is not comparable
To the supports, the images of body, speech and mind.
It is not comparable
To the two faults, a quiescent body and final cessation.
The Victor has said it is not comparable either
To the heroic beings training on the grounds.
Vidyādharas and sages who examine the meaning
Are alike in body, but in mind are not at all alike.
Therefore, since the great pure path
Is this secret of mind,
Fortunate great gathered assembly,
Apart from knowing this path
There is no reason to seek anything.
By knowing this very path,
Without any difficult striving and accomplishment,
All, all things will be accomplished.

Therefore, great gathered assembly, this mind is called "the path." It is called "saṃsāra." It is called "sentient being." It is called "a boat."

It is called "the journey." It is called "awakening." It is called "mind." It is called "wisdom." It is called "samādhi." It is called "the abode." It is called "the excellent." It is called "the supreme." It is called "the foremost." It is called "the unsurpassed." It is called "the profound." It is called "the secret." It is called "the hard to fathom." It is called "the Dharma." It is called "bodhisattva." It is called "buddha."

Why is that? Because it enters, it is the path. Because it is deluded, it is saṃsāra. Because it does not know, it is a sentient being. Because it carries across, it is a boat. Because it moves on, it is the journey. Because it is blissful, it is awakening. Because its mindfulness is certain, it is mind. Because it is skilled, it is wisdom. Because it is clear, it is samādhi. Because it has arrived, it is the abode. Because it is without equal, it is the excellent. Because it is wondrous, it is the supreme. Because it is noble, it is the foremost. Because nothing has power over it, it is the unsurpassed. Because it is deep, it is the profound. Because it is concealed, it is the secret. Because it is subtle, it is the hard to fathom. Because everything arises from it, it is the Dharma. Because it treads the grounds, it is a bodhisattva. Because it has reached the end, it is a buddha.

Great being, for that reason this path of yoga should be known. This path is the ground of all phenomena. It is the mother of all the buddhas. Why is that? Because all phenomena arise from it, it is the ground. The buddhas who have reached the end have gone by this path. The Teachers of the present, too, go by this path. Therefore this path should be known.

That being so, for that reason this path is also called the father of all the tathāgatas. Likewise it is also called the mother, the son, the lord, the lineage, the life, the wealth, the servant, the body, the speech, the mind, the qualities, and the great activity. Why is that? Because of great skillful means, great wisdom, great awakening, great power, suchness, being hard to pass beyond, being inexhaustible in the nature of reality, great compassion, majesty, displaying itself in manifold ways, knowing everything, arising as anything whatever, and manifold deeds, these should be known to be so. For that reason, too, this path should be fully known.

Likewise it is also called great desire. It is called great livelihood, great enjoyment, great requisites, cause, condition, result, conduct, miracle, mudrā, approach, close approach, accomplishment, great accomplishment, great assembly, and total perfection. Why is that? It should be fully known as such because of manifold desires for objects, living by means of reference, acting in a disorderly way, accomplishing what is needed, producing results, being totally inverted, accomplishing aims, accumulating to the point of ripening, becoming the intrinsic nature, doing what is to be done, arising in manifold ways, being shown as signs, bowing down, acting thoroughly, acting on desire, desiring still more, being totally rich, and being spontaneously present.

Furthermore, everything is present in this great gathered assembly: all phenomena should be known to be included in three kinds of yoga. What are the three? The yoga of the cause, the yoga of the condition, and the yoga of the result: these three, too, should be known to be this very thing and to arise from it. How so? As for the cause, those who wish to know and master the one delusion should also know this very path. Likewise, those who wish to know and master the two signs, the three conceptions, the four inversions, the five afflictions, the five aggregates, the five faculties, the six causes, the twelve conditions, the twelve births, the eighteen natures, the eleven conducts, the four ripenings, the five paths, the six abodes, and the three extremes should also know this very path.

Why is that? Because it is the ground of the desired result. Because of not knowing that very path, it is called delusion. Because it has become dual with its objects, it is called sign. Because it conceives of the three times as things, it is called conception. Because it has turned away from certainty, deviating from the meaning, deviating from equality, deviating from the right direction, and deviating from the ground, it is called inversion. Because cause and effect are thoroughly afflicted, being shrouded by darkness, tormented by craving, weighed down as by a tree trunk, hardened by being unbreakable, and thoroughly agitated, they are called afflictions. Because they are thoroughly assembled, being causes assembled, felt as conditions, known as signs, acting in every way, and cognizing, they are called aggregates. Because they are clear at the doors and have power over objects, having power over seeing, power over hearing, power over sensing, power over tasting, and power over touching, they are called faculties. Because they produce results, having power to grasp, making soft, making attached, blowing into motion, being clear in producing, and being obtained in their time, they are called causes. Because they are related as conditions, being seed, root, sprout, shoot, branch, trunk, leaf, flower, fruit, kernel, and drying out, they are called conditions. Because signs arise, the arising of seeing, of appearance, of hearing, of echoing sound, of sensing, of odor, of tasting, of flavor, of touch, of cognition, and of phenomena, it is called birth. Because they possess the nature of signs, holding the nature of seeing, the phenomenon of appearing, the phenomenon of vividness, the phenomenon of hearing, the phenomenon of sound, the phenomenon of clarity, the phenomenon of sensing, the phenomenon of odor, the phenomenon of satisfaction, the phenomenon of tasting, the phenomenon of flavor, the phenomenon of relish, the

phenomenon of touching, the phenomenon of the tangible, the phenomenon of certainty, the phenomenon of knowing, the phenomenon of phenomena, and the nature of realization, it is called the nature of reality.

Because they act upon signs, as the conduct of altering perception, the conduct of acting under another's power, the conduct of wavering, the conduct of imputing through discourse, the conduct of departing from one's counterpart, the conduct of burning all around, the conduct of seeking to deceive, the conduct of holding on to attachment, the conduct that is wholly Māra's, perverted conduct, and conduct in dependence on duality, they are called conducts. Because they ripen as results, as complete ripening, gradual ripening, sudden ripening, and ripening through transformation, they are called ripenings. Because they are traversed, as the path of torment, the path of cessation, the path of darkness, the path of the swamp, and because of lightness, they are called paths. Because they are relied upon, as the abode of Endurance, the abode of the Mindful, the abode of the Equal, the abode of Desire, the abode of Strife, and dwelling in Tuṣita, they are called abodes. Because they hold to the extreme of happiness, the extreme of essential nature, and the extreme of a creator and Īśvara, they are called extremes.

Great gathered assembly, the yoga of the condition is as follows. Those who wish to know and master the one knowing should also know this path. Likewise, those who wish to know and master the two meanings, the three modes, the four means, the five dharmas, the six awarenesses, the twelve great deeds, the twelve great miracles, the eighteen wisdoms, the eleven distinctions of the grounds, the four bodies, the five paths, the six great results, and the one great awakening should also know this very path.

Why is that? Because it acts merely as its own condition and becomes the condition for the result. Because that very path is known without error, it is to be known as the one knowing. Because it appears as the two truths, it is called the two meanings. Because it is applied through the three characteristics, as the mode of existing in the concordant case, which is the imputed, the mode of not existing in the discordant case, which is the dependent, and inference, which is neither, they are called modes. Because it is held by the wise, as the means of entering gradually, the means of applying oneself to conditions, the means of entering directly, and because all is completed, they are called means. Because it abides in its intrinsic nature, abiding in the dharma of the cause, the dharma of the path, the dharma of realization, and the dharma of the result, they are called dharmas. Because it knows what will arise later, as

mindfulness of the cause, mindfulness of the result, mindfulness of sound, mindfulness of application, mindfulness of place, and mindfulness of direct perception, and because it is aware, they are called the six awarenesses. Because it acts for the sake of others and engages in the welfare of beings, as the mode of the essence, the mode of birth, the mode of play, the mode of great dominion, the mode of becoming free, the mode of great austerity, awakening and taming Māra and turning the wheel, the mode of taming Māra, the mode of displaying miracles, and the mode of passing into nirvāṇa, they are called great deeds. Because it emanates in manifold ways, as the miracle of samādhi, the miracle of appearance, the miracle of magical power, the miracle of universal expression, the miracle of subsequent teaching, the miracle of meditative concentration, the miracle of blessing, the miracle of birth, the miracle of strength, the miracle of qualities, and the miracle of the result, for that reason they are called miracles. Because it knows all outer and inner phenomena, as the knowing of all inner phenomena, the wisdom that knows all outer phenomena, the wisdom that knows all outer and inner phenomena, the wisdom that knows all empty phenomena, the wisdom that knows the ultimate nature of reality, the wisdom that knows all conditioned phenomena, the wisdom that knows all phenomena whose extremes are not apprehended, the wisdom that knows all phenomena of the three times, the wisdom that knows all phenomena in which adopting and rejecting are not apprehended, the wisdom that knows all phenomena of the intrinsic nature, the wisdom that knows all phenomena that are property-bearers, the wisdom that knows all phenomena that hold characteristics, the wisdom that knows all phenomena without reference, the wisdom that knows all phenomena not conceived as signs, the wisdom that knows all phenomena of essential nature, and the wisdom that knows all phenomena in which things are not apprehended. Because they are relied upon as abodes, relying on the awareness that is unstained, the awareness that does not decline, the awareness that is unobscured, the awareness that is complete, the awareness that is unmoved, the awareness of equality, the awareness of nonduality, the awareness of utter purity, the awareness that is wholly excellent, the awareness that is immediate, and the awareness of complete mastery, they are called grounds. Because it is expressed in every way and abides as essential nature, as the essential nature, the nature of reality, complete enjoyment, and emanation as a guide, they are called bodies. Because it is traversed and entered, as accumulation, application, seeing, meditation, and having gone to the exhaustion of the end, they are called paths. Because the

cause is meaningful, as being complete as one, knowing everything, being all-pervading, arising as an assembly, having power over everything, and fulfilling every need, they are called results. Because it is fully perfected, it is called the great awakening.

Great gathered assembly, the yoga of the result is as follows. Those who wish to know and master the one unerring should also know this path. Likewise, those who wish to know and master the two certainties, the three qualities, the four intentions, the five greats, the six assemblages, the twelve modes of arising, the twelve samādhis, the eighteen great wisdoms, the eleven great yogas, the four great accomplishments, the five applications, the six great siddhis, and the one Great Perfection should also know this path.

Why is that? Because the cause itself is accomplished as the result, it is settled, and so it is called the unerring. Because there is no doubt, as certainty through skillful means and certainty through wisdom, they are called certainties. Because desires arise, as all-pervasiveness, qualities vast as waves, and being beyond reckoning, they are called qualities.

Because the intention is indirect, through skillful means, there is the intention directed at sameness; because of the characteristics, the intention directed at another time; because of the antidote, the intention directed at another enumeration; and because of transformation, the intention directed at another meaning. Since they intend in these ways, they are called intentions.

Because it is especially exalted, and because it is manifest, the great self, that very thing, great in every way, and complete in every respect, it is called great.

Because it is complete in every respect, being great sameness, great wealth, great gathering, great awareness, great empowerment, and great blending, it is called an assembly.

Because they arise for the sake of others and accord with the ways of beings: moving to the abode, becoming equal, going in beauty, engaging in delight, joining in secret, destroying signs, being without activity, the sound of the lion's voice, definitive perfection, performing the emanation of great majesty, and, because of complete purity, they are called the great modes of arising.

Because it is clear and does not let go, there is the activity of mind, namely: the samādhi of the pure expanse, the samādhi of vivid, shimmering appearance, the samādhi of the inexhaustible treasury, the samādhi of

manifest realization, the samādhi of total perfection, the samādhi of the emanation of the great elements, the samādhi of the means of mastery, the samādhi of one-pointed radiance, the samādhi of the perfection of the great accumulation, the samādhi of the jewel sprout, the samādhi of the medicine that overcomes poison, and the samādhi of accomplishing activities. Because of these, they are called samādhis.

Because they are clear as the wisdom of emptiness, the wisdom of the cause, the wisdom from which all arises, the wisdom of letters, the wisdom of mudrā, the wisdom of emanation, the wisdom that does whatever is needed, the mirror-like wisdom, the space-like wisdom, the illusion-like wisdom, the jewel-like wisdom, the sun-like wisdom, the wisdom of appearance, emptiness and clarity, the wisdom of sameness, the discerning wisdom, the wisdom of diligent activity, and the wisdom of the expanse of phenomena, they are called the great wisdoms.

Because one abides in the yoga of aspiration and intention, the yoga of attending on command and of action, the yoga of distinguishing the great families, the yoga of signs, the yoga of the secret door of scripture, the yoga of continuous conduct, the yoga of marks and signs, the yoga of obtaining the great scriptural transmission, the yoga of holding awareness, the yoga of training great skill, the yoga of complete perfection, and the yoga of spontaneous presence, it is called yoga.

Because of accomplishment in sameness, accomplishment in great bliss, accomplishment in complete perfection, and the spontaneous accomplishment of everything, it is called the great accomplishment.

Through joining cause and result, joining skillful means and wisdom, joining the expanse and primordial wisdom, joining mind and phenomena, and joining action and compassion, it is called the great application.

Because the ocean of existence is accomplished as satisfied in the expanse, the ocean of saṃsāra comes to be accomplished as one's own, the great self comes to be spontaneously accomplished, whatever is visualized comes to be accomplished just so, miracles and magical feats are accomplished without obstruction, and consciousness is accomplished as expanding through the essence of the ultimate, they are called the great siddhis.

Because all categories are accomplished as complete in the awakening mind, great bliss, it is called the one Great Perfection.

Moreover, those in the gathering of the great assembly who wish to tread the eleven great distinctive grounds should also train in this path. What are they? The ground where the power of change is not yet settled, the ground of the supporting basis, the ground of crucial application, the ground of irreversible abiding, the ground of continuous training, the ground of miraculous emanation, the ground of advancing distinctively through reliance, the ground where the result is born from the focus, the ground that does not change through abiding, the ground of the nature of reality spread out, and the ground of perfection that masters all. Those who wish to tread these grounds should also train in this path.

Moreover, those in this gathering of the great assembly who wish to master the ten extremes of yogic training should also train in this path. What are they? Training to hold the basis through samaya, training to free the mindstream through hearing the tantra, training to draw forth excellence through expertise, training to gather the doors from every side, training to traverse the stages through empowerment, training to leave the pass behind through conduct, training to cut through decisively by the view, training to take it into experience through samādhi, training to accomplish the meaning through pith instructions, and training to gather all into a single sūtra.

Moreover, those in the gathering of the great assembly who wish to amass the greatness of qualities should also train in this path. What are they? The twenty greatnesses, the twenty displays, the twenty miracles, the twenty majesties, the twenty great splendors, and the jewel of the great crest.

Moreover, those in this gathering of the great assembly who wish to attain the twenty wondrous great powers should also train in this path. And what are they? Wishing to hurl the six great worlds; wishing to suck up and dry out the great masses of water; wishing to bind the eon of wind; wishing to emanate a hundred thousand disks of the sun; wishing to destroy the three great eons of burning; wishing to fill all of space with a single hair; wishing to emanate ten million buddhas from a single hair; wishing to fit ten million buddhas inside a single hair; wishing to draw all of saṃsāra into a single hair; wishing to pervade all of saṃsāra with a single hair; wishing to churn the great wheel of the eons long; wishing to churn it short; wishing to turn the great wheel of time, the Kālacakra, evenly; wishing to turn it in turmoil; wishing to turn the great wheel of karma continuously; wishing to cut off its continuity; wishing to reverse the wheel of existence; wishing to turn it in its forward order; wishing to cut off the continuity of the great wheel of suffering; and wishing to empty

the great wheel of hell from its very depths: those who wish for these should also train in this path.

Moreover, those in the gathering of the great assembly who wish to destroy the eighty-one mountains of conceptual thought in yoga should also train in this path. They are the nine conceptions of the substance, the nine conceptions of signs, the nine conceptions of marks, the nine conceptions of conditions, the nine conceptions of action, the nine conceptions of conduct, the nine conceptions of movement, the nine conceptions of clinging, and the nine manifest conceptions.

Moreover, those in the gathering of the great assembly who know the nine doors of downfall should also train in this path. And what are they? The door of falling into the class of the great māras, the door of falling into the realm of the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas), the door of falling into the realm of the rākṣasas, the door of falling into the class of the yakṣas, the door of falling into the great Rudra, the door of falling into the great obstructors, the door of falling into the class of the Great God (Śiva), the door of falling into the class of the great wild beasts, and the door of falling into the great hells.

Moreover, gathering of the great assembly: if you wish to know this path, you should know the dharmas of the Buddha. In whatever way they may be, the dharmas of the Buddha are seen as permanent; they are also seen as annihilated. They appear as arising. They exist as objects of focus. These dharmas of the Buddha are accompanied by attachment. They are accompanied by aversion. They are accompanied by delusion. They are accompanied by pride. They are accompanied by jealousy. They are accompanied by the five deeds of immediate retribution. They are accompanied by the five that are close to them. They are accompanied by the four grave ones. They are also accompanied by the eight wrong ones.

Moreover, gathering of the great assembly: they are accompanied by killing. They are accompanied by taking what is not given. They are accompanied by sexual misconduct. They are accompanied by lying. They are accompanied by slander. They are accompanied by harsh speech. They are accompanied by idle chatter. They are accompanied by covetousness. They are accompanied by ill will. They are accompanied by wrong view.

"Therefore, gathering of the great assembly, those who wish to engage in those dharmas of the Buddha should train in this path. They should know it. They should become familiar with it. Make it become the vast expanse!" So

spoke the sublime Sattvavajra.

From the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness, this is the first chapter, on the nature of yoga.

Then the multitude of the great assembly gathered in that retinue made a wondrous prostration in the manner of yoga and addressed the sublime Sattvavajra with these words: "Great being, Lion of Speech, if we may be so bold as to put questions to you, please grant us the opportunity."

When they had made this request, the Lion of Speech declared: "Gathering of the great assembly, I grant you leave to ask whatever you wish to ask, so with full confidence, put your question."

When he had declared this, the gathering of the great assembly said, "a la la ho! Great Lion of Speech, if we wish to follow the meaning of the great nature of yoga that you have explained at length, how many doors are there for entering it? What is the method? By which path is it easy? Great being, please explain its meaning at length."

When they had made this request, the Lion of Speech declared: "Friends, excellent, most excellent! Truly excellent! These matters you have asked about are wondrous: they make the doors for entering all phenomena clear and vast. Listen attentively and with respect, and I shall explain clearly."

Then, in the midst of the retinue, with the voice of a lion, he set out to explain clearly this opening of the doors of the teachings:

"These doors of the Buddha's Dharma,
Though many in number and beyond conception,
When gathered in summary, are clear as three:
The door of entering through effort,
The door of the means of accomplishment,
And the door of the result, the final culmination.

The first, again, has three:
The door of the means of the characteristics,
The door of entry of the family of the Sage,
And the secret door of the accomplished scripture.
For each one of these doors
The Guide has taught that there are three each.

The second door also has three,
Clear as the door of realizing wisdom,

The door of growing familiar with samādhi,
And the door of fulfilling aspiration.
The last, the door of the final culmination,
Is taught as the door of the three liberations.

For the path of entry, too, it is thus:
It is clearly taught as three sublime ones:
The piṭaka of the great Guide,
The door of entry of the great Sage,
And the treasury of the great sublime one: these three.

The means of entry, too, is thus:
From means arise means: three means.
When one examines by which of them,
Meaning, letters, or samādhi, one follows,
That is the sublime means of entry.

As for following the meaning:
The meaning is the mind that follows
The essence of the nature of reality.
The occasions when mind itself is joined to phenomena
Are taught by the Guide to be tenfold.

If you ask what those ten are:
The stage when aspiration arises,
The stage of applying effort,
The stage of entering the training,
The stage when perception is transformed,
The stage of entering the great application,
The stage of feeling the taste itself,
The stage of engaging objects,
The occasion of arriving at great conception itself,
The occasion when that itself becomes confidence,
And the occasion of becoming workable: these are the ten.

On the occasion of each one
Of these ten, mind and phenomena meet,
And so an awareness, an awakening mind, arises each time.

If you ask what the awakening mind is,
Its enumeration, too, is tenfold:

The moving awakening mind itself,
Likewise the aspiring awakening mind,
The rising mind of great awakening,
Likewise the applying awakening mind,
The entering mind and the virtuous mind,
The unchanging and awareness,
The abiding and the perfect.

Because it is renowned as the awakening mind,
The Victor has taught it as ten minds.
That nature of the awakening mind,
Because it is joined on ten occasions,
Appears as a reflection before the nature of reality.
How does the nature of the reflection appear?
As a star of the merest minuteness,
Likewise as an ordinary star,
And as the great stars,
And as the form of the moon on the first day,
And on the second, third, fourth, and fifth,
The eighth and the sixteenth:
It appears in reflections of these forms,
Yet it never appears as a real thing.
Like the moon in water, it cannot be grasped.
The appearing reflection of mind
And the clear sun of the nature of reality, these two,
Like the way of object and sense faculty,
Are clear as the nature of expanse and primordial wisdom.
This is the great means for traveling
The path of the application of yoga.
When one trains to become familiar with this path,
The extremes of yogic training,
The ten points, are as follows.

Just as, relying on moist ground,
From a seed that has been sown
And has ripened into fruit,
There comes the sustenance that keeps life going,
So, relying on this samaya

That has become the basis of all the nature of reality,
Through the ripening of the harvest of siddhis,
There comes the sublime sustenance of virtue.
This is the samaya of training.
As the basis that holds every training,
Becoming familiar with it is most precious.

Just as a thoroughbred steed, its limbs
Bound by fettering chains,
When released, becomes easy and free,
And goes without hindrance anywhere,
So this thoroughbred faculty of mind,
Bound by the bonds of ignorance,
Through the door of hearing liberation
Frees its whole continuum of awareness and goes unobstructed.
This is how bound beings
Are released from the continuum of ignorance.
In the training of freeing from the continuum,
Becoming familiar is most precious.

Just as, if one climbs with diligence,
Without weariness, to the peak of a high mountain,
Reaching the heights and treading the summit,
One comes to know the lands and becomes skilled in the paths,
So, if without weariness one listens and reflects
Upon the high mountain of wisdom,
One reaches the wisdom foremost of all,
And the primordial wisdom of the learned is measureless.
Becoming skilled in the meaning
Is the training of drawing forth excellence.
In these great wisdoms
Becoming familiar is most precious.

For example, just as a bee seeking a hollow
Enters everywhere and comes out again,
Then enters for certain and stays
In whatever is its own entrance hole,
So the yogin seeking the trail of the meaning
Gathers, in harmony, whatever doors of conduct there are.

Entering the doors of view, examining and gathering them,
In order to follow the trail of the meaning of the nature of reality
In the unmistaken, certain Middle Way,
This is the extreme of the training
Of gathering the doors from every side.
Becoming familiar with it is most precious.

Just as one born in a royal lineage
Is appointed ruler as lord over many,
And through the precious wheel and other jewels
Gains mastery over all,
So one born in the lineage of yoga
Is appointed ruler as lord of the Dharma,
And through the great signs, the mudrā and the rest,
Goes step by step to the head of all.
This is the pervasion of empowerment,
The extreme of training that travels with the skill
That arises stage by stage on the grounds.
Becoming familiar with it is most precious.

Just as an elephant entering water,
Without hesitation, attachment, or hindrance,
Delighting in the enjoyment of joy,
Crosses to the far shore without turning back,
So the mind of the yogin who truly practices conduct
Enters the water of the ocean of yogic discipline,
And, delighting in training great skill,
Casts it off without attachment or hindrance.
This is the extreme of training.
The sublime training of conduct:
Becoming familiar with it is most precious.

Just as the great garuḍa soaring in the sky
Cuts across the heavens with the power of its wings,
And though gorges, ravines, and rivers are endless,
All are encompassed beneath the beat of its wings,
So the yogin soaring in the sky of sameness,
Though the doors of conduct of the vehicles are endless,
Through the meaning of great sameness

Cuts through decisively with the beating wings of the view.
This is the view that cuts through
The doubts of hope and fear;
It is looking at the meaning with the mind.
Becoming familiar with these trainings is precious.

For example, a person seeking treasure in the ocean
Succeeds by enduring hardship,
All the suffering of harm
From snakes, sea monsters, stinging insects, and the rest.
So the yogin seeking bliss,
If he takes up these hard deeds,
Destroying the foes of thought, dullness, agitation, and distraction,
Finds and attains bliss.
This is the training of taking
Sublime samādhi into experience.
To grow accustomed to these deeds of mental familiarization
Is most precious.

Just as, in transmuting darkness, poison, and substances
Into light, medicine, and gold,
A person without the pith instruction of the elixir,
Though he suffers through many great and arduous labors,
Does not succeed,
While a person who has the pith instruction,
Effortlessly and with ease,
Transmutes them so they become medicine, light, and gold,
So, in accomplishing the meaning of great yoga,
Those who lack the pith instruction
On the transformation of the basis of all,
Though they practice austerities, do not succeed.
Whoever sees this secret of the mind
Possesses the pith instruction:
Whatever supreme aim they desire,
They accomplish effortlessly and with ease.
Because whoever works to accomplish aims
Succeeds by having the pith instruction,
These trainings through which aims are accomplished

Are most precious.

For example, when a wandering traveler
Sets out for the land he wishes to reach,
Though the kinds of lands are endless,
The path he travels leads to one place alone.
So, though eighty-four thousand
Inconceivable teachings of Dharma are taught,
They are words that guide and lead;
The object of their intent is one.

This is the sublime training
Of gathering all meanings into one.
Because, for certain, there is nothing but one,
One should become familiar with these.
When one has grown familiar with this training,
The qualities of practice are endless;
Through practice one becomes skilled in the path,
And one also attains the great
And wondrous qualities of mantra.
The distinction of the great secret mantra
Is that each and every thing is to be done:
It is the conduct of blessing,
Or the conduct of the means of mastery.
For example, it is like space or the ocean,
Or like a mass of fire, or a king.
These, too, are empowered
By the very distinction of their domain, great or small.
That king, too, by distinction,
Has degrees of greater and lesser
In the realms over which he holds sway.
The way of mantra in yoga appears like that.
Entering the conduct of great means
Is entering straight on, directly.
For example, when elephants enter water,
Some fine elephants plunge in and some do not;
Through the strength or weakness of their vigor and spirit,
Some cut straight across,

Some go at a slant,
And some go only a little, as best they can.
So in yoga, within the cause itself,
Though one cuts straight to the meaning of the result,
Through distinctions of high and low in the reach of skill,
Things appear according to each one's capacity.
Therefore the grounds, the stages, and the wisdoms,
The obscurations, the deviations, and the conceptions,
Conduct, samaya, and samādhi,
The times, the siddhis, and the culminations,
The distinctions of view, and the transformations,
Though all of them are nothing but one,
Their particulars of number and division
Are matched to the skill of the vessel.
All phenomena being one in the basis of all,
Through five kinds of transformation of the basis of all
They appear as the particular dharmas of the path:
The basis itself, the basis of all as cause;
Application, the basis of all as aspiration;
Appearance, the basis of all as object;
The unchanging basis of all;
And the basis of all that abides without seeking: these five.
Through transformation on these five occasions
One travels the distinctions of the grounds.
Moreover, these dharmas of the two
All proceed through complete yoga
And through the three that benefit beings:
The aim of virtue and the practitioner,
And what is called the vidyādhara, which is completion.
Therefore, through distinctions of skill,
If the lesser yogas, beginning with
The yoga of the beginner,
Abandon their own roots
And practice the manner of the great yogas,
Beginning with the yoga of completing great skill,
Wishing for the aim, it is like a frog performing the feats of a garuḍa:
The object it seeks is cut off.

Just as one whose station in wealth is low through karma,
Abandoning the livelihood that is his lot,
Sets his sights on the great wealth
Of a king, whose station through his means is high,
Yet does not gain it and is left without livelihood,
So these aims of the fortunate
Are hard for those of weak fortune to accomplish.
Because houses of various treasures
Have become the king's treasury,
So in all entry into the doors of conduct,
Through distinctions of outer and inner austerity,
The ranks of the nine kinds of jewels,
And the higher and lower work and means of each,
Though the place is only one,
The nine doors of the record office are each used separately.
Whoever becomes king
Is the lord who holds sway over them all.
When the nonabiding expanse of phenomena itself
Becomes the object of seeing,
Through distinctions in the skill of awareness,
Though the object seen is only one,
Each practices the doors of entry from every side.
In the single nature of the expanse,
Through distinctions of high and low reach of skill,
Like counting the rungs of a ladder,
In the distinctions of the grounds and vehicles
They appear in stages, high and low.
In the single basis that has become equal,
Through meanings that accord and do not accord,
Like a house with many doors,
The separate doors of the grounds and vehicles
Appear separately, not in accord.
Though one has not trained in entering and the rest
Of the doors of the separate vehicles,
Because the root of all is cut through here,
It is one, and there is no difference at all.
That is like mountain and Meru,

Or wanderer and youth:
The distinctions in what is seen, heard, and taught
Exist in that way only in meaning.
Therefore, since this mind
Is the root of all phenomena,
Illustrated by the example of space,
One should know the root of all.
The yogin who knows it in this way
Is skilled in the means of the path:
Having lost the path, sought the path, and found the path,
He finds and accomplishes the easy short path.
If you ask what the path he finds is,
It is the ground of yogic practice.
Because the ten grounds are traveled in sequence,
I shall explain the distinctions of the grounds.
The grounds where one holds one's place and practices
Are complete as a single set of ten.
On this ground where the power of change is not yet settled,
There are five yogas: contrived and mixed conduct,
Holding to the signs of a manner, devotion,
And aspiration for virtue.
With entering, turning back, and falling,
One circles about and is not settled.
This is called the ground where
The yogin of aspiration and intention abides and practices.
On this ground of the supporting basis
Are the yoga of the beginner,
Training, purification, and certainty,
Practiced with purity and impurity.
It is explained as the ground where
The beginner of attending on command and of action abides and practices.
This ground of crucial conduct
Is the ground where abides and practices
The yoga of distinguishing the great families itself:
All virtuous and nonvirtuous actions,
Through cutting, purifying, and applying,
It makes into the great power of good and ill.

On this ground of continuous training,
The heats of moving, attaining, and stability,
And likewise the great signs of moving,
Of attaining, and of stability:
These six kinds of yoga
Bring the ten points of training to culmination.
Like the waxing moon,
The wisdom of training increases;
One is not afraid of the meaning, and wonder arises.
Through that knowing in which the investigating mind engages,
One enters the solitude where the lower realms are not returned to,
Though obstacles also arise for him.
The three yogas, of the secret door of scripture,
Of continuous conduct,
And of marks and signs,
Are explained as the ground where they abide and practice.
On this ground of the treasure of merit
Is the yoga of continuous conduct itself:
The place of pure devotion and aspiration,
The ground that is the resting place of the skilled mind,
Mastering the ten extremes of training altogether.
On this ground of advancing distinctively through reliance,
There is the yoga of reaching the great breath,
Holding the great families, and great equal perfection,
True conduct, and training in great skill,
Entering objects, and joining with awareness:
These seven proceed to completion.
These ten, the causes and results of training,
Are applied in the manner of familiarization.
In rest, everything is seen.
On the irreversible ground, there is nothing to familiarize.
Though the application of these has one basis,
They are counted as individual, uncommon
Obscurations and actions,
And for each a single wisdom dawns.

Therefore, in the single extreme of training,
The Great Perfections, the irreversible and the rest,
As each is placed in sameness,
For each a single wisdom dawns,
And the last is complete through self-arising itself.
For those who have culminated, those who have attained,
And the irreversible, in sequence,
In dreams, in echoes,
And with certainty in direct perception, as befits each,
The yogin admitted to the vajra ranks
Is proclaimed "Vajra, Vajra So-and-so"
To himself, through the lands of the earth,
And through all the buddha fields,
And he teaches the excellent scripture of yoga.
On this ground where the result is born from the focus
Are three yogas: the yoga of accomplishment, great yoga,
And the yoga of definite emergence.
Born a victor from the heart of the victors,
The heir of the victors who carries on the lineage,
Complete in every distinction of the reach of skill,
It is the application of samādhi.
On this ground that does not change through abiding,
The gathering of the great accumulations, the completion of great skill,
Should be known as completing in three:
The great mudrā is illusion.
The great king who turns the wheel,
From the place of seeing, the sixteenth,
Is fulfilled in the place of perfection.
On this ground of the nature of reality spread out,
The yoga of the ornament of play,
And great bliss, and completion in the bindu:
In this completion as three,
By coming to know the joining
Of that wisdom with the meaning of objects, all is complete.
In the conduct where even illusion is not illusion,
This ground of perfection that masters all,
From the first to the last of the ten,
Is the summit of all final completion.

In the vast expanse, the essence of space,
A hundred thousand cloudless suns spread out.
Whatever appears is nothing whatsoever;
In the essence that is neither born nor ceasing,
However one looks, all things appear there;
It is cut through by the waves of the general seal of the supreme vehicle.
That, too, through distinctions of view,
Is the yoga of the great self,
Spontaneous presence, and the vast expanse realized:
Three, complete, self-arisen, spread out.
This is the path of yogic practice;
Yogins should travel it.

Moreover, yogins of the assembly,
If you wish to seek the trail of the meaning,
Do not, from hearing merely a few words,
Give rise to the notion that it is enough.
You are all yogins, it is true,
But you are not joined in yoga with the true meaning.
You transform your conduct, it is true,
But it has never become the true meaning.
You cling to acts of attachment and aversion, it is true,
But you never cling to the sublime meaning.
You enjoy vast pleasures, it is true,
But you do not taste the flavor of the meaning of the nature of reality.
You say "selfless, free of sides," it is true,
But you are never free of the five afflictions.
You crush concepts through yogic discipline, it is true,
But you never crush the concepts of subject and object.
Therefore, yogins of the assembly,
If, by the lamp of the words you have heard,
You seek the gold of the true meaning,
Then catch this monkey, the wish to realize,
Set the cat upon the thief,
Block every crack and window,
And tear down the empty house to rubble;
When you open the king's treasury,

These are buddhas forever.
If you seek the path of the true meaning,
Abandon the five faults of thought.
The mountain of coarse thought,
Signs, movement, feeling,
And sudden awareness: clear away these five faults.
Thought, moreover, is twofold:
It appears as coarse and subtle.
Likewise signs are two, large and small;
Movement is two, long and short;
Likewise feeling is clear or unclear;
And sudden awareness also appears as two:
Swift and slow.
These are the great hindrances of great thought
That obscure the meaning.
Why? Because one does not see that meaning:
Obscured as if by darkness, by overcast skies,
By dense cover, by banks of cloud,
And by mist, the true is not clear and is not seen.
These, too, are each divided in two:
Darkness and great pitch-black darkness;
Being covered over completely;
Being utterly overcast and obscured;
Great and small cover;
Great clouds massing, and haze;
Filled with mist, and drizzle.
Through these one falls into the three bad realms and the human realm,
The abodes of the gods of the four of the desire realm,
The form realm and the formless realm,
And the abodes of the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas.
The great fault that makes one fall
Is the six kinds of distraction by signs:
Distraction toward the nature of objects,
Likewise outer distraction,
Distraction by illness and by signs,
Mental engagement, and taking up negative tendencies.
These should be thoroughly cleared away.

Once they are cleared away, there is great equipoise on the meaning.
The faults that obscure the meaning of sameness
Arise in five kinds, namely:
Distraction through the force of sudden awareness,
Cover through the force of dullness and torpor,
Cessation through the force of grasping and attachment,
Conceptualizing through the force of rigid fixation,
And nonexistence through the force of vacant slackness.
These are the faults of sameness.

The teaching that mends those great faults,
This counsel for the mind, was taught by the Victor.
When a yogin of the Great Assembly
Seeks the nonconceptual meaning,
He should take to a solitary, secluded place,
And with a mind endowed with the three valid cognitions
Should track down conceptual thought:
Whether it exists or not, from where did it first arise?
On examination, thought arises from appearances.
If one fully knows thought to be illusion,
The mountain of thought will subside.
Thereby one does not fall into the three lower realms.
If one asks from what thought arises,
It arises from phenomena of signs.
If one fully knows signs to be illusion,
The phenomena of signs will subside.
Thereby one is not in the lowest level of the desire realm.
If one asks from what signs arise,
They arise from the stirrings of mindfulness.
If one comes to know mindfulness as a fault,
One clears away the faults of stirring.
By that power one is not in the second level of the desire realm.
If one asks from what stirring arises,
It arises from feelings.
They are pure, and there is nothing to be produced.
If one comes to know feeling as illusion,
One clears away faulty feeling,

And will not fall into the third level of the desire realm.
If one asks from what feeling arises,
It arises from sudden awareness, outer and inner.
It is pure, and there is nothing to be produced.
If one comes to know that very thing as a fault,
Then by the power of knowing it thus
One does not fall into the fourth level of the desire realm.
If one asks from what sudden awareness arises,
It arises from the phenomena of mind.
If one fully knows mind itself to be illusion,
The phenomena of mind will subside.
The aggregates are like reflections,
And mind itself is like a mirage,
Free from both extremes of existence and nonexistence.
The yogin who knows it thus
Will not fall into the fifth level of the desire realm.
By not viewing mind itself as an existent thing
Or as something called nonexistent,
One will not fall among the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas).
By not becoming dull and torpid,
One will not fall into the state without perception.
By not following after perceptions,
One does not circle in the abodes of sentient beings.
By growing familiar with the meaning of the universal ground,
One does not fall into the state of the śrāvakas.
By not making it empty and at peace,
One does not fall into the view of the pratyekabuddhas.
By not making it purely empty,
One does not fall into the conduct of awakening.
By not dividing the meaning of sameness and emptiness
Into separate, distinct things,
One does not fall into the sequence of the grounds,
And there is no gradual training and ascending.
The nature of the genuine meaning
Abides in nothing and takes up nothing;
It sees nothing at all, and there is no hearing;
It does nothing at all and is free of doing.

Of anything heard there is not even an atom.
That which does not appear as anything at all
Is the supreme appearance.
The nature of reality, which is inconceivable,
Being inconceivable, should be left just as it is.
In the nature of reality, which lacks intrinsic nature,
With the mind, instant by instant,
Unwavering, one should be continuously mindful.
When one rests thus in equipoise on the meaning,
The experiences of the signs arise in this way:
Warmth, signs, and miracles,
Higher perceptions and wisdom arise.
Warmth stirs and is attained;
Signs arise and become stable;
Miracles arise and are perfected;
All subtle awareness becomes clear.
Thereby all aims are fulfilled.
It is like darkness being cleared away,
Light arising, the sky,
Seeing everywhere, and everything clear.
By the power of knowing thus,
All the darkness of habitual tendencies is dispelled.
Just as the wind sweeps away the clouds,
By a samādhi of a single instant
The heaps of obscurations are swept away.
Just as when a lamp dispels the darkness,
The darkness itself becomes light,
So by knowing the meaning in an instant
The darkness amassed from before is dispelled.
The person who knows in this way
Opens the door of awareness onto the meaning,
And since he is endowed with the Dharma eye,
He composes what he sees and hears into verses of four lines.
Being one who has reached the ground, he engages in the meaning.
If one is not endowed with the Dharma eye,
Then however much one speaks of the meaning in conventional terms
With words that are endless and unbounded,

One cannot gauge what is mistaken and what is not.
One whose mind chases after words is a crude boor,
One still on the grounds and paths of training.
However many hundreds of thousands of words and meanings such a one may utter,
Do not teach them to others!
If he teaches, he is a thief of the vajra word,
And he will fall into the Vajra Hell.
Those hypocrites
Whose minds have not opened onto the meaning,
Who, led along by words and letters,
Teach the Dharma while not knowing it:
Teaching the Dharma without knowing
Is graver than taking the lives of all sentient beings.
Therefore, if one knows how to enter this meaning of sameness
All at once, in accord with it,
One is not left in the thoughts of whether the time of meditation is long or short,
Whether one has residual karma or not,
Or when one will succeed.
If one rests in equipoise on the meaning of sameness,
Awareness dawns immediately.
If one does not waver from the meaning of sameness,
One does not fall into the abodes of the form realm.
If one is not attached to sameness itself,
One will not fall into the formless realm.
Because sameness itself has become manifest,
One does not fall into the state of the śrāvakas.
When one sees the meaning of nothing whatsoever,
That is called a buddha.
Therefore the yogin
Should meditate on this special samādhi until it is familiar.
All is nonconceptual and unborn,
The expanse of space that has abandoned the extremes of thought,
Unmoving just as it is, sameness itself,
Beyond the domain of conceptions of signs.
From the objectless nature of space,

The mind of awakening of great compassion
Dawns as a disk of a thousand suns,
Pervading all the phenomena of signs.
From the heart of the blazing sun,
Rays of light shine clear as the supreme of syllables,
The syllable a, from which all arises.
From its nature, which can turn into anything at all,
All the miracles of emanation arise.
Moreover, from the distinctive features of its dynamic energy,
The domain of the breath, feeling,
Hearing, seeing, and the rest,
The domain of mind, the expanse of space,
Throughout to the limits of the expanse of phenomena,
Natural syllables, transformed syllables,
And limb syllables, each one,
With root and so forth, sharing a single ground;
The measure of their radiating and gathering,
And the number of the clusters of mudrās, are likewise.
This is the order of entry for the beginner,
By which one gradually grows acquainted and habituated.

By working from the wisdom of the syllables,
One accomplishes aims and generates mudrās:
Pressing down the ocean, a ladder to the sky,
Binding the wind, turning back rivers,
Quenching the eon of burning,
Riding the sun and moon, hurling the world,
Entering into the earth, lifting up Mount Meru,
The way of placing the trichiliocosm in a mustard seed,
Destroying and raising up, and so forth.
These things, which thought cannot encompass,
Are nothing but the training of the great power of yoga
That becomes workable through habituation.
Recitation brought to its end and accomplished,
Binding brought to full perfection,
Intention made workable,
The meaning seen and words accomplished,

Activity made fully pure:
One single meaning appears distinctly according to its object.
Therefore, although the special samādhi
Is meditated on the single expanse itself,
Through differences in the power of yoga
The objects of thought are various.
The yogins abiding on the first ground,
The yogin of the activity of undertaking,
The yoga of aspiration and intention,
And so on, the six kinds of yoga:
Because the reach of their power of wisdom is narrow,
Their power of samādhi is also small,
And they do not come to see the meaning.
When they meditate on the deity of their own inclination,
Whatever the seed of that deity may be,
They distinguish it by its color,
And make it move with the breath of the nose.
As far as the range of the breath extends,
From visualizing it clearly, twined in pairs and radiating outward,
They should generate it in the place of radiating and gathering.
The extent of the deity's body, matched to their own size,
Is likewise just that much.
The yogins abiding on the second ground,
The yogin of the activity of attending on command,
And so on, the four kinds of yoga:
The particular feature of their power of samādhi
Is the seed, the natural syllable,
Together with its blazing rays of light,
As far as the range where scent arises,
Generated clearly radiating and gathering.
The extent of the deity's body, twice their own size,
Is likewise just that much.
The yogins abiding on the third ground,
The yoga of the command of scripture,
And so on, the three kinds of yoga,
Hold their samādhi of focus to be as follows.
Whatever the seed of the deity may be,

They transform it into the natural syllable,
And with its blazing rays of light,
As far as the range of hearing,
They make it radiate and gather clearly.
The extent of the deity's body, about four times their own size,
Is likewise just that much.
Likewise, following the sequence of the yogas,
Whatever the particular deity may be,
It is done following the sequence of the syllables,
And the measure of radiating and gathering is likewise.
When they have applied these in sequence
And the radiating and gathering has become clear,
As far as the mind is capable,
The particular extent of the body as well:
Meditate that the extent of the body fills everything
To the very limits of the expanse of phenomena.
Furthermore, when the yogins of the Assembly
Gauge the meaning by following the syllables,
The syllables will reveal the meanings.
Why does the meaning itself appear as syllables?
From the expanse arises a, and from a
Arises the assembly of syllables, radiating in variety.
a is the natural syllable.
Since it is free of any support, it has no cause or condition.
Since it pervades all, it is like space.
a is the miraculous display of the nature of reality.
Since the miracle syllable a arises
From the state of the profound nature of reality,
a symbolizes the nature of reality.
From a the assembly of syllables radiates,
And the teachings in assemblies of words resound as an ocean.
Taking up every sound and utterance of the syllables,
It transforms them into the speech of various syllables.
The many limb syllables
Gather into the state of the natural a.
Since a arises from the vast expanse of the enlightened mind,
From the radiating and gathering of the rays of a,

Dawning in the secret place of the throat,
The sound of speech radiates as five syllables:
a ka kha ga gha ṅa.
Then the rays of a
Radiate to the lotus of the palate of the tongue.
From their coiling at the base of the tongue,
The rays dawn as five syllables:
ca cha ja jha ña.
Then the rays of a
Radiate to the tip of the tongue,
And from there the rays dawn as ten syllables:
ṭa ṭha ḍa ḍha ṇa ta tha da dha na.
Then the rays of a
Radiate through the door of the mouth,
And from there dawn as five miracle syllables:
ba pa ba bha ma.
Then the rays of a
Radiate to the outer domain,
And from there the various miracle syllables radiate:
ya va ra la śa ṣa sa ha kṣa i ī u ū e ai o au aṃ aḥ.
Since miraculous light radiates from a,
The garland of syllables arises as an assembly,
And in the wisdom of the limb syllables
The seeds of the bodies of the buddhas arise.
Immeasurable Victors,
Hosts of emanations of body, speech, and mind,
Appear beautiful in various mudrās.
Therefore the nature of the syllables
Is explained to be the very body of the Victors.
a is the seed of the enlightened mind.
The first five, ka and the rest,
Are the nature of the secret place of the throat.
The second five, ca and the rest,
Are the nature of the palate and the tongue.
The third, the ten beginning with ṭa,
Are the nature of the tip of the tongue.
The fourth, the five beginning with pa,

Are explained to arise from the lips.
The fifth, the syllables of the two sets of ten
Beginning with ya,
Are fully explained to radiate from the body.
From the rays of the wheels on the feet
Comes the syllable ha, which burns away obscurations.
From the rays of the secret space
Comes the syllable kṣa, from which miracles arise.
From the navel, the midpoint of the body,
Comes the syllable hva, from which desires are fulfilled.
From the śrīvatsa coiled at the heart
Comes the syllable śa, which purifies signs.
From the rays of the wheels on the hands
Comes the syllable śu, which displays miracles.
From the shoulders of the Great Being
Comes the syllable la, which destroys conceptual thought.
From the hips of the Great Being
Comes the syllable ra, which burns away attachment.
From the flanks of the Great Being
Comes the syllable va, which dispels delusion.
From the thighs of the Great Being
Comes the syllable ya, which suppresses saṃsāra.
From the two eyes of the Great Being
Dawn the two natural syllables i.
From the two ears of the Great Being
Dawn the two natural syllables u.
From the two nostrils of the Great Being
Dawn the two natural syllables e.
From the two rows of teeth of the Great Being
Dawn the two natural syllables o.
From the crown of the head of the Great Being
The seed of the Victors dawns as aṃ.
Therefore all the limb syllables
Are the body, speech, and mind of the ocean of Victors.
oṃ is the nature of the body,
And āḥ is the characteristic of the mind.
All the many garlands of syllables

Are the nature of speech, the utterance of speech.

āḥ is the nature of the dharmakāya;
aṃ is the body of perfect enjoyment (sambhogakāya);
The garlands of blazing syllables
Are explained to be the emanation body that guides beings.
a is the expanse of phenomena;
oṃ is the wisdom of awareness;
The garlands of blazing syllables
Are the nature of phenomena and of the nature of reality.
a is the cause of expression;
oṃ is the cause from which assemblies of words arise.
The assembly of words is itself the syllables;
Long strings of syllables are the treasury of words.
Because the syllables blaze and radiate rays of light,
Dharma and what is not Dharma
Open the faculty of speech
And unfold into meanings and words.
The assembly gathered from every sound and utterance
Is complete within the state of the garland of syllables.
All words and syllables, every one,
Are complete within the state of the nature of oṃ.
All the miracles of oṃ, every one,
Subside into the expanse of the nature of a.
a is the treasure of all syllables;
a itself dissolves into the expanse of phenomena.
Therefore the vajra of the body, speech, and mind
Of the Victors, the buddhas,
Through the particular powers of taming beings,
Turns into anything at all and appears as anything at all.
To beings who are to be tamed
By substances such as earth, space, fire, wind, and water,
It appears in the very essence
Of earth, space, and the rest, of water and of wind.
When some are to be tamed by the body,
It shows bodies, images, relics,
Sacred supports, and so on, each distinct,

Throughout all the worlds.
When the time comes to tame by speech,
It displays the various sounds and languages
Beginning with the sixty branches of melodious voice,
And the forms of letters,
And so appears in the realms of saṃsāra.
Why is this? Because the syllables
Are the Tathāgatas themselves,
They are the nature of the Tathāgatas;
And since they are the nature of compassion,
Through various kinds of skillful means
They bring all to liberation.
Likewise this assembly of syllables,
Through the various joinings and contractions of its limbs,
Makes everything understood as words.
The wisdom of the natural syllables:
I shall explain their individual meanings.
a is unborn wisdom;
It shows that all natures are empty.
ka is the wisdom of activity;
It shows that all are liberated by the path.
kha is the door of pervading;
It shows that all are liberated as beyond reference.
ga is the door of having become the meaning;
It shows that all are liberated as without object.
gha is the door of abiding;
It shows liberation as not fixed as one.
ṇa is the door of no grasping;
It shows that all are liberated, free of grasping.
ca is the door of no cessation;
By appearing as anything at all, all are liberated.
cha is the door of no passing beyond;
Since there is no separation, all are liberated.
ja is the door of what has not arisen;
By not abiding, all are liberated.
jha is the door free of turbidity;
By the stains being purified, all are liberated.

ña is the door free of conduct;
Since there is no activity, all are liberated.
ṭa is the door of no pride;
Since there is no mountain, all are liberated.
ṭha is the door of no artifice;
Since there is no doing, all are liberated.
ḍa is the door of no mixing;
Since there is no dispute, all are liberated.
dha is the door of no deception;
It liberates all illusions.
ṇa is the door free of objects;
Since there is no grasping, all are liberated.
ta is the door of no conventions;
Since there is no expression, all are liberated.
tha is the door free of support;
Since there is no abiding, all are liberated.
da is the door free of giving up;
Since there is no taking, all are liberated.
dha is the door of no intrinsic nature;
Since there are no characteristics, all are liberated.
na is the door free of objects;
Since there is no grasping, all are liberated.
pa is the door of renunciation;
Since there is no cessation, all are liberated.
pha is the door of no entity;
Since there is nothing at all, all are liberated.
ba is the door of no expression;
Since there is no expression, all are liberated.
bha is the door free of dust;
Since there is no conceptual thought, all are liberated.
ma is the door of no attachment;
Since there is no permanence, all are liberated.
ya is the door of no attachment;
Since there is no defilement, all are liberated.
va is the door of no cause and condition;
Since there is no result, all are liberated.
ra is the door free of conditions;

Since there is no discarding, all are liberated.
la is the door of no adopting;
Since there are no qualities, all are liberated.
ṣa is the door of no conceptual elaboration;
Through peace it liberates all.
ṣa is the door free of burden;
Since there is no heaviness, all are liberated.
sa is the door of the genuinely secret;
Through certainty it liberates all.
ha is the door free of cause;
Through being free of conditions it liberates.
a is the door free of the elements;
Since there are no characteristics, it liberates.
i is the door of no seeing;
Through being free of forms, all are liberated.
u is the door of no hearing;
Through being free of sound, all are liberated.
e is the door of no sensation;
Through being free of smell, it liberates.
o is the door of no sensation;
Through being free of touch, all are liberated.
aṃ is the door from which miracles arise;
Through appearing as anything at all, all are liberated.
Nirvāṇa and the phenomena of saṃsāra,
All phenomena that exist, are seen, appear, and resound,
Are fully awakened as the assembly of syllables.
There is nothing at all that has not become syllables.
In the sun of the essence of the nature of reality,
Rays of light blaze as assemblies of syllables.
In the nature of reality, which is like space,
Various syllables are finely arrayed,
And the maṇḍala of the Victors of the three times is complete.
From the rays of the blazing sun
Blazes a vajra, ablaze with light.
Because the light of the syllable hūṃ radiates,
It is called the seed of the vajra essence,
And is renowned as the field of the vajra family.

From the jewel of the sun's rays,
Because the syllable of light sva radiates,
It is called the seed of the jewel essence,
And is renowned as the field of the jewel family.
Because the sun lotus blazes and radiates,
It blazes as the miracle syllable aṃ,
And is renowned as the field of the lotus family.
Because the light of the variegated sun radiates,
And the miracle syllable ha is clear,
It is the seed of the variegated essence,
And is renowned as the field of the karma family.
The mind of all the Victors of the three times
Is vajra wisdom.
The immeasurable Victors
Emanated by that supreme wisdom
Are explained to be called the vajra family.
The wisdom of qualities is the jewel.
The immeasurable Victors
Emanated from that jewel
Are explained to be called the jewel family.
The wisdom of speech is the lotus.
The immeasurable Victors
Emanated from the lotus wisdom
Are renowned as the field of the lotus family.
Enlightened activity is various.
The immeasurable Victors
Emanated by the various wisdom
Are explained to be called the karma family.
The body is unfabricated suchness.
The immeasurable emanated Victors
In the wisdom of suchness
Are explained to be called the tathāgata family.

Therefore, the reasoning for the families is this:
The unfabricated body is suchness;
The unchanging family is the vajra family;
The source of all qualities is the jewel family;

Unattached speech is the lotus family;
Performing activities is the karma family.
All the emanations of the body
Hold the lineage of the tathāgata family.
The buddhas emanated from the enlightened mind
Hold the lineage of the vajra family.
The buddhas of the domain of qualities
Hold the lineage of the jewel family.
The buddhas emanated from speech
Hold the lineage of the lotus family.
The buddhas emanated as deeds
Hold the lineage of the activity family.
If one asks why they are called families:
In the beginning they arise from it,
In the middle they perform its activity,
And in the end they hold its lineage;
That is why they are known as families.
For example, all the sentient beings without exception
Who dwell in fire and water,
In space and in earth,
Bear the name of the very place they dwell in.
Sentient beings that dwell in fire
Are called fire pretīs;
Sentient beings that dwell in water
Are called the water monster tvarana.
If one asks why they are said to be five:
For all the Victors, the buddhas,
Body, speech, mind, qualities,
And deeds, that is, activity, make five.
As the five awarenesses and as fivefold,
All appear with complete clarity.
Therefore they are definitively explained to be five.
If one asks why: all the buddhas
Do not arise from anything
Apart from these five, nor exist anywhere else.
As for the particular names of the buddhas,
Names imputed to what has no name,

All are imputed from these five alone.
All the varieties of names, every one,
Are nothing but designations made by mere convention.
Families spoken of where there are no families
Appear as five by the power of taming beings,
But that is the provisional meaning; they have no actual basis.
Whatever appears out of nothing whatsoever
Is like a rainbow arising in the sky.
"All phenomena are like space":
So the Lord of the Supreme Secret has explained.
The equal and the unequal are equal.
There are no buddhas and there are no sentient beings;
There is no saṃsāra and there is no nature of reality;
There is no reference, and no absence of reference.
One who knows it thus is wise.
Awareness and ignorance are of one mode;
One who knows it thus is a Victor.
The nature of sentient beings is buddha itself;
The nature of buddhas is sentient beings;
Sentient beings and buddhas are one.
One who knows it thus is a child of the Victors.
For the sake of awakening, nothing is found;
Not finding anything, one does not find it.
If one sees the meaning of there being nothing to find,
That is the supreme finding.
Furthermore, if the yogins of the Assembly
Wish to seek the essence of the path,
They should illustrate the very signs of the path by examples,
And grow familiar with the meaning of the path.
With the lamp that has the eye of nonabiding,
They should become skilled in the cause of the path.
The signs of realization of habitual tendencies
Appear as various entities,
Yet they are like a mirage against the clear sky.
And if this is to be realized
Through examples that illustrate decisive reasoning:
Though there appear in the sky banks of cloud, rainbows,

Rain, and other continuous phenomena,
They are nothing but the single miraculous display of space;
They do not always appear that way.
For example, the nature of an illusion:
Though it appears as anything at all, deceiving and beguiling,
It is nothing but the appearance of an illusion's magic;
It does not always appear that way.
For example, the entity of a stone,
Even an entity that is solid and hard,
If it is ground down or made into powder
And scattered by the force of the wind,
Where then is its intrinsic nature?
For example, the nature of fire
Burns all the brushwood and kindling,
Blazing, radiating, shining clearly and spreading;
Yet if it is destroyed by the force of water,
Where then is its intrinsic nature?
For example, the entity of a substance:
If it is burnt by the force of fire,
Where then is its intrinsic nature?
Sentient beings, held by consciousness,
Though made beautiful by form and various recollections,
By sense faculties and the rest,
When the impermanent aggregates die and transmigrate,
Do not become stable entities.
Their forms break apart one by one,
And even their bones no longer appear;
Through breaking apart, rotting, and so on,
In the end nothing at all appears.
Great mountains and the like,
The worlds of stable and moving entities,
When destroyed by the three eons,
Such as the eon of burning,
Where then is their intrinsic nature?
Therefore all the phenomena of entities
Are not entities when examined,
And so one knows phenomena to lack intrinsic nature.

This is the supreme path of yoga.
Assemblies of the Assembly, grow familiar with it!
Thus Sattvavajra, the Lion of Speech, taught the path of supreme yoga.
This is the second chapter, on following after yoga, from the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness.

Then Sattvavajra, the Lion of Speech, entered into equipoise in the samādhi called Displaying Various Great Miracles. Through the blessing of that samādhi all the buddhafields shook, and the portents of the complete fulfillment of the meaning appeared. Among those gathered in that assembly, some came to dwell upon the sun and moon and to soar in the sky of the nature of reality. Some hurled Mount Meru far away. Some came to hurl the great trichiliocosm. Some came to see the true meaning of the nature of reality. Some came to be seated on lion thrones.

Then Sattvavajra arose from that samādhi of miracles. The yogins of the Great Assembly were utterly amazed, and making the yogic salutation with the whole body, they addressed Sattvavajra with these words: "Great being, what is the meaning of these vast miracles? What are they signs of? Please explain this to us in full."

When they had requested this, the great Lion of Speech declared: "Yogins of the Assembly, these are the great portents of the complete fulfillment of the meaning. When applied to these marks of portent, they are the portents that the members of the Great Assembly will advance greatly from ground to ground and will see the genuinely definitive meaning."

When he had said this, the host of yogins said: "Great being, what are the portents of attaining the grounds? What are the portents of seeing the meaning? Please explain them to us."

When they had requested this, Sattvavajra declared: "Excellent, host of the Great Assembly! I shall explain at length the matter you have asked about. Unstop your ears and listen with respect!

When the yogin who practices the meaning
Applies himself to the meaning in yoga,
Through the particular deeds he has performed,
Where his element and his ground will go
Is foretold in five ways, in summary."

When the definite portents have appeared,
The particular result, the meaning, is such
That one is able to display various miracles,
And then one attains the genuine truth.
The five kinds of definite portents
That appear at the time of the cause
Are expressed in words as follows:
The particulars of the deeds of intellectual power,
The portents of appearances and of the body,
Signs of the way wondrous substances are found,
Marks of prasena divination and dream omens,
And the portents of many aspirations.
Through these, whatever result is to be accomplished
Has its marks clearly set out in the tantra.
For example, the portent of fire
Is that the mark of smoke appears in abundance;
Wherever smoke appears, in that place
There is certainly fire.
Likewise the portents of water
Are that vapor, moisture, and living creatures appear;
There, certainly, is water.
The omens of wind are like this:
The clouds race along and break into pieces;
Thereby a great wind will certainly arise.
Just as, wherever the leaves of the vermilion plant appear,
There is a gold mine,
So by these marks of portent
Where the result will be, high or low, is known.
Having become skilled in the cause,
Apply whatever mark appears to it.
With uninterrupted diligence,
Paying no heed even if it costs one's life,
Enter the domain of yoga,
Shake out the power of the awareness of samādhi,
Rely on every antidote and train in the grounds,
And strive on the ground of yoga.
Through this one is without doubt,
In some no hesitation arises,

And entering into what is uncertain, there is no doubt.
For example, just as worldly children
Who have long been pining for their mother,
On hearing the sound that a portent has appeared,
Run out to meet her with great delight,
So through the delight that the great omen has appeared,
By striving greatly one comes to attain bliss.
Therefore, having understood the marks of portent,
It is fitting to make diligent effort.
Through the particular deeds of intellectual power,
The portents of the warmth of samādhi appear.
When the meaning of the genuine truth is taught,
One is not frightened, and joy is born.
When one gazes with certainty at the genuine meaning,
Weariness with the phenomena of saṃsāra is born.
When one is familiar with the genuine meaning,
One does not put one's faith in the Dharma of enumerations.
When one sees the genuine meaning itself,
No delight in words arises,
And one holds closely to the meaning itself.
When one sees the meaning, wisdom is born.
When wisdom has been born,
All that appears as entities
Is known to be like an illusion.
When, relying on the knowledge that it is mere illusion,
One gazes at the meaning of the nature of reality,
The very meaning that is without appearance
Is seen as without appearance.
When one sees existence as without appearance,
All the movements of miracles arise.
That itself is the portent of truth.
Then a mark appears
Like the motes in the rays of the sun;
That is the portent of stirring.
Then it appears like a mirage;
This is explained as the first warmth.
Then it appears like the waves of a lake;

This is explained as the middle warmth.
Then it also comes to arise
Without obstruction, like a great wind;
This is explained as the final warmth.
Then, as the warmth of the syllables unfolds,
It appears like a great rain falling;
That is called the warmth of attainment.
Then, like a cloud soaring in the sky,
The reach of the power of samādhi becomes high;
That is the extremely stable warmth.
Then, to the height of a single palm tree,
One's own body, without control,
Leaps into the sky and strives to rise aloft;
This is the extremely clear warmth.
Then, as though the great earth were quaking,
Everything appears to sway and flicker violently;
This should be known as the first sign.
Then, if one trains the power of samādhi,
Whatever one focuses on is accomplished just so.
If one meditates there on the sphere of fire,
It becomes the very nature of fire.
If one meditates there on the sphere of water,
It becomes the very sphere of water.
If one meditates there on the sphere of wind,
It becomes the very sphere of wind.
If one meditates there on the sphere of syllables,
Whatever syllable it is becomes clear.
Likewise, in the sphere of substances,
However one meditates, so it becomes.
That is the attainment of the great sign.
When the power of the samādhi of the intellect is perfected,
The power of truthful speech comes about.
When one sees a great consuming fire,
By saying, "May it be pacified!"
It is pacified right there.
When a harmful flood of a river occurs,
By declaring, "May it be cut off!"

It is cut off right there.
When a harmful onrush of great wind occurs,
By declaring, "May it be pacified!"
It is cut off right there.
When one sees a crowd of sick people,
By merely snapping one's fingers
At the place where they hurt,
And declaring, "May the illnesses be pacified!"
The hosts of illness are pacified.
Likewise whatever one declares with one's speech
Is accomplished, all without exception.
When the power of truthful speech is perfected,
Power arises in the warmth of the body.
Overcoming the conceptions of sleep
And attaining bodily endurance:
This is the first warmth.
Being free of food for the elements,
And one's complexion and senses becoming clear:
This is called the second warmth.
Being light like cotton,
With no comfort or discomfort of the elements arising,
And becoming free of the hosts of illness:
This is taught to be the great warmth.
Even without relying on food for the elements,
The senses and complexion are extremely clear:
This is the sign of tasting samādhi.
Further, the portents of the body:
Seated in the cross-legged posture of equipoise,
One rises about a cubit
And travels about the height of a palm tree;
This too is a sign of the great omen.
Further, in the sky of appearances
One travels on foot,
Does not sink in water, enters the earth,
Is not burnt by fire, and binds the wind;
This too is a great portent.
When the power of the truth of the body is perfected,

The power of might also arises,
And the blessing of that might is inconceivable.
If there is need, or one wishes it,
One transforms earth, stone, or sand
Into gold, silver, and the like.
One brings forth water on dry ground,
And trees spring from charcoal.
Such needs as these
Are accomplished just as one wishes.
When the might and power of conduct are perfected,
The qualities of wealth become complete:
Pleasing riches appear,
And every wished-for intention is accomplished.
One also comes to find marvelous things
That are the most excellent of substances.
These are the portents of being fit.

The portents that beings will gather around one are these:
One is honored by all, and all rejoice,
And one becomes pleasing to the minds of all.
One tames all, and over all
One becomes supreme in holding sway.
These are great portents.
Signs, and omens in divination visions (prasena) and in dreams,
Also arise most extensively;
The yogin should come to know them.
The portents that habitual tendencies are purified are these:
Constantly appearing naked,
Always taking a great bath,
Masses of dirt being cleansed away,
Crossing over rivers,
Swimming in the waters of lakes,
Being washed by streams of rain,
Others pouring water from a full vase
Over one's own body,
Being burned by a great mass of fire,
And, from very lofty peaks,

Being tossed about and scattered by the wind.
These are the signs that habitual tendencies are purified.
The portents of freedom from fear are these:
Coming back again from battle,
Escaping from illness and recovering,
Being freed from prisons,
Slipping from the executioner's hands,
Fleeing from among beasts of prey,
Recovering from poisoning,
Being released from bonds,
And ropes being cut.
These are the portents of good signs.
The portents of attaining the grounds are these:
Climbing onto thrones,
Climbing an ordinary ladder,
Climbing trees,
Going very high upward,
Climbing to the peak of a mountain,
Climbing a jeweled ladder,
Climbing stupas,
And climbing a ladder into the sky.
These are the portents of the meaning.
The portents of securing the grounds are these:
Sitting upon a high throne,
Riding an elephant,
Riding lions,
Riding a great soaring garuḍa,
Reaching the top of a stupa,
Sitting on the peak of a mountain,
Dwelling in the expanse of the sky,
Masses of cloud billowing from one's body,
Sitting upon the moon,
And sitting upon the sun.
These are the signs that the yogin abides on the grounds.
The portents of being a child of the buddhas are these:
Being entrusted with a king's command,
Being appointed lord of commands,

Holding sway over others,
Assigning the world its tasks,
Bringing the factions of others under one's power,
Being victorious in great battles,
Becoming a king oneself,
And flowers growing on one's head.
These are the signs of having become a child of the Victors.
The portents of gaining mastery over the Dharma are these:
Finding profound volumes,
Likewise many questions,
And examining them,
Explaining and teaching them to others,
Establishing the meaning itself,
Looking into mirrors,
Looking at a full crystal vase,
Examining it and drinking,
Gathering precious jewels,
A wheel falling into one's hand,
Seizing the sun and moon in one's hand,
And circling the summit of Mount Meru.
These are the portents of gaining mastery over the Dharma.
The portents of seeing the truth, too, are these:
Seeing lands one has not seen before,
Seeing the vast trichiliocosm,
Going to other continents,
Reaching the top of Mount Meru,
Seeing the vastness of the sky,
Going to the depths of the ocean,
Holding a lamp in one's hand,
Gazing into the heart of the sun,
And examining the whole of appearance and existence.
These are the great signs of gaining mastery over the Dharma.
The portents of receiving a prophecy are these:
Hearing the sounds of music,
Thunder resounding,
The roar of a lion resounding,
Hearing talk in the sound of the Dharma,

The face of an image smiling,
Hearing the Buddha's voice without seeing his body,
Goddesses singing songs,
Sounds arising in celestial palaces,
And being addressed as "Friend, friend!"
And holding discussions of the Dharma.
These are the portents that a prophecy will come.
When such signs as these,
Great omens, appear everywhere,
It is explained to be the portent that individuals who are beginners
Will become ones on the respective grounds
Of the vidyādharas.
For a beginner in yoga,
Whichever of these great omens occurs,
Clearing away all the bustle of saṃsāra,
One realizes the meaning and trains in the grounds.
Thereby one comes to touch the meaning.
Through the blessing of awareness of the meaning,
One is spontaneously accomplished as a vajra vidyādhara.
When abiding on the ground of the vidyādhara
And training great prowess on the grounds,
Various miracles of prowess arise:
Riding upon the sun and moon and traveling,
Brandishing Mount Meru by its waist,
Hurling the world far away,
Quelling the eon of burning,
And all such miracles as these
One is able to display through special prowess.
Such magical feats as these
Are the miracle of magical power.
The miracle of instruction is this:
To all beings who are to be tamed,
In their own languages and in accord with the Dharma,
One is able to teach the various doors of taming,
Each in its own language.
That is instruction.
The miracle of revealing the doors of the Dharma,

The definite one, is taught thus:
Through the special quality of the prowess of meditative absorption,
The world realms are shaken,
And wonder arises in all;
Satisfying the thoughts of their minds,
Each comes to taste the flavor of joy.
This is the miracle of revealing phenomena.
The utterance of all in every way is this:
From the garland of secret letters,
The miraculous sound of the Dharma is proclaimed,
So that all phenomena that are seen and that exist, all appearance and sound,
All resound as the sound of mantra,
And there is nothing at all that has not become mantra.
Therefore, from special prowess
All qualities and the rest arise.

Thus spoke the great Lion of Speech, Sattvavajra.

From the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness, this is the third chapter, the teaching of the miracles.

Then the Lion of Speech, Sattvavajra, entered into equipoise in the meditative absorption of the supreme secret of the inviolable samaya. Then, when he had risen from that meditative absorption, the great yogins of the assembly said this: "Lion of Speech, great being, we see you yourself as the very embodiment of the great samaya."

When they had said this, the great being declared: "Yogins of the assembly, know that the life force of all phenomena is samaya!"

Then the host of the Great Assembly said this to the great being:

"Great being, we wish to hear the secrets of the supreme samaya. Having heard them, we wish to understand them. Having understood them, we wish to abide in them. So, great being, please explain them extensively."

When they had requested this, the great being declared: "Host of the Great Assembly, the samayas are these:

The samaya of utmost secrecy is this:
From those who are not vessels,
In the three ways, outer, inner, and secret,

Practicing the means of concealment,
The secret teachings are to be kept secret.
Bad vessels, unfit for the teaching,
Their kinds summed up in four types,
I explain so that yogins of the future who have the essence
May recognize them and avoid them.
Worldly people, those of the lesser vehicle,
Non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) who delight in wrong views,
The faithless, the dull-witted, the distracted and torpid,
Those not diligent in training and listening, who are like animals;
Those whose faith is reversed, whose samaya is broken, who have strayed from the meaning,
Whose rope of awakening is cut at its depth,
The root of whose mind's sprout is scorched:
They are vessels turned face down in the swamp of the lower realms.
To those who are no vessels, turned face down,
The secret is not to be spoken.
If it is spoken, one becomes turned face down oneself.
Though they speak the secret words with their mouths,
They do not know the hidden, secret meaning.
Among the flawed who broadcast it with bluster,
The secret meanings are spoken all too freely.
With the secret words of approach and accomplishment,
They listen to the sound but do not pursue the meaning.
Unable to keep the essential meaning secret,
Without essence, they leak away into saṃsāra.
Whoever speaks the secret
To a bad vessel unable to hold the secret meaning,
He and that unfit, bad vessel, the two of them,
Leak away alike into the realm of saṃsāra.
Though they know how to talk of the three sacred treasuries
Of view, samaya, and practice,
They lack the power of familiarity, and it has not become stable.
Tormented by deceit, jealousy, and avarice,
Fixing their minds on a dharma of non-action,
Coarse in conduct, their samaya torn, without restraint,
Those who say of yogic conduct, 'Its view is inferior,'

Are defeated and transmigrate in saṃsāra.
One who speaks the secret meanings
To a bad vessel transmigrating in saṃsāra,
Because the secret has thereby been impaired,
Becomes just like that broken one.
Bad companions, broken and ruined, who stir up retorts,
Boastful, double-tongued, twisting things,
Holding the five afflictions in their minds,
Delighting in theft, deceitful conduct, and lies,
For the sake of renown in this single life,
Trailing after persons for a few words,
Listening and eager to repeat them, putting on airs:
Venomous speakers of falsehood, fallen to the lowest.
To speak the secret points of focus
To such a venomous, fallen vessel
Is a great breach of yoga;
One falls to the very bottom of saṃsāra.
Thus, to a defeated bad vessel,
Whatever is the meaning and the nature
Of the secret, the great secret, and the rest,
If it is taught, it becomes an obstacle of defeat and downfall.
Therefore it is not to be taught.
If it is taught,
Those who teach and speak and those who listen,
Both will come to terror, ruined both visibly and for a long time.
Those who do not know yoga
Who, under the sway of arrogance, toward a yogin
Learned, clear, and possessed of the meaning,
Give rise to however many instances of jealous thought,
For that many eons, equal in number,
Will experience unbearable results.
If they are to take up the remainder of their karma,
Only after that many eons must they first enter in.
Even one learned, clear, and possessed of the meaning,
If he thinks ill as described above,
He too takes on a wretched state,
And that learned one cannot escape grief over it.

If one disturbs with evil words the mind
Of a yogin possessed of the meaning and in harmony with the way,
And assails him with exaggeration and denial, theft, and violence,
One falls into the Vajra Hell.
The incidental ripening, too,
Becomes like it, in keeping with its cause.
Yogins of low fortune,
Their root broken, flawed in nature,
Possessed of evil minds, wrath, and ferocity,
Engage endlessly in deeds of slander.
Those of ignorant temperament,
Childish in nature and dull-witted,
With exceedingly inferior views and minds,
Pay honor to hypocrites.
For those who have the qualities of samaya,
Who abide in love and are always patient,
Of excellent conduct, who keep straight the scriptures of the meaning,
For them they have no regard.
While practicing samaya like a monkey,
Buddhas who have attained the heart of awakening
Do not come forth;
I have truly never seen them come forth.
Toward a yogin who has become a child of the Victors,
Skilled in showing the path and clearing away faults,
Some, out of arrogance and jealousy,
Revile him by means of anger and rejection.
That is a stone sunk to the bottom of saṃsāra;
Never will it rise to the surface of liberation.
Yogins who are ignorant
Do not follow a person
Possessed of the true meaning,
But follow whoever has wealth and bustle
And bow down to him.
That is a traveler on the wrong path.
Over yoga's fall and awakening's gain,
No concern arises in them, even when the lifeline is cut;
But for material things, wealth, and the profit of guile,

However small, they will wager their lives to get it by any means.
One with the nature of a learned yogin,
Like a lamp within a vase,
Though possessing the treasure of the treasury of wisdom,
Like the claws of the creature Caurī,
Shows the meaning hidden within,
Yet fools see nothing of it at all.
For example, it is the same in this way:
A man who carries a treasure on his body
And men who have become fools dwell together;
Though they keep company, the two look alike, with no difference.
They utter praises of meditative absorption,
But do not pursue meditative absorption in earnest.
They utter praises of the authentic,
But do not pursue the authentic in earnest.
They utter praises of samaya,
But do not pursue samaya in earnest.
Just as some beings
Tell of the qualities of precious things, saying,
'A precious jewel is like this:
All desired qualities come from it,'
And other beings ask them,
'If desires come forth like that,
Do you have even a little of such a thing?'
And, having none, they reply,
'I have merely mentioned a few of the qualities
Of something that fulfills one's needs;
That itself I do not have';
Just so, yogins who are not diligent,
Lacking the teachings in which one should train,
Though they utter praises of the nature of reality,
Have no nature of reality in themselves.
The wrong conduct of those who act in this way
Should be avoided by those who hold samaya.
Those Dharma-holding yogins
Who, seeing yogins who have broken their yoga and are full of perverse craving

As enemies who destroy the secret,
Expel them and cut them off with punishment,
As one who sees an evil:
That person is a child of the Victors.
For example, when misdeeds
Come into conflict with the law, a minister
Who does not let the violation stand but brings it into line with the law,
That minister who straightens what is crooked in the command,
Becomes widely renowned everywhere
As 'the excellent keeper of the king's heart.'
If a poisonous plant grows in a garden,
As soon as its owner knows it for poison,
He pulls it out by the root and does away with it.
Why? Because if, from those garden vegetables,

The poison were to spread, one would die.
Just so, that venomous one who has broken his commitments
The yogin who keeps the discipline
Should banish, by place or for years, and shun.
Those who do not shun them but become their protectors
Are samaya-demons of the secret.
A yogin of the meaning who,
Toward the pledges that have been profoundly set,
Keeps an unwavering intent to guard them,
Even if, with regard to the root and the branches,
He should transgress without being aware of it,
Though there is a ripening, his root is not broken.
Just as the elephant Eneya,
Though it dies and becomes a corpse,
Still serves a purpose through its bezoar,
So a broken yogin, though he has become a corpse,
Is still an object honored by others
And is able to serve that purpose.
Though that is so, all such as these
Should not be seen even in a dream.
Why? Just as a little milk gone bad
Turns all the milk bad,

Through a single yogin who has broken his commitments
All who practice yoga become corrupted.
All the false yogins
Who bring victory to the battle of saṃsāra
Should all be diligently shunned
By the yogin skilled in the meaning.
If they are not shunned and they practice wrongly,
The battle of saṃsāra is won,
And the might of the blessing of truth grows weak.
All say, 'Practicing virtue is of little use,'
And grow weary of the true meaning,
And take delight in false teachings.
Because all practice wrong deeds,
Various unwelcome things arise,
And through this, both exaggeration and denial come about.
As for the punishment of the command,
By the very nature of their view, the wisdom beings
Never bring any harm at all;
But the savage, mighty ones
Who dwell in their retinue,
The moment they see the faults
Of yogins who practice wrongly, cut them off with punishment,
And all fall headlong into the lower realms.
There is one supreme vessel for practice,
Unlike these, complete in every respect:
Of gentle disposition, possessed of the meaning, of good character,
Attached to nothing, with a generous mind;
Having opened the lock of delusion on the mind
With the key of wisdom and liberation,
Possessed of the eye of the heart of the Dharma,
Seeing the meeting of permanence and annihilation, the domain of the Middle Way,
Knowing how to enter the unerring path,
A pillar, a great pillar, thoroughly tamed.
One able to keep the scriptures straight,
In accord with the pledges as they come in scripture,
Is a child of the Victors;

Therefore the door of the secret should be opened to him.
To the extent that one keeps samaya,
It is like a wish-fulfilling jewel,
From which pleasing desires and bliss come forth.
It is the mother of all the vidyādharas and Victors.
Likewise, to the extent that one keeps samaya,
It is also the support that makes one abide.
Samaya is the life force of all;
Samaya is the supreme wealth of all.
This samaya is the refuge from fear;
Samaya is the supreme path to travel;
Samaya is the boat that ferries across the river;
Samaya is the sacred accomplishment;
Samaya is the supreme friend;
Samaya is the eye of the blind.
To the extent that one keeps samaya,
It conquers the opposing factions
And brings victory in the battle of saṃsāra.
Therefore guard samaya continuously.
In brief, one's own three doors
Held to the limit of the three purities;
The deity, companions, and the master,
And oneself pure, bringing no shame;
The three modes not harmed, the three vows taken;
The four points of complete equality,
Brought to completion, with the four kinds of seals and signs;
Count and dedicate them in mindfulness of the summarized meaning.
The samaya of practicing the discipline
Comes first of all samayas:
Like the fox and the thoroughbred steed,
Free of the very names of accepting and rejecting, a lord of great wrath,
With a mind like a maddened elephant,
Heroic and bold, a supreme tiger, fierce and wild,
A great garuḍa soaring in the sky that does not look back,
A fierce, stocky great bear that stands alone,
With mind mastered and irreversible, like gold in the ocean,
With the seeking mind of one dumb and deluded,

Unchanging as a mountain, of great stability,
Like the sky, free of all wideness and narrowness,
Fierce as a tongue of meteoric iron,
A lord of the discipline of Vajrapāṇi,
Careful and cautious, with a quiet, reticent mind,
With the certain pride and bearing of a bull,
Peerless as the lion, king of beasts,
With a mind of attached companionship like the rejam bird,
Wily, a great whip, a net of illusion,
Enjoying all things without clean or unclean,
Unhindered in killing, like the jackal, wolf, and crow,
With the great pride and mind of the supreme tiger,
With the crouching, wary mind of the soaring garuḍa,
Mastering the ground, taking heed, protecting the realm.
The great discipline of yoga,
Holding twelve and three in mind,
Practiced through familiarity,
Is the secret austerity of yoga.
One who has a continuum of leisure and holds the pledges:
The guarding, the uttering, and the secrecy
Of vajra body, speech, and mind;
The samayas of practicing the branches;
Accepting what is pleasing;
Practicing the profound discipline;
Of all the yogas of yoga,
Not discarding and not abandoning, joined together;
The things one of good family should know;
And what is to be attained and accomplished.
Each of these has five,
And of the root and the branches,
Possessing twelve and eight,
They are the supreme wealth to be practiced.
To the child who practices yoga,
Having examined with certainty the continuum of the mind of awakening,
For a mind of the profound, perfect, supreme bliss,
This scripture of certainty is taught.
This is the pledge that goes before;

Prior to accomplishing the profound,
It is the fierce vajra pledge.
In order to guard the perilous, narrow paths,
If one guards the general and the particular samayas
With the definitive meaning,
That is a great vessel of riches.
Thus, abiding in the general vows,
At this juncture of time,
What is to be guarded and kept is this:
The lion is not to be destroyed,
For it is the king of beasts.
The casket is a treasury of desires;
It is not right to put poison in it.
The tender shoots of the sprout of great awareness
Are not to be cut.
Boiled snowmelt
Is not to be drunk by the wise.
The lotus anthers that have not opened
Are not to be opened except by the moonbeams.
A vessel unexamined and full of holes
Is not to be opened, nor the elixir poured in.
Counterfeit tokens without meaning
Are not to be kept and used.
Precious eggs of white crystal
Are not to be churned in a muddy pit.
The milk of the white lioness
Is not poured into a poisonous vessel.
The precious wish-fulfilling jewel
Is never to be burned.
The great garuḍa's wings, spread in the sky,
Are not to be broken.
The fiery mass of meteoric iron
Is not to be struck.

The remains of the kill made
By the tearing of tiger and leopard are not to be gathered up.
The foundation packed with great vajra rocks

Is not to be demolished.
The close-knit armor of the vajra fence
Is not to be loosened from its tightness.
The lamp that burns the firewood
Is not to be stirred by the wind of distraction.
The flowing stream of vajra words
Is not to be cut off midway.
The king's seal, the token of his command,
Is never to be effaced, not even in passing.
The fortress packed with vajra diamond
Is not to be overturned from its foundation.
The blazing crest jewel
Is not to be taken down from the tip of the victory banner.
These are the samayas of the fortunate
Who are distinguished in the activity of yoga,
The supreme wealth of those endowed with fortune.
The supreme wealth to be practiced continuously
Is the strict sessions of vajra activity.
With the great wrath of vajra armor and dagger,
The enemy that obstructs life,
The dense afflictions, is to be destroyed.
The torpor that raises the army of laziness,
The obstinacy that blocks, the ground of pride,
The intoxicating elixir that makes the faculties arrogant,
The conditions that make one bold, these too are to be restrained.
Apart from the vajra secret words,
The talk of mixed persons and of the childish
Is not to be uttered, not even in part;
All is to be done in vajra secrecy.
Just as men who are to be killed,
When the executioner comes to kill them,
Strive for a means of escape,
So conquer the enemy of laziness and exert yourself in diligence.
To clear away the obstacles that obscure yoga:
Those knotted up in austerities and vows,
Those at odds in desires and enjoyments,
Those in general agreement who are not one within,

The two-faced and the harmful,
Those drunk with desire, sluggish, torpid, and greedy,
The faithless, those whose root is broken, the flighty and distracted:
These the wise should diligently shun.
They are obstacles to yoga;
They cut off the river of accomplishments.
For the one who practices yoga with certainty,
Five obstructing māras arise:
The māra of restless thoughts,
Likewise the māra of indifference and laziness,
The māra of distraction by wealth and bustle,
The māra of harsh words, sharp weapons,
And the māra of wrath, ferocity, short temper, and strife.
These five māras of yogic practice
Obscure the true meaning;
With the antidote, the supreme mind of awakening,
Turn them back into the state of great peace.
The four enemies of yogic practice
Are to be tamed by one skilled in means.
When the vajra that should be held within spreads as secret talk,
The faculty of speech is impaired,
And reproach strikes one.
That is the enemy that breaks what has been laid down.
Through inferior view and coarse, unruly conduct,
Abandoning the scripture of the command and practicing wrongly:
That is the enemy by which obstacles arise through error
In the work of those who practice with samaya foremost.
The three supreme vajras, hard to transgress,
When let slip into slack indifference,
Are like a tree with rotten roots,
A place where the great punishment of the command falls.
When one applies oneself to the work undertaken,
Through weak force of effort
The aims are not accomplished:
That is the enemy that robs, so that it bears no fruit;
For one who practices great yoga,
It is the enemy that steals the supreme wealth one desires.

The person skilled in means
Should shun these four enemies, the faults.
To realize these fields, to be liberated throughout the three existences,
As buddha fields
Is to train in the grounds all at once;
It is the supreme purification of fields.
These causes of offering, the three realms,
Are the supreme great requisites,
The cause that pleases all the Victors,
A marvelous offering.
These places, saṃsāra as a charnel ground,
Are the abode of great bliss.
In the unmistaken, unfabricated expanse of phenomena,
Spontaneously present without seeking,
The roots in which the five poisons move
Are the roots of the five wisdoms:
All-knowing, all-aware, and luminous.
Self-aware wisdom arises from itself.
The yogin who has the eye of Dharma
Views it thus in the definitive meaning.
This is the continuous samaya,
The guarding of the inexpressible.
As for being able to guard it,
The special prowess of samaya
Is taught as a scripture of certainty
For the minds of those who hold awareness.
Attachment through desire, destroying,
Delusion, pride, and jealousy
Are the samayas of great yoga,
To be practiced by a person possessed of the meaning.
Union and liberation,
Taking what is not given, and emanated speech:
The supreme of practices of yogic samaya,
These are deeds to be practiced.
The Victors and all sentient beings,
And all that is imputed as things,
Are one in the state of the meaning;

That itself is the lord of body, speech, and mind.
All phenomena that are signs
Are clear within the state of great equality.
The distinctions of the lower vehicles
All are clear to the self-aware mind.
Not proclaiming whatever qualities arise,
And not disparaging those below,
Is the samaya of the equality of all;
If one knows it thus, the supreme accumulations are perfected.
Forms are Vairocana;
Words that are uttered are Amitābha;
Thoughts of every kind are the Vajra of Mind;
Awareness and feeling are Ratnasambhava;
The movement of the mind is Sarvārthasiddhi (Amoghasiddhi).
The seat and its nature are the place of practice.
When endowed with the ten fields,
This is the enjoyment of great bliss,
And unobstructed activity is perfected in its four kinds.
Outer objects and the inner mind
All abide as equality itself.
Of this, the King of Equality
Never spoke of obscured and unobscured.
Since all has become the expanse of equality itself,
The five aggregates are in truth the five wisdoms;
The lord of body, speech, and mind
Is the vidyādhara of the great seal.
Since there is no nature other than
The nature of object and wisdom,
However the aspects of signs may appear,
There is no ground for any penalty in that.
If one asks what the sacred samaya is:
Sacred realization is samaya;
Whatever brings realization,
That is the great samaya.
Abiding in the state of the equality of all,
Out of the miraculous display of meditative absorption,
Perform all conduct in actuality;

That is the great samaya.
What has become the vessel is the expanse of the Mother;
Its contents are the sky of the Victor, the Father;
Enjoy their arising and entering with awareness:
This is the vajra pledge.
All the sentient beings of existence
And all the categories of the teachings of liberation
All appear each in its own way,
Yet all are clear in the state of equality.
The deeds of conduct, and realization,
And all that has become signs,
That outer and inner domain of the mind,
When examined, becomes an accumulation of enjoyment.
Unborn emptiness is the seal of body;
Natural wishlessness is the meaning of speech;
The signless, beyond the mind, is the heart;
These three are the buddha of great bliss.

When one holds sway through the view of equality,
All of saṃsāra appears within the expanse.
This is the supreme completion of all actions;
No activity remains to be done elsewhere.
Suffering is great awakening;
Saṃsāra is primordially beyond sorrow.
The obscurations are the utterly pure expanse of phenomena;
All the afflictions, too, are the meaning of awakening.
Seeing the meaning that is without appearance,
In the sequence of the grounds
There is nothing to grasp as "this" and "this."
This is the state of attaining non-appearance.
One abides in the state of suchness itself,
With body, speech, and mind unmoving.
However it may be transformed, since it is the nature of reality,
It is free of being called a ground for penalty.
Nonexistence, openness, singularity,
And spontaneous perfection are the great samayas.
Not confined to a side as "this":

This is the samaya of guarding.
Since there is nothing practiced and nothing to be practiced,
All that appears as the conduct
Of existence, of non-Buddhists (tīrthikas), and of worldly people
Is spontaneously present enlightened conduct.
Since what is unabandoned and spontaneously present are indivisible,
There is no object of view other than the expanse.
This is the samaya of view.
Earth, water, fire, and wind, together with the vessel and its contents,
All are by nature the nature of reality.
The nature of reality, without anything other in its meaning,
Is luminous, self-arisen wisdom.
The precious wish-fulfilling jewel
Is present in oneself without being sought.
It is the enjoyment from which desires come forth;
It is the accumulation of the enjoyment of great bliss.
All the lower realms and higher realms,
And all the phenomena of the noble path and of saṃsāra,
Are not apprehended as natures separate from one another;
They are the very nature of the buddha.
All conduct and all kinds of form
Are the nature of the great seal.
Body, speech, mind, and words teach extensively;
This is the nature of the mind that knows the meaning.
Unborn, unarisen,
Nonabiding, there is no attachment to it.
When one fully realizes the special quality of the meaning,
It is the supreme ground of Samantabhadra.
The major and minor marks are all complete;
All is the meaning of body, speech, and mind;
All is perfected in the great self.
Since all is spread out in the great pervasion
Of spontaneously perfect great bliss,
All obscurations are purified and all accumulations are perfected.
Liberated, free of all bonds,
It is the great abode of spontaneously present bliss.

Thus spoke the great Lion of Speech.

From the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness, this is the fourth chapter, called "The Supreme Secret of Samaya."

Then again Sattvavajra entered into equipoise in the meditative absorption called "Indicating All Phenomena through Symbols." Then, when he had risen from that meditative absorption, the retinue of the Great Assembly said: "Great being, we see all phenomena as having the essence of mere symbolic understanding."

Then the great being declared: "Host of the Great Assembly, know all phenomena to be mere symbol, convention, and designation. All designated phenomena abide nowhere, neither outside nor inside. All phenomena have no basis for names and are free of designated conventions. What is called a symbol is a convention designated for what is hidden.

So that the hidden teachings remain secret,
All should be concealed and transmitted.
In this way the yogin
Should come to know the application of symbols."

Then the yogins of the assembly said: "Great being, please explain the teachings of symbols extensively.

We too will transmit
All teachings through the meaning of symbols.
What is it that is called a symbol?
What are the hidden teachings?
What are the secrets not to be revealed?"

When they had requested this, the Lion of Speech declared:

"Listen, host of the Great Assembly!
What is called a symbol is hidden speech.
The hidden, secret teachings
Are the conduct of great yoga.
What is not revealed and kept secret from others:
Because non-Buddhists and other groups
Deride yogic conduct,
In order to be most careful and keep it hidden,
It should be taught through hidden symbols.
The great qualities of symbols,

Though inconceivable even in number,
Are fourfold when summarized:
They are not the domain of others;
They are the domain of yogic awareness;
Through hiddenness, accomplishment is close at hand;
And the secret samaya is not broken,
And they become a means of closeness and affection
For the mothers and sisters who delight in symbols.
Therefore the hidden symbols
Should be expressed, indicated by words:

a la la hoḥ a ti pu hoḥ pra ti bu hoḥ mahā go ru saṃ kra ma gu ya de bī samaya mahā candra mahā purśa gu ya bha ga mahā vajra samaya hoḥ samaya stvaṃ ra ho ya haṃ ra ga yā mi samaya jaḥ lhan oṃ āṃḥ hūṃ samaya samaya e hye hi e hye hi ha he ha ha he ha ma taṃ kha ma taṃ kha ka rukṣa ka rukṣa kṣaṃ ba ri kṣaṃ ba ri ra ho haṃ ra ho haṃ samaya hi a la stoṃ a la stoṃ kha kha le kha le śa da pa śa da pa kha raṃ khā hi kha raṃ kha hi kha le bhyo kha le ha bhyo kha ka kha kha ka kha kha hyi ha he rakṣa khā hi rakṣa khā hi ha ha he raṃ guhya guhya sama sama ma le mu le ta le du le ma ca me ca guhya sitti parama parama śi ri hoḥ śi ri ho ma ma kha ka traṃ e e e e hriṃ hriṃ bhyo bhyo kha kha le le karma ma ti bhyo rakṣa kra ma bhyo rakṣa kra ma bhyo karma ma le karma ma le kṣu ti śa ne kṣu ti śa ne rakṣa karma rakṣa karma krodha kṣaṃ khā hi bhyo kha hi bhyo ca le yaṃ ca le yaṃ pra ca le pra ca le gu rā yaṃ gu rā yaṃ bi gurtti bi gurtti mamo'haṃ mamo'haṃ

This is the seal of the samaya of verbal symbols.

byā ghri carma byā ghri carma ba yaṃ kṣaṃ ga ri ba yaṃ kṣaṃ ga ri ba byā jño ba ba ti ba byā jño ba ba ti na ra ha sa na ra ha sa bandha ka pā la bandha ka pā la carma na ga truṃ carma na ga truṃ rā ga rakta ca ra ga rakta ca ru dhi rā ma ta ru dhi ra ma ta ka ru ga ca ka ru ga ca ba bya ba ti ba bya ba ti gaṃ gro ṇa gaṃ gro ṇa tharpa ta tharpa ta

Courage-maker, kha! Courage-maker, kha!
The waxing moon and the full moon,
The white moon and the supreme moonbeam,
The chief of all who hold life,
The gentle one, the great liberation,

The supreme taste called gal,
The sweet fragrance of great splendor,
The maidservant and the female attendant,
The sharp dagger of Mañjuśrī,

mā tha ya mā tha ya parpa ti parpa ti rva tha ma rva tha ma kha taṃ ña kha taṃ ña rva ti hūṃ rva ti hūṃ śi ñaṃ tha śi ñaṃ tha ka raṃ tha ka raṃ tha śakti kha śakti kha yo gac rbān yo ga carbān

This is the seal of the samaya of sound symbols.

As for the great mudrā of the hands:
Circling the hands in dance to the right and left,
Then snapping the fingers is the sign for inviting.
Circling, then joining the palms, is the sign of the mudrā of homage.
Circling fully, then releasing at the crown of the head,
Is the sign of accepting offerings.
Circling, then holding the hands at the heart,
Is the sign of firm vajra samādhi.
Circling in dance and fully presenting both hands
Is the sign of making offerings.
Circling in dance and placing the hand on the tip of the ring finger
Is the sign of entering into the meaning of union.
Method places it at the tip,
And wisdom at the middle of the ring finger.
If method puts a finger to the right secret place,
For wisdom the secret place is the ear.
If method raises the hand from the right,
Wisdom raises it from the left.
Method displays the vajra mudrā;
Wisdom displays the lotus mudrā.
If method moves the right eyebrow,
Wisdom should raise the left eyebrow.
Method stretches out the left hand,
And wisdom, with the right, shows the manner of embracing.
Circling the mudrā in dance, clapping the palms,
And touching the ring finger to the tongue
Is the sign that the time for the feast offering has come.
Circling both hands, then flicking with the ring finger,

And then touching the ring finger to the tongue,
Is the signal for passing around affection and laughter.
These samayas of signs, such as the mahā, the great kiṃkara and the karma,
And the act of holding the sign of vajra heat,
Are accomplished when the yogin practices them.
This is the seal of the samaya of bodily signs.

Thus spoke the Lion of Speech.

This concludes the fifth chapter, on the signs of yoga, from the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness.

Then again the Lion of Speech, Sattvavajra, entered into equipoise in the samādhi called the Gathering of Yogic Play. When he had arisen from that samādhi, the gathering of the Great Assembly said, "Great Lion of Speech, we see all phenomena in the maṇḍala of the vajra gathering." When they had said this, the Lion of Speech declared, "Gathering of the Great Assembly, know that the intrinsic nature of all phenomena is the vajra gathering." When he had declared this, the assembled gathering said, "Great Being, please explain to us at length the meaning of the maṇḍala of the vajra gathering, which is the intrinsic nature of all phenomena." The Great Being declared:

Listen, gathering of the Great Assembly!
This maṇḍala of the vajra gathering
Is the heart commitment of the Victors,
The path practiced by all yogins.
These paths that traverse the supreme grounds
I shall explain to the assembled gathering.
When a beginner who has just set out
Enters the vajra gathering,
In accordance with the particular stages,
Through the nature of this supreme action,
Having trained step by step as is fitting,
To proceed to the most supreme ground
One should advance by five supreme methods:
One should apply the vajra gathering, approach,
Close approach, accomplishment,
And great accomplishment.
In keeping with the numbers, the great occasions,

And whatever is accompanied by the arising of signs,
Applying the hidden means of concealment,
One should employ the great method that no one can detect.
They are the lords of secrets.
The childish who enter this place,
Having been drawn out of the dust of the world,
Should be set on the ground where change and mastery are not yet certain.
Why so? Because they are beginners,
Childish ones whose mental strength has not yet unfolded,
They do not know good from bad or happiness from suffering,
And cannot tell apart the aims of the open teaching and the secret.
At this command door of the practice of yoga
The secret door should not be opened, for they would become frightened.
Because, from among childish ordinary beings
Who have not realized the intrinsic nature and its disposition,
Māra himself, making a vessel of one who is no vessel,
Harms the yoga and cuts off its life,
And through uncertain turning back and entering,
This secret would be laid bare.
Therefore its conduct too
Should be applied by easeful means, as is fitting.

Then the Lion of Speech entered into equipoise in the samādhi of the vajra gathering of method, and the great yoginīs became invisible. Then the assembled gathering said, "Great Lion of Speech, we see the intrinsic nature of all phenomena as the nature of the mudrā of method." The Sattva declared, "These gatherings of the Great Assembly should be known as gatherings handed down in lineage and concealed."

The deities endowed with the vajra yoga gathering,
The five concealed gatherings of the mudrā of great method,
Together with the sixteen, Vajradhara and the rest:
This vajra maṇḍala
Should be drawn, or else visualized,
Or recited, or consecrated, or set upon a sign.
By the Dharma tradition of the Lord of the World,
Having generated and recollected it for the sake of devotion,
And having brought it down from the realm of its intrinsic nature,

With offerings such as prostration,
And with great articles such as vajra medicine and nectar mixed together,
One should present them to the gathering of vajra method.
Singing the songs of vajra yoga,
Having pleased them and completed the number for accomplishing the activities,
One should make offerings and fulfill the samaya as one wishes.
To disciples who are suitable vessels,
Through acts such as heroic knowing,
One grants the mode of entry, empowerment and accomplishments.
With the five kinds of vajra oath,
Having conferred the duties of training as appropriate,
In stages according to ability,
One has them swear the momentous vajra oath.
Then, for the greater and lesser accomplishment practices,
As they wish, with diligence,
The vajra yoga should be enjoined as a command.
With samayas that do not permit saying "I cannot" and the like,
One should be strict.
Generating the resolve to keep the secret from the deluded,
One transforms their perception with words of wonder.
Once they understand, the objects of knowledge
Should all be shown to their eyes step by step.
To the intelligent one in whom warmth has coiled,
Open the door of the inner treasury of yoga.
To the wild unruly one of coarse conduct,
Show the dangerous straits and distractions of saṃsāra.
To one who has the measure of vajra scripture,
Grant empowerment according to capacity.
To one of incapable disposition who does not seek,
Only what is beneficial is to be praised.
In this place, whether it is present or absent,
Do not efface the radiance, and do not lower the weight.
To one with the disposition of vajra intellect,
One should give the instruction, "Train in great skill."
In the empowerment row of the vajra assembly,
Examine the great downfalls regarding the vajra meaning.

Distinguish the particulars of skill and stage.
The mudrās of the respective families
Are given either in common or else one by one.

Then the Lion of Speech entered into equipoise in the samādhi called the Gathering of the Dhāraṇī of Wisdom. When he had arisen from that samādhi, the assembled gatherings said this:

"We see the intrinsic nature of all phenomena residing in the maṇḍala of the wisdom gathering." When they had said this, the Great Being declared, "Gathering of the Great Assembly, know that all phenomena are awakened in the maṇḍala of the wisdom gathering. Why is that? All phenomena arise from the intrinsic nature of wisdom, and they are clear as the intrinsic nature of wisdom."

Then the assembled gathering said, "Great Being, please explain to us at length the intrinsic nature of the dhāraṇī of wisdom." When they had said this, the Great Being declared:

Gathering of the great yoga of the assembly,
Understand the intrinsic nature
Of the dhāraṇī of wisdom through my extensive explanation.
Just as the gatherings were joined through method,
Those endowed with yoginīs,
Vajradhāriṇī and the rest,
Are joined into a gathering of goddesses.
Here, entering, joy and the rest,
The mudrās of method, are concealed within signs.
The dhāraṇīs of vajra equality
Should be pleased with offerings of equality.
Through dance, song lyrics and the like,
One accomplishes the vidyādhara yoginīs.

Thus he declared.

Then again Sattvavajra entered into equipoise in the samādhi in which all phenomena, method and wisdom, are linked with one another as in a net. When he had arisen from that samādhi, the retinue said, "Blessed One, we see the intrinsic nature of all phenomena as having the nature of being linked as method and wisdom." When they had said this, the Blessed One declared, "Yogins of the Great Assembly, know that all phenomena are linked as method

and wisdom, and are nondual."

Then the yogins of the assembly said, "Great Being, please explain the meaning of all phenomena being linked as a net." The Great Being declared:

The meaning of linkage is this:
The characteristic of all phenomena
Appears in the manner of mutual linkage.
From the space-like characteristic of all phenomena,
Ten million emanations appear as anything at all.
They are linked in the manner of a nondual net.
This is the supreme secret of yoga.
The skillful guardian of the secret door
Should open the secret door to it.
To the sons who have entered this secret
Proclaim this command of the vajra secret.
In this sacred secret maṇḍala,
The Vajra King together with the Queen,
The five themselves entwined as couples,
Join in embrace, entwining from right to left.
On the right is the vajra of awakening,
With each one's own emblem blazing.
On the left, the sweet-sounding bell,
Clear and beautiful with its signs;
Radiant, swaying and bowing,
In a manner of passion and movement,
Upon great lions, supreme bulls and the like,
They sit poised in a perfect manner,
Blazing with the light of five colors,
Graceful in the sixteen adornments.
Generate them gradually or all at once,
Applying this according to the grades of faculties.
The retinue of the secret gathering, too,
With natures transformed at their very base,
Mudrā kings together with queens,
Eight pairs coupled, entwined in embrace:
Kṣitigarbha and Ākāśagarbha, Avalokiteśvara, Vajrapāṇi,
Maitreya and Vajra, Samantabhadra and Mañjuśrī.
The inner and outer articles,

Joining and pleasing through the two bases,
The visualization and so forth, are likewise.
Together with the vajra gatekeepers,
This is the secret gathering of vajra embrace.
By joining the great enjoyments of yoga,
Offer in sequence to please and to fulfill.
Through the secret mode of entry and the like
One accomplishes the secret aims.

Thus he declared.

Then the Blessed One, Sattvavajra, entered into equipoise in the samādhi called the Expanse of Vajra All-Linking. Then the assembled retinue said this to the Blessed One: "We see the intrinsic nature of all phenomena in the expanse of the vajra net." The Blessed One declared, "Gathering of the Great Assembly, know it as the expanse of the net. For all phenomena arise from the awareness of the heart, and the intrinsic nature of the heart is nothing but vajra."

The assembled gathering said, "Blessed One, please explain to us at length the gathering of the great vajra net." The Blessed One declared:

Yogins of the Great Assembly,
The meaning of great vajra awareness,
The very expanse of the linked net,
I shall explain with certainty; listen one-pointedly.
Because this awareness, the great secret of the heart,
Is the definitive vajra,
And because the meaning of the linkage of vajra faculties and objects
All arises from it, know it as the expanse.
Vajradhāriṇī, the holders and the rest,
Are likewise entwined in equality.
The images abide as the nature of samādhi.
Having joined them in the proper sequence,
Do as you wish.

Thus he declared.

Then again the Blessed One, Sattvavajra, entered into equipoise in the samādhi called the Equality of All Four Times. When he had arisen from that samādhi, the gathering of the Great Assembly said this: "Blessed One, we see all phenomena as one in the equality of the four times." When they had said

this, the Blessed One declared, "Gathering of the Great Assembly, all phenomena are realized as the equality of the four times. Know that all phenomena are perfected within the state of the four times. Why is that? In the state of equality, no earlier or later time appears."

Then the assembled gatherings said, "Blessed One, please explain to us at length the very time of great equality." When they had said this, the Blessed One declared:

Gathering of the Great Assembly,
If one knows the time of equality,
Even the name called "time" does not exist.
If one fully knows the four times as equal,
That is the intrinsic nature of the equality of the nature of reality.
The gathering of goddesses of vajra time,
The queens of equality who hold sway
Over the portions of the past, the present,
And what has not yet come,
In destruction, birth, ripening,
And cessation:
Vajra liberation and the immeasurables,
Mind, and likewise the wisdom retinue
Of equality and the center of glory.
In the same way, in sequence, with vajra
Song, dance and other articles,
Make offerings and follow the mode of entry as above,
Without letting the portions pass beyond their times,
On the days of the deities.

Great Bliss and the rest,
Whether as clusters or as mudrās,
Should be applied in common or one by one.
For the past, urge on the gathering of liberation;
For the present and what has not yet come,
Bring about equality with immeasurable mind.
One then becomes a king of equality,
And becomes a Sugata, a king of time.

Thus he declared.

Then again the Blessed One, Sattvavajra, entered into equipoise in the samādhi called the Gathering of Sun and Moon. When he had arisen again from that samādhi, the gathering of the Great Assembly said this: "Blessed One, we see all phenomena as a gathering of sun and moon." When they had said this, the Blessed One declared, "Gathering of the Great Assembly, know that the intrinsic nature of all phenomena is the nature of the mind of awakening and great compassion. All phenomena arise from the mind of awakening and have the nature of compassion."

Then the assembled gathering said, "Blessed One, please explain to us the meaning of compassion and the mind of awakening." The Blessed One declared:

The equipment of all phenomena
Is compassion and the mind of awakening.
If one is not endowed with that equipment,
The aims will not be accomplished.
The yoga in which the mind of awakening is complete
Is like the waxing moon complete in its sixteen parts.
The dawning of compassion and wisdom
Is like the clear sun rising in the sky.
The yogin in whom the two aims are complete
Belongs to the ground of definitive yoga.
To proceed to the definitive ground,
Through gatherings in the continuous flow of vajra time
One should bring about the two great accumulations.
Just as the full moon amid the host of stars
Is completed in sixteen days,
The ground of the thirteen, where great skill is perfected,
Is completed through the sixteen gatherings.
Through the sixteen beautiful days,
The moon disk, a royal seal of light,
That bliss, beautifully adorned,
Brings about merit through the sixteen gatherings.
From the half-full onward, as the accumulation increases,
The mind is trained in phenomena without reference.
Ever more peaceful, ever more without reference,
Signs and objects of knowledge are thinned away.
The accumulation of merit, too, is without reference.

When through equality it has become empty,
Everything is perfected as the dharmakāya,
And suffering and awakening are nondual.
Generating a sense of wonder at this,
One should make offerings with the moon, the times, the signs,
And the two secrets.
To those that arise in the subtle warmth,
And those that hasten forth from oneself,
In order to cut the root, by full completion,
One takes them up without doubt,
And at that very time the sun rises.
If the continuity of this time is cut off,
It is hard to turn back even through approach.
If an interruption occurs, restore and fulfill it.
When the clear moon in the sky is full,
Since the yogin on earth is full as well,
One should perform great increases of merit
And acts of great dedication.
Thereby the great fruit, too:
Riding upon the sun and moon as one goes,
Until one reaches the ground of the vidyādharas,
Great glory is accomplished on the sixteenth ground.

Thus he declared.

Then again Sattvavajra entered into equipoise in the samādhi called Abiding Continuously. When he arose, the assembled gathering said, "Blessed One, we see all phenomena abiding in the maṇḍala of the continuity of letters." The Blessed One declared, "Know that all phenomena are the nature of the maṇḍala of the Victors, and that all the Victors are the nature of the maṇḍala of letters." They said, "Please explain to us at length what the meaning of the letter mudrā is." To this request the Blessed One declared:

All phenomena are the nature of the Victors;
The Victors are clear as body, speech and mind.
Body, speech, mind and the mudrās
Are complete in the very garland of letters.
The maṇḍalas of the letter mudrās
Should be practiced continually.

Thereby one attains the continual samādhi.
The continuity of continuities is not to be cut.
At the vajra dawn and at the times of day,
Generate the gathering of letters and join the gatherings,
And likewise join them with the first portions and the remainders.
This is the path that is close to the meaning;
It swiftly brings about merit.
Through that cause, the all-complete gathering,
Whatever the authentic great gathering may be,
The sacred supreme bliss
And the great suchness, it becomes that very suchness.
With entry door, conduct and view in harmony,
All of them having become one,
Endowed with causes and conditions, excellent,
With harmony, medicine and delightful union,
Deities, vidyādharas and yogins, all of them,
Gathered without exception, should practice this Dharma.
An instant, a moment, a short while,
A brief spell, a day and night, or each month,
The auspicious days of the deities:
These times when the feast falls due
Are the great occasions of blessing.
With articles according to one's means,
Distinguished as outer and inner,
Pure food for the bhūtas,
And for the Victor free of thought and concept,
One should act diligently, according to one's means.
Self, other, and both,
And what does not become the aim of the Dharma:
Having abandoned these four faults,
And endowed with the manner that reverses them,
Regarding the yogins as one's heart and eyes,
One keeps close a feeling of tender affection
And applies oneself as one wishes.
To draw near the deities,
To pacify the obstructors,
To accomplish aims and to restore the dead,

Practicing this rite is most precious.
This feast should not be spoken of
In front of small-minded newcomers.
All the substances and articles, too,
Should be applied forcefully, in whatever way tames.
Therefore this rite, in particular,
Generating a gathering within the gathering, trained in good order,
Having become familiar with approach,
Through accomplishment the fruit is brought to its culmination.

Thus he declared.

This concludes the sixth chapter, on the gathering of the bliss of yoga, from the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness.

Then again the Lion of Speech, Sattvavajra, entered into equipoise in the samādhi called Proclaiming the Past. When he had arisen from that samādhi, the gatherings of the Great Assembly said this: "Blessed One, the question has appeared in our awareness: what are the faults and the virtues of practicing the profound mantra?" Then again the Blessed One declared, "Gathering of the Great Assembly, know that the meaning of the great secret mantra is extremely difficult to practice. Why is that? The gathering of secret mantra is very much like fire. If fire is kept continually and used well, it can be used continually just as one wishes.

But if fire itself is used carelessly, it becomes a great mass of fire. It burns the very one who uses it, it burns from house to house, and it burns up every material thing. In the same way, this secret mantra is like water. If water is harnessed by skillful means and used well, one can enjoy it as one likes, and one who delights in water can even cross over a great river. But one who is not familiar with the nature of water and with the means is carried away and dies. Furthermore, this great secret mantra is like a vicious beast of prey. A beast of prey that takes the lives of other beings is brought under control by one skilled in means, just as one wishes; but if it is not mastered by means, it takes life. Furthermore, this great secret mantra is like the precious jewel that sits on the head of a snake. If the jewel on the snake's head is fully secured by skillful means, it is brought under one's control and can be used; but if it is not secured by means, it parts one from the breath of life. Therefore, because this

great secret is difficult to practice, even in times past there were many who practiced it badly and followed a wrong path. And because many persons skilled in the meaning and the path, who secured it by means and practiced it well, also entered the unerring path, gathering of the Great Assembly, become fully skilled in the means of practice."

When he had declared this, the gathering of the Great Assembly said this: "Blessed One, what are the things that come from a wrong path of secret mantra? What are the things that come from the means of practicing well? Please explain them to us at length." When they had said this, the Blessed One declared to the gathering of the Great Assembly, "Gathering of the Great Assembly, I shall explain the sequence of what is wrong and what is right; listen!" And he declared:

At the time of my earliest memory,
These meanings of secret practice,
Their definitive meaning, had mostly declined.
While only a semblance of the manner remained,
Almost everyone practiced it,
Yet I did not see them meet with the meaning.
All of them practiced a wrong path.
What, then, is it to be wrong?
Not abiding in this, failing in this,
Turning from this, and practicing in a wrong manner;
What is not this manner, and is uncertain here;
A path of deceit, false honesty, and contradiction.
And how was that?
In the time of the aeon called All-Arrayed,
After that Buddha, the King of Manifest Arising,
Had passed into nirvāṇa,
The yogin Excellent Ornament who then appeared,
For a retinue of ignorant, childish ones,
Kept up a hypocritical and wrong gathering;
So, together with five hundred groups,
He strayed from the meaning and turned back into saṃsāra.
Do not practice in that manner!
This wondrous secret teaching,
At times when the authoritative lords of yoga
Are mostly not present,

Is stirred up by the ignorant with evil thoughts,
Who corrupt the word and abandon the scriptures.
Erring, they bring ruin on themselves,
Saying, "I am the one, not this other,"
Praising themselves and disparaging others: this is wrong.
And how was that?
In the times of that same aeon,
A yogin called the Giver of Courage,
Whose mental strength for the meaning had not unfolded,
And who was unskilled in the means of the path,
Abandoned the scriptures of the word of definitive meaning,
Practiced a dharma that is no Dharma,
And to others who practiced the definitive meaning
Said, "That of yours is not the meaning.
Whatever is the supreme meaning, the nectar,
That is this Dharma of mine."
Thus he praised himself and disparaged others.
This too is a wrong path of existence.
Do not practice in that manner!
If, in following a tantra that arose before,
One who lacks substance is installed as master,
Through the power of arrogance from intellectual attachment to words,
Making pronouncements without knowing,
He is hypocritical, crooked in mind,
A deranged and foolish wrongdoer.
And how was that?
A semblance of a yogin
Called the monk Stainless Conduct
Arose following one skilled in the meaning.
The retinue of a hundred thousand groups,
Who had come along following the tantra,
Laid the heavy weight of great verbal mastery
Upon that very monk who lacked the meaning,
And installed him as master, calling him the successor.
The pride of great eminence arose in him.
Not knowing, he put on a pretense,
And by practicing a counterfeit, wrong dharma,

He, together with the hundred thousand groups,
Fell into the state of Rudra of great arrogance.
Do not practice in that manner!
Patrons solicited through friendship and favors,
And a retinue living on gain and honor:
Fearing they might fall under another's control,
They cut off their doors, factions and separate camps.
"This retinue is my field to ripen,
My field for taming;
Those who are not connected with it..."
Making doors with words of affliction is an error.
And how was that?
Five hundred groups of what was called
The yogin Na Zhinépa,
Saying, "We practice the most secret mantra,"
Stayed in a remote hermitage,
And treated all the people living
In those great lands
As their field for taming.
A monk belonging to another school,
Endowed with the meaning,
Came deliberately to that land,
Intending to teach extensively
A single supreme path of definitive yoga.
But that monk who stayed in the hermitage
Issued orders in words of affliction:
"This retinue is my field;
You have no part in it."
By cutting off doors, factions and divisions,
He fell into the path of afflicted saṃsāra.
Do not practice in that manner!
Once offerings have been dedicated to the great yoga,
A few hoard whatever they can;
One mind is drawn out by another,
And never do they partake of the enjoyments.
And how was that?
In a group with what was called

The yogin Bliss-Endowed Knower,
While practicing the secret extensively,
A yoginī living in the retinue,
A woman called Excellent One,
Was appointed as the steward for the feast.
With a miserly mind she hoarded
Those articles of plenty.
Through that ripening of karma
She was born as a hungry ghost in the body of a dog.
Do not practice in that manner!
Furthermore, gathering of the great yoga,
Yogins who practice wrongly,
With wrong views, brazen, fierce and very angry,
Practicing evil and devoid of the meaning,
Still say, "I am the authentic one,"
And with careless talk steal the word, deceive and corrupt.
And how was that?
A yogin who was a Dharma protector,
One called Pramade,
Unskilled in the meaning and the path,
Proclaimed loudly to everyone,
"I am the preceptor."
He stole the word of the Victor, and through the ripening
Of having deceived beings,

That perverse worldling
Fell into the realm of the conduct of non-Buddhists (tīrthikas).
Do not practice in that manner!
With oaths broken and dull toward the meaning,
Because in arrogance they lay claim to the meaning,
Those who want the empowerment of the Vajra King
Are shameless, brazen, benighted and immoral.
And how was that?
One who practiced the manner of yogic mantra,
Called Penaya,
Appeared together with a hundred groups.
With root vows broken and dull toward the meaning,

Through the pride of great arrogance,
Because he feigned skill in the meaning,
He received the empowerment of the Vajra King.
Just as a mountain crushes living creatures,
By the mountain of pride and arrogance,
With the evil deeds of saṃsāric conduct,
He fell into the species of pig.
Do not practice in that manner!
Without realizing the very meaning of equality,
They say in words, "It is equal,"
And indulge openly in both attachment and aversion:
Through yogic action, this is the path of saṃsāra.
And how was that?
A monk called Giver of Bliss,
Together with a thousand groups,
Practiced the secret acts of yoga.
Some indulged openly in attachment;
Some, in great aversion, practiced killing.
Through the ripening of the karma of attachment and aversion,
They fell into the realm of rākṣasas.
Do not practice in that manner!
Those yogins of little intellect
Who, when the meaning of the vajra row of the gathering is discussed,
Are afraid of it and become frightened,
Lose heart, take no delight, and slink away, are fools.
And how was that?
A monk called Devadatta,
While training on the first ground of yoga,
When many yogins endowed with the meaning
Had mostly gathered together,
And the meaning of the definitive secret was discussed,
Devadatta and his retinue slipped away from it.
Taking no delight in discussing the meaning,
With an evil mind he grew jealous.
Having gone to his own dwelling,
He spoke ill of that learned one.
Through that ripening of karma,

For immeasurable aeons
He strays from the authentic meaning
And wanders in the meaningless state of saṃsāra.
Do not practice in that manner!
When a yogin himself shoots at a yogin
The poisoned arrow of extreme malice,
The oath, mighty as a fortress,
Is destroyed: the yogin is his own obstructor.
And how was that?
A learned one endowed with the meaning,
The yogin called Pure Intellect,
Came with his retinue to the place
Where one called Fearless Intellect,
Unskilled in the means and the meaning,
Looked after many communities.
Upon that learned one, endowed with the meaning and possessed of patience,
With an evil mind he cast slander and false charges.
Through that ripening of karma,
Fearless Intellect fell into the Avīci hell.
Do not practice in that manner!
Because their view lacks a focal point,
The authentic path of the Middle Way is not clear to them.
Practicing while relying on a mere general object,
That is a blind gathering of yoga.
And how was that?
There appeared a yogin
Called King Holder of Great Clarity.
Without the eye of the view of wisdom,
Adopting the manner of a yogin in name only,
He practiced scriptures known merely by hearing their sound,
And fell, eyeless, into the realm of saṃsāra.
Do not practice in that manner!
Through yogins such as these
Practicing it as a perverse gathering,
It becomes a perverse gathering of saṃsāra.
Therefore, yogins of the assembly,
The Victor has said that in these most secret teachings

There are great places for going astray.
Through conduct skilled in means
It is precious to make them meaningful.
The yogins of the good path,
Who practiced with skill in means,
The accomplished ones who arose in times gone by:
I shall tell their story.
This conduct of supreme persons,
Whoever hears the proclamation of its virtues
Gains it even through the mere name,
And by recollecting it is protected from the lower realms.
And how was that?
This most secret conduct
Was renowned in the abode of the Thirty-Three gods.
The god's son Radiant,
When the time of impermanence and death had come,
And the omens of death appeared,
Came to feel discontent.
As the perception of his next life arose,
He saw through his own higher knowledge
That he would take the body of a foolish creature
That eats filth as its food.
With a perception of extreme terror,
He brought the objects of refuge to mind.
While his memory of other things was unclear,
The name of the great gathering of the great secret
Was heard by his faculty of hearing.
By bringing what he had heard to mind,
He turned back from the path of the lower realms,
And through the good fortune of practicing the great gathering,
He was born in the abode of those who hold the secret.
In the same way, practice purely what you hear.
Whoever delights in this gathering that pleases the Victors
And develops longing for it,
Without obstacles from others,
Swiftly attains whatever he aspires to.
And how was that?

The brahmin's son Loving One,
Aspiring to practice
These gatherings of the great secret, searched everywhere.
Though he searched, he did not find them.
Sitting down in a certain place,
He wept bitterly and said,
"Alas, how my karma has failed me!
From birth until I have grown old,
I have searched for the profound meaning of the great gathering,
Yet I have not met the meaning. How evil my karma is!
How could I find it, however I search from now on?
Though I search, I will never find it.
I go for refuge to you; protect me with compassion!"
As he cried out loudly in his anguish,
A voice came forth from the expanse of the sky:
"You fortunate brahmin,
Relying on your chosen deity in this way,
You are one who has the fortune of the meaning.
All the Victors of the three times
Bestow their blessings upon you.
Therefore, without letting the view lapse,
You must be skillful and diligent
In the means of purifying the obscurations.
Having opened your own veins,
With that offering of great blood,
As sandalwood water that purifies attachment,
Visualize and offer to all the Victors,
And immediately you will attain the meaning."
Having received this prophecy,
His mind was greatly stirred with joy.
By practicing it just as prophesied,
He became a vidyādhara, a son of the Victors.
In the same way, practice your aspiration purely.
For the fortunate who see and enter here,
It is the same in every case:
Like a pinnacle ornament that has become the summit,
It is never wholly lost.

And how was that?
The one called the son of the gods,
Named King of Virtue,
Together with a hundred thousand groups,
Practiced the secret extensively.
The god's son Jewel Radiance,
Greatly stirred with faith,
Went to that secret place
Bringing many divine substances and articles.
With joy and longing,
He became reverent and stayed there,
And so he gained four great miraculous powers:
Traveling to all the abodes of the gods,
Emanating the great elements from his body,
Lifting up and hurling mountains,
And abiding in deathless life.
Like the pinnacle ornament at the top of a victory banner,
That very Dharma of pure vision
Did not decline for aeons.

Likewise, make your entry pure.
Through seeing, this Dharma is wholly purified,
And having found the eye of the lamp of wisdom,
Those who possess the unsurpassed essence
Find the path and enter on the path.
And what is that like?
A brahmin called Kunri,
Possessing the eye of Dharma, saw the meaning
And practiced according to the scripture of the great secret.
A brahmin called Kaini
Followed after the meaning with faith.
Seeing the gathering of the assembly of the great secret,
He came to possess the eye of Dharma
And came to see the essence of the meaning.
He attained the very stage of a great vidyādhara,
Perfect in spontaneously present great power.
Likewise, make it pure through seeing.

Others who here, toward those who actually practice,
Turn with a joyful mind
Are just like those who practice,
And in the result there is no higher or lower.
And what is that like?
To a yogin called
King Radiant Īśvara,
With a retinue of ten groups,
Who had entered on the aim of vidyādhara conduct,
The great fruit of mantra practice came,
And he gained many wondrous miracles,
So that he became renowned everywhere.
Then a brahmin of another school
Called Virtuous Disciple,
Having given rise to a most pure mind,
Set out to enter and to train,
But the king did not permit it and closed the secret door.
The brahmin, his faith unshaken,
Offered all the wealth and articles he had
To the king's retinue,
And, turning his mind toward
The land where the king dwelt, made aspirations;
He made aspirations single-pointedly.
Through the merit of holding in mind
Sublime rejoicing,
The king who practiced
And the brahmin who did not practice
Both obtained the result, with no higher or lower.
This is effortless and of great meaning;
It is the vidyādhara skilled in means.
Likewise, by rejoicing with joy
In others who practice,
The one who practices virtue and the one who does not
Both come to obtain an equal result.
The inconceivable, unfathomable
Victors train in this and know this,
And so have become friends to the beings of the three worlds

And lords of all.
And what is that like?
The brahmin Luminous Gift of old
Trained in the meaning of this great secret,
And when he made his own mind familiar with it,
He saw the meaning of the truth of mind itself
And became learned in all phenomena.
Since mind is the root of all,
From mind arise countless hundreds of thousands of phenomena.
Becoming a king of Dharma there,
He became renowned throughout all buddha fields
As the Buddha called the Lion of Speech.
Likewise, make your training pure.
The merit of a single great feast gathering
Is such that spreading great accumulations of giving
To countless śrāvakas, lifetime after lifetime,
Does not equal even a hundred-thousandth part of it.
Why is that? Because by pleasing the one,
All the victors are pleased.
The victors who pervade space
And the victor who appears as one alone
Are not separate; they are not different.
Their body, speech and mind are nothing but one.
It is only by the particular perspective of those to be tamed
That inconceivable displays are shown;
Hence the differences appear in that way.
And what is that like?
Two brahmins of pure deeds,
Called Virtuous and Luminous,
In each of whom joyful faith had arisen,
Made a pact with one another.
One made extensive offerings and gifts
To countless śrāvakas;
The other made an extensive feast offering.
Luminous, who practiced the feast,
Fully awakened in this single life.
Virtuous, who spread his giving,

Accomplished it in three countless aeons.
Therefore, those who practice in this place
Should practice correctly, like the yogin Luminous.
Whoever always upholds these
Will always obtain, in actual form,
Greatness and qualities just like those
Of Vajrasattva and the rest.
And what is that like?
The householder called Agnidatta,
Together with a hundred groups,
By practicing this constantly and without break,
Surely attained, in that very birth,
The likeness of the Buddha Vajrasattva
Together with his retinue.
Whoever, having realized the feast
That surely accomplishes for the sake of
Vajra body, speech and mind, speaks of it,
Through familiarizing, expressing and mentioning it,
Becomes a king of Dharma
And becomes the very crown of qualities.
And what is that like?
The sage and yogin Kalyana
Proclaimed the vast qualities of this feast
To sages of many kinds,
And from his definitive explanation of its meanings
Many sages attained the state of vidyādhara.
Kalyana, who taught them,
Became the Lord of Secrets, a king of Dharma.
So teach, explain or express
These secret meanings
To beings who are fit vessels.
By that one will obtain
Great qualities and my own confident eloquence.
Therefore the gathering of the Great Assembly,
The heart commitment of all the victors,
Is this secret feast of yoga.
Whatever yogin endowed with intelligence,

For an instant or a moment,
Fully sets out this feast of the victors
Fulfills the profound pledges
With all the victorious buddhas
And all the vidyādhara yogins,
And will obtain the eye of Dharma.
This has been the explanation of the accounts of former times
Concerning the qualities of practicing the feast
And the faults of practicing it wrongly.
Thus spoke Sattvavajra.

This is the seventh chapter, called Accounts of Past Times, from the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness.

Then the Blessed One Sattvavajra gazed at the face of the Blessed One, the Lord of the Supreme Secret, with great expectation, in the manner of one awaiting a command, and, majestic in every way, remained in readiness at the point of being urged on by the retinue, and fell silent. Then, knowing that most of the retinue were urging him, they struck the ground with their yogic hands and whole bodies, let out the sound "a la la ho," and supplicated with one voice:

How wonderful! Great Vajrasattva,
Blazing with the wisdom that knows self-awareness,
Protector whose qualities pass beyond thought,
Victorious one, to you we bow.
How wonderful! Self-appearing, indivisible body,
Adorned with the major marks of pure merit,
The minor marks arrayed like grain, never tiring to behold,
To the supreme of the five bodies we bow.
How wonderful! Pure expanse of space,
Single speech that knows the various sounds as awareness,
Vajra speech beyond thought and beyond expression,
To the supreme of the five speeches we bow.
How wonderful! Secret mind like space,
Equality unmoving, yet each thing distinctly clear,
Essence of all-knowing awareness, supreme wisdom,
To the supreme of the five minds we bow.
How wonderful! Doing nothing, yet doing great deeds,

Unattached, free of attachment, yet a treasury of desire,
Great action that liberates all,
To supreme enlightened activity we bow.

Regent, we supplicate you:
Through the blessing of the compassion of the protector Maitreya,
Array the armored ranks of emanations in equal troops,
And, against the great hunting drive of saṃsāra,
In order utterly to slay suffering,
Perform the great act of blessing
Everything into a great charnel ground.
A ho!

When they had supplicated thus, that great Sattvavajra made the salutation of a yogin and asked the Blessed One, the Lord of the Supreme Secret: "A la la ho! Supreme of great bliss, king of all secrets, embodiment of the unsurpassed utmost secret, this most daring request, the wondrous words of the gathering of the Great Assembly, is truly marvelous. Considering them with a view to taming them, please satisfy their intentions just as they request."

When he had made this supplication, the Blessed One, the Lord of the Supreme Secret, knowing that the time for taming all had come, surrounded by the retinue of the wondrous secret command, entered into equipoise in the samādhi called Wondrous Display of the Charnel-Ground Ornaments. Having entered equipoise, he spoke these words that bless the retinue: hūṃ he he phaṭ hūṃ hūṃ viśva vajra krodha jvala maṇḍala ā ra li a li u li ta pa li traṃ stvaṃ kha li ho na śa staṃ bha ya hūṃ bruṃ phu ca khā hi phaṭ phaṭ ha la hūṃ

All the boundless ten directions of the six worlds became the maṇḍala of the charnel ground, and they shook, shook violently, and were utterly scattered.

Then the Blessed One, the Lord of the Supreme Secret, taught the heart of Sattvavajra a Dharma of the body that the rest of the retinue could not fathom. Transforming his whole body into the great lord of the charnel ground, he displayed the eight charnel grounds, the ten places of Heruka, the eight glorious attires, the nine great charnel-ground ornaments, the eighteen great signs of meaning, and the various enjoyments of the charnel ground, and gazed with the radiance of a smiling face. From this Sattvavajra understood. Realizing that by this great and mighty secret command the meaning had

been explained, and that it was to be proclaimed in words, he spoke to the gathering of the assembly in words of deeply hidden intention:

"This great and wondrous secret command
Is concealed, and so profound and hard to realize.
Not knowing how to draw out the meaning from what it indicates,
Those of utterly childish and feeble intellect
Who think, 'Afflictions may be indulged at will,'
Are blind in the eye of definitive wisdom.
With little strength and force in the meaning,
Thinking to create the enjoyments of joy and bliss,
Though they practice and pursue signs at will,
Their own nature will not be accomplished.
The continuum ruined, the fruit scorched,
The sprout destroyed, how could anything arise?
For that reason, the Lord of Secrets, the king,
Declares everywhere that these meanings
Are not to be taught to those of feeble strength.
Do you all not know this?"

When he had spoken at length in this way, the gathering of the assembly supplicated him again: "How wonderful! Great being, will you speak such great words of the cause here within this sublime maṇḍala of the retinue? Or will you not practice them? Surely that cannot be. What will you accept and what reject? How wonderful! Who here is not a vessel? Since all possess the essence of awakening, release it, release it completely! Speak it out fully! You have no hindrance; speak without holding back!

Why do you not speak, unobstructed son?
Son of the Victors, this is the time.
This is the vessel for the secret essence.
This is the place of the maṇḍala of the secret command.
This is the way of the secret charnel ground.
You of compassion and wrath, we bow to you.
Secret and utmost secret, we bow to you.
Secret and primordially secret, we bow to you.
King of the maṇḍala, we bow to you.
Essence of the wheel, we bow to you.
What is the manner of the great secret essence?
What is the method of the maṇḍala of the secret command?

What is the meaning of the result, bliss?
For the yogins of the future,
What is the method by which, when they practice,
They will come to know the attainment they seek?
King of the Great Elements, please explain!"

When they had supplicated thus, the sublime Sattvavajra laughed broadly with a great laugh, and as he let out the peals of laughter "a a he he," the whole retinue too let out a great sound of laughter. From the rays of his delight, the glory of wisdom came forth as various joyful music, ringing and resounding. Then the sublime Sattvavajra drew his whole body upright, donned the various charnel-ground attires, made the eighteen signs blaze, and with majestic speech explained this ocean of secret mantra, and these great secret maṇḍalas, the display of signs, the accomplishment of the meaning in its various enumerations:

"Yogins who rely on the meaning
That is singly, truly and definitively accomplished,
And who wish to accomplish it without obstruction,
Just as launderers
Cleanse white cloth so that it takes the dye,
Among the activities of yoga, first of all
Cherish the rites of fulfillment and purification.
Before entering the profound,
In order to cut off at the very depth of mind itself,
Do not keep company in anything at all
With people of the Lesser Vehicle."

Articles that have come from them,
And whatever has come upon the turtle's head,
With a great and deeply stirred mind
Cast them into the ocean and abandon them.
If, through the force of a person,
The penalty of a breach has come about,
Bring down the water of the nature of reality on all, up to the protectors,
And perform extensively the rite of fulfillment and averting.
Before beginning the practice, early or earlier still,
Some number of days beforehand,
Purify wrongdoing, give rise to the mind of awakening,

And set your aspiration on the aim of virtue.
Beggars, those fond of begging,
And all who make their living by begging,
Arrange them in groups, sections and rows,
And make them the field for the manure of compassion.
Medicines, grains and essences,
And whatever has become the finest of nourishment,
Ground, or mixed into flour,
Cast into rivers, streams and great lakes,
And give them away without attachment.
Taking on virtuous patrons,
Establish places for healing the sick, for learning, for practice and for meditation,
And show them supreme honor;
And make the great offerings of the wheel of the seasons.
Relying on all the profound volumes
That proclaim the ocean of the sounds of speech,
Through recitation, service and honor,
Perform vast and extensive deeds.
In order to perfect the accumulations of primordial wisdom,
Give the supreme gifts of the accumulation of wisdom,
Teachings, or volumes and the like,
To those endowed with supreme intellect.
In order to purify the ground of all
Through meditation and familiarization,
Exercise that power of supreme intellect and mind
In many tens of millions of samādhis.
Turning the wheel of Dharma well,
Look to the higher wisdom that purifies the continuum.
At toll stations and on toll roads
Remove all harms of hardship,
Turn the wheel of immeasurable compassion,
And do not interrupt the wheel of giving.
In water or in earth or in the sky,
In fire, and likewise in the winds,
Make into a wheel the great work
Of multiplying and offering the remains and relics.

To avert the deeds of immediate retribution,
Grind them to dust in the continuum of body and mind,
And in the palace of cloud masses of the noble ones,
With bodies as numerous as atoms, make offerings and confess with your mind.
Do the deeds that please the Victors.
From the great works of the union of great means,
Perform the supreme fire rite of four kinds;
That is what averts the deeds of immediate retribution.
The wheels from which compassion arises:
Strive at them in whatever way you are accustomed.
To the hosts who guard the teaching
Perform acts of increasing gifts and offerings.
Among such accumulations of virtue as these,
Abandon all that does not serve the aim,
And raise the great army of the accumulations of diligence.
These great works, heaps of merit and the rest,
Are not produced for any other purpose:
They are to make the single-pointed yogin who holds to the meaning
One possessed of continuum and fit to be a vessel.
And if, being of feeble strength, one has not succeeded,
Gather all the accumulated virtue into great heaps,
Reckon up the meaning of the accumulations of deeds,
Draw out the force of longing and shake out your strength,
And, like the sun rising, a river flowing, the moon reflected,
Cherish its being accomplished by the force of its own nature.
Therefore, even the subtlest thing upward
Should be made to serve one's own aim.
The yogin of subtlety who practices
What is to be practiced in this way, his intelligence increasing,
Having exhausted the small and the smaller to the very end,
Should, by the wheel of the yoga of fulfillment,
Perform this act of fulfilling, restoring and reinstating
Whatever is ruined, torn, broken or mixed.
By the special character of the great work of fulfillment,
There is no fixed rule for examining the site:
A great and wholly fresh site,

Where what is ugly, faulty and inauspicious
Has been removed and is no longer present,
Becomes the place for fulfillment.
Having found such a delightful place,
Invite a teacher who has the warmth of realization,
And honor him with respectful service, placing the royal teaching on your crown.
Then, as the specific requests,
On a maṇḍala plate merely sprinkled with water,
Made like the heart of a mirror,
The offerings of the five pleasing kinds,
Their substances made from pure ingredients,
Adorned with various yogas of conditions,
Cloud masses heaped high,
Are offered to the Victor so that he is pleased and the breach fulfilled.
To the protectors who guard the outer circle,
With the five sense pleasures and the like,
Wish-fulfilling enjoyments together with their conditions,
Make offerings from the portion of qualities, entrusting them with your prayers;
Pleased, they become allies of fulfillment.
To the objects of compassion in the three realms,
If, from great accumulations of gifts of articles,
One satisfies their wishes,
Then, being pleased, they become allies of fulfillment.
Even the classes of obstructors who have become obstructors
Are not to be shut out of mind, through the meaning of equality.
If specifically, with various foods,
The obstructors are satisfied, then all of them,
Through the meaning of equality, appear
As causes of fulfillment, if only in a small way.
Thus, as for what is to be fulfilled
By these acts of fulfillment,
It appears in five kinds:
The great breach of everything,
The breach of the root, the breach of the branches,
Likewise the breach of recitation and the incidental breach: these five.

The means of fulfillment are also five:
Fulfillment through the deeds of conduct,
Through substances, through meaning, through samādhi,
And the great secret means of the pith instructions.
Each of these is also fivefold.
For fulfillment by way of conduct,
I shall explain five kinds.
For the first, five hundred and thirty thousand;
For a root breach, fifty-three thousand.
For a breach of the branches,
Complete five thousand three hundred.
For a breach of recitation, five hundred and thirty.

For an incidental breach,
Fulfill it with fifteen, one and three.
The supreme means of fulfillment through substances is this.
If, through a lapse in some guarding,
The pledge of awakening has been torn,
Fulfill the pledge of the delusion family.
Invite a teacher of the commoner caste,
And confess your faults and transgressions a thousand times, without concealment.
With great substances such as gold,
Ransom with that wealth whatever pledge was lost.
Give rise to the mind of awakening, purify your continuum, and listen to the teachings.
If the vajra pledge has been torn,
Fulfill the pledge of the aversion family.
Invite a teacher of the merchant caste,
And confess your misdeeds a hundred thousand times, without concealment.
With great substances such as crystal,
Ransom with that wealth whatever pledge was lost.
Strive to cultivate meditative concentration and samādhi.
If the jewel pledge has been breached,
Fulfill the pledge of the pride family.
Invite a teacher of the royal caste,
And confess your misdeeds eighty thousand times, without concealment.

With great substances such as beryl,
Ransom with that wealth whatever pledge was lost.
Multiply the bodily remains and relics.
If the lotus pledge has been torn,
Fulfill the pledge of the desire family.
Invite a teacher of the caṇḍāla caste,
And confess your misdeeds a hundred times, without concealment.
With great substances such as coral,
Ransom with that wealth whatever pledge was lost.
Recite the profound volumes that are to be explained.
If the action pledge has been torn,
Fulfill the pledge of the jealousy family.
Invite a spiritual friend of the brahmin caste,
And confess your misdeeds fifteen times, without concealment.
With substances such as sapphire,
Ransom with that wealth whatever pledge was lost.
Perform the great deeds of offering, giving and merit.
By this the great act of fulfillment is accomplished.

The supreme means of fulfillment through meaning
I shall also explain in five ways.
Having meditated on all phenomena as space,
Settle in your mind all habitual tendencies, good and bad,
As nothing whatsoever.
When you have grown familiar with that, there is no fault.
From a teacher learned in everything,
Hear the vast and extensive Dharma,
And perform the deeds of reflection extensively.
Through such deeds held in the mind,
A root breach comes to be fulfilled.
If the branches have been breached,
Examine all the profound volumes
That teach the meaning of the nature of reality as space,
And examine their meanings extensively.
By that there is no breach of the branches.
If the pledge of recitation has been breached,
For a teacher, a learned person,

Take on the role of patron
For a teaching that establishes a great scripture,
Gather all who have the power of intellect,
And proclaim the teaching, the nectar of the sublime Dharma.
If there has been an incidental breach,
Write out the vast volumes of the teaching
And give them as a gift of Dharma.
By that the incidental breach comes to be fulfilled.

The supreme means through the power of samādhi is this.
At the crown of the one bound by habitual tendencies,
A light from the red channel, the size of a mirror,
Blazes intensely, gleaming and clear,
And burns the aggregates bound up with attachment.
From the oneness of the nature of the liberated mind
And the nature of light,
It becomes three spheres of light,
White, red and blue.
Emanating as white, its pervasion is great;
Emanating as red, its passion is great;
Blue is the seed of the mind.
From the three gathered into one,
The habitual tendencies of body, speech and mind are burned,
And the pledges of body, speech and mind are fulfilled.
From the white maṇḍala of the wind moon,
A red blowing wind arises,
And scatters the habitual tendencies of signs.
From the red maṇḍala of the water moon,
Blue water of primordial wisdom arises,
And washes away all the grime of things.
When it has become clear in this way,
The yogin speaks these words:
"To burn substances, fire is needed,
But to burn habitual tendencies, no fire is needed:
The fire of the primordial wisdom of awareness arises
And burns the firewood of signs.
To scatter the world, wind is needed,

But to scatter signs, no wind is needed:
The wind of the primordial wisdom of awareness arises
And sweeps away the masses of the dust of signs.
To wash the body, water is needed,
But to wash the mind, no water is needed:
In the river of equality, the bathing pool,
A stream of the river of primordial wisdom arises
And washes away all the grime of habitual tendencies.
oṃ krodhi śvari sarva pāpaṃ śodhaya oṃ āḥ hūṃ raṃ yaṃ khaṃ"
By speaking these words,
The penalty of a breach does not arise.

As for the great act of fulfilling all together:
Gather the substances and articles of the families
At the site and bless them,
Make the outer and inner boundaries firm,
And for whatever has contravened
The pledges of each family,
With offering, confession, and remorseful honor,
Adopt the eightfold discipline,
Purify the place of meditation and prepare the substances.
As for the pledge of the delusion family,
Which is to be understood and realized:
If, through the power of perverse ignorance,
The fierce pledge has lapsed,
In the palace, the emblem of space,
Abiding at the center of a moon maṇḍala,
Is the nature of A, as clear light.
When its radiance stirs and becomes agitated,
By striking it forcefully with PHAṬ,
The light gathers in and the sky of the aeon clears,
The darkness of the mountain of delusion is dispelled,
And the sprout of awakening blazes forth.
When it has become clear in this way,
The yogin speaks these words:
"How wonderful! From the pledge of the Sugatas,
The mind of awakening, blissful, clear and blazing,

Was not given up for the aim, and its ground was produced;
Yet from the continuum of the great lineage of the buddhas,
As the moon is hidden by a mountain,
From a nature that arises from causes,
The sprout of awakening has all but set.
In the buddha field of the aggregate of form,
Supreme bliss, the great expanse equal to space, is clear.
Through the great means that conquers by its antidote,
I fulfill it! I fulfill the heart pledge of the aeon!
With this supreme secret substance of meaning,
May the heart pledges of the aeon of awakening
Be fulfilled, and be purified for the sake of the intention.
sarva tathāgata puta samaya ho"
Having spoken these words,
Join your hands in a mudrā at the crown in the manner of a sign.
As for the pledge of the aversion family:
In the palace, the emblem of consciousness,
Abiding at the center of a vajra vase,
The nature of HŪṂ blazes as clear light.
When its radiance stirs and becomes agitated,
By striking it forcefully with PHAṬ,
The light gathers in, and by the vajra diamond
The mountain of aversion is destroyed,
And the mirror of wisdom blazes as clear light.
When it has become clear in this way,
The yogin speaks these words:
"How wonderful! The vajra pledges,
Great mind, primordial wisdom clear and blazing:
From the continuum of the great lineage of the supreme mind,
As a sword's edge is blunted,
From a nature derived from that,
The mirror of wisdom has all but set.
In the buddha field of the aggregate of consciousness,
Spheres of clear and blazing primordial wisdom radiate.
Through the great means that conquers by its antidote,
I fulfill it! I fulfill the heart pledge of the aeon!
With this supreme secret substance of meaning,

I fulfill the heart pledge of the aeon of the supreme mind.
May it be fulfilled, and be purified for the sake of the intention.
oṃ sarva tathāgata samaya ho"

Having spoken these words,
Join your hands in a mudrā in the manner of the sign at the heart.
As for the pledge of the pride family,
Which is to be taken up after making all equal:
If, not having overcome that perverse pride,
The fierce pledge has lapsed,
In the palace, at the center of the emblem that is the source of birth,
Abiding at the center of a blazing jewel,
The nature of sva blazes as clear light.
When its radiance stirs and becomes agitated,
By striking it forcefully with phaṭ,
The light gathers in, and by the jewel wheel
The great boulder of pride is destroyed,
And the flowers of the tree of merit blaze forth.
When it has become clear in this way,
The yogin speaks these words:
"How wonderful! From the jewel pledge,
Merit and qualities blazing with light
Were not given up for the aim, and their ground was produced;
Yet from the continuum equal to the great lineage of the supreme cause,
As clouds gather thick across the sky,
By a nature derived from causes,
The beautiful light of the flowers has all but faded.
In the buddha field of the aggregate of feeling,
The wisdom of greatness blazes in equality.
Through the great means that conquers by its antidote,
I fulfill it! I fulfill the heart pledge of the aeon!
With this supreme secret substance of meaning,
I fulfill the heart pledge of the aeon of the supreme body.
May it be fulfilled, and be purified for the sake of the intention.
oṃ sarva tathāgata ratna samaya ho"
Having spoken these words,
Join your hands in a mudrā in the manner of the sign at the forehead.

As for the pledge of the desire family,
Which is to be practiced after realization:
If, unsated in the ocean of perverse desire,
The fierce pledge has lapsed,
In the palace, at the center of the lotus emblem,
Abiding at the center of a blazing lotus,
The nature of oṃ blazes as clear light.
When its radiance stirs and becomes agitated,
By striking it forcefully with phaṭ,
The light gathers in, and by the weapon of the lotus
The ocean of desire is dried up,
And the primordial wisdom of the lotus Dharma blazes forth.
When it has become clear in this way,
The yogin speaks these words:
"How wonderful! From the lotus pledge,
The primordial wisdom of the lotus blazing with light
Was not given up for the aim, and its ground was produced;
Yet from the continuum equal to the great lineage of the supreme speech,
Like the thorns among a thousand-petaled lotus,
By a nature derived from causes,
The primordial wisdom of the lotus has all but set.
In the buddha field of the aggregate of perception,
The light of the realized nature of reality radiates.
Through the great means that conquers by its antidote,
I fulfill it! I fulfill the heart pledge of the aeon!
With this supreme secret substance of meaning,
May the heart pledges of the aeon of the supreme speech
Be fulfilled, and be purified for the sake of the intention.
oṃ sarva tathāgata dharma samaya ho"
Having spoken these words,
Join your hands in a mudrā in the manner of the sign at the tongue.
As for the pledge of the jealousy family,
Which is to be practiced after realization:
If, through the power of perverse grasping of jealousy,
The fierce pledge has lapsed,
In the palace, at the center of the secret emblem,
Abiding at the center of a vajra sword,

The nature of ha blazes as clear light.
When its radiance stirs and becomes agitated,
By striking it forcefully with phaṭ,
The light gathers in, and by the vajra sword
The weapons of jealousy are blunted,
And the primordial wisdom of the vajra sword blazes forth.
When it has become clear in this way,
The yogin speaks these words:
"How wonderful! From the pledge of enlightened activity,
The vajra sword blazing with light
Was not given up for the aim, and its ground was produced;
Yet from the continuum equal to the great lineage of enlightened activity,
As the clear sun is obscured by clouds,
By a nature derived from causes,
The great vajra light has all but set.
In the buddha field of the aggregate of formations,
The light of the weapon of primordial wisdom radiates.
Through the great means that conquers by its antidote,
I fulfill it! I fulfill the heart pledge of the aeon!
With this supreme secret substance of meaning,
May the heart pledges of the aeon of enlightened activity
Be fulfilled, and be purified for the sake of the intention.
oṃ sarva tathāgata karma samaya ho"
Having spoken these words,
Join your hands in a mudrā in the manner of the sign of the body.
By this too the great act of fulfillment is accomplished.

The supreme meaning of the means of pith instruction is this.
For whichever of the root and branch pledges
Has been breached,
Fulfill it by the five supreme means of pith instruction.
If one has fallen into a great breach,
Those persons who have become teachers,
In the sight of nine kings,
Should undertake nine great practices
And carry out the discipline of the nine great supreme ones,
And whoever is one's own consort

Should be offered as consort to nine teachers.
Likewise, for breaches of the root, the branches,
Recitation, and incidental breaches,
If the special practices of meaning,
Seven, or five, or three, or one,
Are applied in their order,
That becomes the supreme fulfillment.

The objects of fulfillment are also of five kinds.
All the Sugatas and Victors,
When summarized, are of five kinds:
Delusion, aversion, pride,
Desire and jealousy, these five.
Because they are what has become the root,
And the ground too is entirely transformed by them,
Know that these are the cause
Of pledges breached and unbreached,
And of all enjoyments, all rejecting and accepting.
By the power of designating the cause itself as the cause,
Like poison that, transformed, becomes a great medicine,
Transform that very thing into a powerful pledge.
By the particular force of taming,
They likewise gather into the five families:
Vajra, jewel, lotus, action, and the rest.
Their supreme heart pledges, too,
Are taught to gather into five.
If, having realized them and vowed to guard and practice them,
One violates and breaks each of them,
Each must be restored individually.
Breaks of body are to be set back in place.
Violations and errors of speech are to be restored.
For violations and errors of mind there is no repair.
For the pledge of the vajra heart,
The great signs that fulfilling has brought fulfillment
Are these:
The relics called śarīram,
Which arise from the great lineages

Of the victorious buddhas and the vidyādharas,
Show everything as omens.
Placed with purity inside a crystal casket and kept there,
When the penalty of a breach has arisen,
Their color turns black and they vanish.
If the breach is fulfilled or restored,
Or if the sacred pledge has not been breached,
Their color becomes white and gleaming.
When good qualities arise,
They multiply greatly in number.
If they are black or unclear,
Hasten, concentrate, and perform the rites of circling and averting.
So, without incurring a breach,
When restoring them,
Rely on this great sign.
When, examining these with great care,
They have become white and gleaming,
That is the sign that breaches of root and branches
Have been fulfilled and restored.

Therefore, as the chief of the yogic activities,
Perform the rites of purification and of fulfillment.

When the Blessed One Sattvavajra had spoken thus, among those gathered in that assembly were the five Great Gods (Śiva and his like), lords of the five afflictions, and others, who from the hosts of Māra had come into the family of the gods, had become the retinue of the Buddha, holding the noble family, and were seated there, blessed so as to be fit vessels for the teaching. Of these, the one called Vajra Skull-Bearing Brahmin, chief of all desire, and the others addressed him thus: "If one does not act according to the Blessed One's command, what will be the birthplace of punishment, and what the karmic maturation, for those who have become faithless, irreverent, contrary and mistaken? Please explain this to us at length."

When they had asked this, the Blessed One Sattvavajra declared: "Lord of Desire and the rest, you ask well about the birthplace of punishment for breaching the sacred pledge. I shall explain what will satisfy your minds; listen!

If any of these roots and branches
Should be destroyed or breached:
At the very beginning of yogic activity,
When one entered the secret door of scripture,
The master who possesses the meaning
Consecrated the vajra oath,
And the pledge water placed upon the tongue
Was sworn with a curse of the Vajra Hell.
That water, having become the letter hūṃ,
Dissolves into the center of the heart,
And there, becoming the great blood-drinker,
The wrathful one called Rakṣa,
An iron scorpion with nine heads,
It sucks out and drinks the heart's blood,
Slays the breaker in great suffering,
And he falls into the Vajra Hell.
If the oath has not been breached,
What was placed upon the tongue is argha;
It dissolves into the center of the heart,
Becomes a wisdom being one finger-span in size,
Purifies every obscuration,
And causes one to be born as a child of the buddhas.
If the pledge of desire is breached,
One goes to the great city of the womb.
If the pledge of aversion is breached,
One goes into the race of rakṣa rākṣasas.
If the pledge of delusion is breached,
One falls into the body of a great, dull-witted pig
That eats filth for its food.
If the pledge of pride is breached,
One falls into the body of a black tortoise.
If the pledge of envy is breached,
One falls into the body of a nine-headed sea monster (makara).
If all the great pledges are breached,
One falls into the body of black Rudra.
Unless one meets with the condition of the rite,
There is no possibility of liberation."

Thus spoke Sattvavajra.

The vidyādharas, lords of the five afflictions, let out a very great wail, and at that time they said: "Oh! Blessed One, Blessed One! According to what the Blessed One has said, we have causes for a fall. At first, when we were bound by the Blessed One's command, lacking faith and respect for the command, we disparaged the command and mocked it; we reviled and mocked the Teacher and our companions; and so on. Since we committed many causes of downfall, it was certain that we would go to the birthplace of punishment. But since the Blessed One's great compassion has taken hold of us and placed us in the retinue of the teaching, we have, it seems, attained liberation. Even so, under the power of intense remorse, we confess the obscurations of mind through the mind of awakening; we confess the obscurations of speech by uttering them in words and crying out; we confess the obscurations of body by offering our bodies as seat and throne. If, then, we beg to be held by the Blessed One's compassion, what is the antidote? By what method is confession made? To what object is it confessed? What is its cause? Blessed One, please explain. Sugata, please protect us with your compassion."

The Blessed One declared: "Great vidyādharas who bear human skulls, listen! It is excellent that, feeling remorse for the occasions of your transgression, you have asked this. What is the antidote to transgression? If one wishes to confess misdeeds, it is to give rise to intense remorse, so that the hairs of the body stand on end and tears are shed. The method is of four kinds. What are they? To know, through the continuum of great wisdom, that all habitual tendencies are without intrinsic nature; to burn all habitual tendencies with the fire of great meditative absorption, so that they are no more; to dispel all the darkness of habitual tendencies with the light rays of the mind of awakening, so that they are purified; and to wash them with the water of vast conduct. The objects before whom confession is to be made are these: the buddhas, the vidyādharas, the deities, the masters, the scriptures, one's companions, and whatever serves as a sacred support. The cause for which confession is to be made is this: the confession of obscurations great and small; that is, the confession of the coarse afflictions that manifestly arise, and the confession of the latent tendencies and of the obscurations to the knowable. Therefore, attend to the actions that have become transgressions with intense remorse, examine them with skill in means, distinguish the obscurations great and small part by part, and confess them with reverence!"

When he had declared this, the great vidyādharas who bear human skulls were pleased and delighted, and, having made the prostration of yogic union, they sang this song of remorse and anguish:

oṃ The maṇḍala that is the nature of the supreme body of wisdom,
Like the full moon, is free of all elaboration,
Yet, deity who makes all equal, like the clear light of the sun of compassion,
Sugatas, please remain, and turn your minds to me.
Ineffable wisdom, unmoving, supreme expanse of Dharma;
Great bliss, Body of Perfect Enjoyment, chief of the five families;
Hosts of miraculous emanations, the vast display
Of compassion and skillful means: to you I prostrate.

With unsurpassed Samantabhadra clouds of offerings,
Both actually present and emanated by the mind,
Filling completely the vast and pure expanse of space,
We make vast outer, inner and secret offerings.
In the bhaga of the mother Samantabhadrī,
In the state where there is no meeting and no parting,
May you be pleased by the nondual awakening mind of a single taste!
The nature of mind is the dharmadhātu, the great space;
Since the nature of reality is pure, vast and luminous,
Since the expanse of yoga itself transcends speech and thought,
To equality, the awakening mind, I bow always.
In Samantabhadra, the Great Perfection, all-pervading from the very beginning,
The array of the outer, inner and secret maṇḍalas
Is appearance and existence wholly pure, the expanse of the mother Samantabhadrī;
The elements and what derives from them, spontaneously perfect as father and mother;
The great secret, fully perfect, she whose very nature is the great dhāraṇī;
Luminous as the nondual great bindu;
Appearing as anything at all, the unchanging deities of great bliss.
The secret maṇḍala, free of meeting and parting:
The Great Being, the Blessed One, father and mother,
The male and female bodhisattvas, the hosts of wrathful males and females,
The vajra goddesses, the lords of the hosts and masters of the gatherings,
Those who love like mothers and cherish like sisters, and all the rest,

The women who watch over good and ill and follow up the pledges,
The vajra oath-bound ones who stand as witnesses: please turn your minds to us!
We, the vajra skull-bearers, heirs through compassion,
All the lords of the haughty ones gathered here,
Have given rise to the awakening mind for the sake of beings,
In order to attain the unsurpassed state.
The discipline of each of the ocean of teachings,
The supreme vows of body, speech, mind and union,
The vajra pledges, hard to transgress, a lasting charge,
And the pledges, general and especially particular:
Earlier and later we received them and swore to keep them in our charge.
Although we had no thought of straying from the meaning or turning back,
Through the laziness that thinks, "There is still time to do it later,"
And through strength and vigor grown slack and feeble,
Lacking vigilance, we came to contravene the pledges.
At first, when the oath was bound upon us by the command,
We were irreverent toward the command, went against it, and mocked it.
In the middle, when the great charge of the training fell to us,
We did not strive in the training and were careless of the meaning.
At last, when the fruit was to be accomplished in this life,
We could not follow the command and the texts, and went against the meaning.
Obscurations great and small, noticed and unnoticed,
Through the power of an ignorance that knows nothing at all,
We have gone against the Teacher's command and the pledges:
Hero, in your compassion, please forgive me!
From the beginningless reaches of time in saṃsāra,
By the force of karma we have wandered long.
Having drunk the poison of afflictions and wrong views,
We are sorely tormented by the disease of suffering.
The compassion of the Sugatas, the king of physicians,
Bestowing the nectar of the pledges, the medicine of liberation,
Pacifies the diseases of affliction and delusion,
And sustains us to the heart of unsurpassed awakening.
In the loving protector, lord of compassion, I take refuge.

Having said this, they cried out a la la ho, relied intensely on the antidote, and offered their bodies as seat and throne. Having been thoroughly purified in the sense of bowing down through the awakening mind, they stripped their bodies stark naked. Because they made confession with intense shame and remorse, the Sugatas were pleased. Thereby their obscurations were purified, and as a sign that the accumulation of merit was complete, their bodies were parted from their clothing, and the skulls they bore became like the moon on the eighth day. As a sign that they had attained the grounds, they came to abide as the support beneath the feet of the Tathāgata.

Then Sattvavajra, delighted, declared: "Skull-bearers, it is excellent that you have confessed through the act of remorse. The obscurations of affliction have been purified. Now, in order to purify the obscurations to the knowable and to complete the accumulation of wisdom, listen with your faculty of hearing to the sounds of the secret mantra in the speech of the buddhas. Through that you will leap from ground to ground, and the fruit will be brought to complete perfection." When he had said this, the minds of the retinue were gladdened.

This concludes the eighth chapter, on the way of accomplishing the rite of fulfillment, from the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness.

Then the Blessed One, the Supreme Secret himself, entered into the meditative absorption called Expansive Magical Display. The sattva Vajragarbha also entered into the meditative absorption called Magical Display. The assembled retinue, too, entered into the meditative absorption called Various Magical Displays. Then the great assembled retinue saw all phenomena as being nothing whatsoever. When all phenomena had become clear as nothing whatsoever, from the space of the empty nature of reality this sound came forth, like an echo:

"Not abiding, not conceiving, free of thought;
Without attachment, free of attachment, beyond all objects;
Nothing at all arises; it is not anything;
Self-arisen, self-pacified, free of expression."

As this sound came forth, the Teacher drew out the greatness of the meaning, and the retinue trained their skill. All were absorbed deep in the meaning and saw the space of the nature of reality.

Then the Blessed One, the Lord of the Supreme Secret himself, entered into the meditative absorption called Stream of Compassion. Then, in the space of

the nature of reality, there dawned a disk of the sun, the reflection of compassion, the awakening mind. Then this true understanding arose in the great assembled retinue: "Ah! Although the nature of all phenomena is thus, beings who do not know it so are sinking into the ocean of saṃsāra; how pitiful this is!" And so the awakening mind of compassion arose in them.

Then from the light rays at the heart of the sun a miraculous sound came forth:

"The light of the sun that pervades everything
Is compassion, the awakening mind.
It shines, dispelling the darkness of conceptual thought;
It is the blazing wish-fulfilling jewel."

As this sound came forth, all phenomena became clear as the light rays of the awakening mind.

Then again the Blessed One, the Lord of the Supreme Secret himself, entered into the meditative absorption called Cause of the Arising of Miracles. Then the great assembled retinue saw the white letter a, the cause of all phenomena, dawn from the heart of the sun. Then from the a a miraculous sound came forth:

"a is the treasury of letters, free of attachment,
The cause of every miraculous conception;
Free of the faults of affliction, the color of the moon,
It is the cause from which various miracles arise."

As this sound came forth, the assembled hosts saw all phenomena abiding as the nature of miracle. Then the Blessed One, the Lord of the Supreme Secret, while doing nothing at all, appeared as the nature of various miracles.

Then the great mother called Ākāśadhātvīśvarī entered into the meditative absorption called Blessing All Phenomena as the Bhaga of Space. When she had entered it, the great assembled retinue saw all phenomena as having the nature of all-pervading space. Then blue light rays radiated from the heart of the mother's bhaga and stirred the a at the heart of the sun, whereupon a blue letter e radiated forth and remained hovering there, and from it this spontaneous miraculous sound came forth:

"a is the nature of e;
From a arises e, pervading space, spreading wide;
Unchanging, unobstructed, beyond thought,

Without edge or center, it spreads everywhere."

As this sound came forth, everything became evenly one as the nature of space.

Then again the great mother Karmadhātvīśvarī entered into the meditative absorption called the Light and Moving Maṇḍala of Wind. Thereby the great assembled retinue saw all phenomena abiding as the nature of wind. Then from that wind a miraculous sound came forth:

"From the wisdom blessed by a,
The miracle of wind dawned as yaṃ;
Possessing the strength that lifts up everything,
By nature moving, it drifts without obstruction."

As this sound came forth, it swirled into a maṇḍala of wind.

Then the mother called Dharmadhātvīśvarī entered into the meditative absorption of blazing, radiating fire. The great assembled retinue saw all phenomena abiding as the nature of fire. Then in the light rays of the fire a miraculous sound came forth:

"From the wisdom blessed by a,
The miracle dawned as the essence of fire;
Blazing and illuminating, wisdom radiates;
All things are consumed, and the expanse of fire whirls."

As this sound came forth, an eon of fire spread out without limit.

Then again the mother called Ratnadhātvīśvarī entered into the meditative absorption of the gathering ocean. Thereby the great assembled retinue saw all phenomena abiding as the nature of water. Then from the light rays of the waves this miraculous sound came forth:

"From the light rays of the causal letter,
The miracle of the essence of water dawned;
It is equal to the limits of space;
The winds and the oceans all spread wide."

As this sound came forth, everything abided pervaded by the nature of the mother Ratnadhātvīśvarī.

Then the great mother called Vajradhātvīśvarī entered into the meditative absorption called Blessing All Realms. Then the great assembled retinue saw

all phenomena as having the nature of the grounds, fully perfected. Then from the ground called Blazing Vajra a miraculous sound came forth:

"From the nonreferential, as manifold
Appearance, this miracle has arisen.
The meaning of perfecting the ten grounds of yoga,
Being spontaneously present, is great bliss."

As this sound came forth, they came to understand the particulars of taming on the nine grounds.

Then the sattva Vajragarbha entered into the meditative absorption called Stacked Mountains. Thereby the great assembled retinue saw all phenomena as mountains of blazing vajras. Then from their light this miraculous sound came forth:

"From the space-expanse of pure wisdom
The mountain of blazing vajras has dawned;
Vast and deep, it towers to the heights of the sky,
And crushes the mountain of conceptual thought."

As this sound came forth, the mountain of blazing vajras overpowered all the mountains of affliction.

Then the five great Dhātvīśvarīs entered into the meditative absorption called the Pure Space-Expanse of the Mother, the Palace of Profound Wisdom. From the heart of the bhaga this miraculous sound came forth:

"From the light rays of the secret bhaga
Comes the palace where the Sugatas dwell,
Immeasurable like the limits of space,
The expanse of the ocean of Victors of the three times."

So the sound came forth. As it came forth, all of space became palaces without limit.

Then the Blessed One, the Supreme Secret himself, entered into the meditative absorption called All Phenomena Fully Complete in the Body, also called the meditative absorption Emanating All Mudrās. Then the great assembled retinue saw all the phenomena of saṃsāra and nirvāṇa complete in the Blessed One, the Lord of the Supreme Secret, from the seat and throne beneath his feet up to the crown protuberance on his head. Then again they saw the desire realm of saṃsāra complete as the ocean of blood of attachment, and the form realm of saṃsāra complete as the outspread ground

of human corpses. They saw the formless realm complete in the skeletons. On the summit of Mount Meru, paved with pearls and filled with crags of blazing precious jewels, dense with the blazing light of emerald, they saw the śrāvakas, the pratyekabuddhas and the bodhisattvas complete. Above the precious jewels, on crags filled with three-pronged and five-pronged vajras, they saw those of Kriyā, Upaya and Yoga complete. Above the great vajra crag, on a maṇḍala of white lotus, they saw all the yogins of the generation stage complete. Above the lotus, where twenty-four suns and twenty-four moons were arranged in union, they saw the twenty-four male and twenty-four female Īśvaras complete. Above the male and female Īśvaras were the eight chief animals; and in order that the yoga of the great vidyādharas, having purified the afflictions, should purify the obscurations to the knowable, they saw all the vidyādharas, fully complete on the grounds, upon the brave tiger, the terrifying lion, the vicious leopard, the fierce bear, the elephant of strength, the majestic buffalo, the seizing sea monster, and the snake of aversion. In the great blazing palace they saw the mother Samantabhadrī complete. In the nine great masses of fire they saw the nine doors of wisdom, stacked one upon another, blazing completely. On the eight feet they saw the four secret mothers and the four gatekeepers complete. The eighteen great ornaments of the charnel ground shone clearly as the eighteen great mātṛkās, fully complete.

The forty-two hand emblems shine clearly as these forty-two: ten sorceresses brandishing staffs, holding in their hands ten blazing garuḍas, from whose beaks various weapons radiate; eight ḍākinīs brandishing staffs, holding in their hands eight lions with gaping jaws, from whose mouths eight blazing swords radiate; eight swift-goers brandishing staffs, holding in their hands eight tigers baring their fangs, from whose mouths various vajras radiate; eight mātṛkās brandishing staffs, holding in their hands eight human heads bound with vajra chains and whirled about by the brains; and eight blazing goddesses brandishing staffs, holding in their hands eight blazing masses of fire from which sparks radiate.

The forty-two hands shine clearly as these forty-two: the four blazing blood-drinkers, the nine male and nine female kiṅkaras, and the ten devouring fathers and ten slaying mothers. The twenty-one faces shine clearly as the twenty-one secret charnel grounds that devour existence. The sixty-four blazing eyes shine clearly as the sixty-four Herukas, fathers and mothers. The twenty-one heads shine clearly as the twenty-one buddhas of the three times.

From the crowns of the seven heads on the right, a buddha body emerges from each, and on each one's head a wheel blazes, together with light rays. From the seven heads in the center, a buddha head emerges from each as a head ornament, and on each one's body there shine seven blazing stūpas of precious jewels. From the seven heads on the left, a buddha body emerges from each as a head ornament, and on each one's head there shine seven precious jewels. From the hubs of these wheels, the vases of the stūpas, and the tips of the jewels blaze ten great banners: the iron banner of the sparrow; the deer banner of those to be tamed; the leopard banner of the beasts of prey; the vajra banner of emanation; the black-snake banner of the precious; the tiger banner of the hero; the human banner of splendor; the blood banner of brilliant red; the lion banner of great prowess; and the bear banner of great ferocity. The tips of these banners converge into one, a golden crown protuberance blazing with a thousand finials.

Then the great assembled retinue saw him fully complete from the seat and throne beneath his feet up to the crown protuberance on his head. They saw the yoga that is complete in the twenty-one buddhas emerging from the heads and in the ten great banners fully complete. They saw the thousand golden finials at the tip of the banner of the crown protuberance shining clearly as the very yoga of the Great Perfection. When they had seen this and it had become clear, the whole retinue was overwhelmed by the meaning of all phenomena being fully complete in the body, and wonder arose in them. The great yogins praised the body fully:

"How wonderful! Because all phenomena are fully complete in your body, you are the dharmakāya.
Supreme great vajra, homage to you, Heruka!
Body vast as the hosts of stars in the sky of the nature of reality,
Form like the massed rain clouds of summer,
Mouth open, speaking like the waves of the ocean,
Like the outspread rays of a hundred thousand suns,
Body perfected by arranging the nine great vehicles and all the phenomena of saṃsāra into a single mudrā,
Three kāyas spontaneously present, dharmakāya blazing with a thousand finials,
Wearing a crest of matted hair, dark brown,
Bathed by a hundred thousand nāga kings, who present every offering,
With vajra speech, clicking your tongue,

You proclaim the terrifying sounds hūṃ and phaṭ,
Words that proclaim the ultimate secret mantra of the Great Vehicle.
Blazing brows flicker like lightning in pitch darkness;
Red eyes with an averting glare blaze like suns;
From blazing nostrils the black whirlwind of the eon swirls,
Raining vajra thunderbolts and great hail of meteoric iron.
Baring sharp-edged fangs, clenched and gnashing,
You fall fiercely upon the hosts of afflictions and wrong views.
Skulls and bones, flesh and blood, marrow-bones, worms and pus
You devour with a crunching sound in your menacing, devouring mouth.
Venomous snakes, fresh hides and other terrifying ornaments
Adorn your menacing body with the greatest majesty.
Hosts of many menacing devourers and terrifiers
Serve as emanated messengers bearing blazing emblems.
All of saṃsāra and all the phenomena of liberation
Sport majestically as the seat of the Great Hero.
Without rival, the one great and mighty one alone,
To the blazing body of the Supreme Secret I bow and give praise."

Through this praise, all phenomena became fully complete in the body, and there was nothing that was not awakened.

Then again the Blessed One, the Lord of the Supreme Secret himself, became the palace in which all mudrās are arrayed as mudrās. This is called the meditative absorption of the Stream of Emanation.

Then the Blessed One, the Lord of the Supreme Secret, entered into the meditative absorption called the Stream of the Nature of Reality. He spoke this meditative absorption of the Stream of Dharma:

"On the volume of meaning that is space,
The hosts of stars are written as letters of awareness;
Proclaimed by the sound of the four great elements,
The stream of the Dharma of secret mantra is never cut off."

The meditative absorption called the Stream of Dharma is complete.

Then again the Blessed One, the Lord of the Supreme Secret, entered into the meditative absorption of the Stream of Nectar and spoke thus:

"Within the excellent bhandha of the trichiliocosm,
The great poison of the beings of the three realms of existence
Is compounded with the buddhas of the three times as its ingredients,
And so the maṇḍala of nectar is spontaneously perfected."

So he spoke. Then again the Blessed One, the sattva Vajragarbha, entered into the meditative absorption of the Stream of Offering and spoke thus:

"The requisites of the ocean of saṃsāra
Are the ornaments of an ocean of offerings;
The whole limitless ocean of existence
Sports as supreme Samantabhadra clouds of offerings."

So he spoke. Then again the sattva Vajragarbha entered into the meditative absorption of the Stream of Recitation and spoke thus:

"From saṃsāra, the dharmadhātu itself,
Dawns the buddha essence of sentient beings;
Sounds and voices beyond the reach of thought
Are all the words of the mantra of recitation."

So he spoke. Then again the sattva Vajragarbha entered into the meditative absorption of the Stream of Union and spoke thus:

"With saṃsāra, the mother wisdom herself,
The king of compassion and skillful means
Is joined without meeting or parting,
And so all are born as children of the Victors."

So he spoke. Then again the sattva Vajragarbha entered into the meditative absorption called the Stream of Liberation and spoke thus:

"These fields for the liberation of saṃsāra,
By the great weapon of blazing wisdom,
Are liberated as being without intrinsic nature,
And drawn forth into the great dharmakāya of equality."

So he spoke. Then again the sattva Vajragarbha entered into the meditative absorption called the Stream of the Reliquary and spoke thus:

"On Mount Meru of the desire realm as the foundation,
The form realm is the steps and the firm base of the throne;
The formless realm is the vase support together with the vase:
The great reliquary abides continuously as the dharmakāya."

So he spoke. Then again Sattvavajra spoke thus:

"Space, fire, water, earth and wind
Appear as the foundation, with Mount Meru as the support;
The tiers, together with the seven mountains,
Are themselves the steps and the firm base of the throne;
The mountains are the vase support together with the vase:
This too is the dharmakāya, never interrupted."

Again Sattvavajra spoke thus:

"The four branches of erecting it are the foundation and support;
The wheel of the great gathering is the firm base of the throne;
The first branch is the vase support together with the vase,
Draped with braided locks, diadems and garlands."

So he spoke. Then the sattva Vajragarbha entered into the meditative absorption called Fully Raising the Dead:

"The great method of accomplishment with a corpse:
In the places of the great charnel grounds,
Seek out the substances of the corpse,
And seal them with the mantra that transforms as one wishes.
Seated upon the corpse,
Imagining oneself as the corpse's antidote,
Recite the corpse mantra without interruption.
If luster and radiance appear on the corpse,
That is the sign that it will be accomplished;
Continue the meditative absorption without interruption.
When the corpse begins to stir,
Smear it with the gold-transforming elixir.
Binding all the limbs of the corpse,
Recite the mantra purely.
When the corpse itself rises up,
It displays the miracles of the corpse.
Then the person who keeps the discipline
Cuts off the corpse's tongue,
And if he strikes the corpse with it, it turns to gold.
Likewise, whatever one wishes,
If one transforms it by that condition, so it becomes.
With that weapon, the sword of the severed tongue,

One cuts off the corpse's bhandha,
And whatever substance one wishes is accomplished.
Taking the bhandha as armor
And bearing the sword of the tongue,
One can turn back even the battle of the asuras.
The swift feet of one who has accomplished the vetāla
Are beyond all measure:
Four men endowed with skill,
Facing the four directions,
At one moment shoot arrows into the distance,
And before the arrows fall to the ground
He catches all four out of the sky;
In a single instant he circles the world,
And before the men's hands have lost their warmth
He has arrived back at his place at once.
'From a corpse every desire arises,'
So the Victors of the three times have taught."

So he spoke. This is the meditative absorption of accomplishing the vetāla.

Then again the sattva Vajragarbha entered into the meditative absorption called the Vajra Ladder of Space and spoke thus:

"Having meditated on space as a vajra,
When one has gained the meditative absorption,
Climbing the vajra ladder
In a zigzag manner, this way and that,
And going into the expanse of space,
Look upon the world realms of appearance and existence.
Thereby the domain of the mind becomes vast."

So he spoke. Then again the sattva Vajragarbha entered into the meditative absorption called Pressing Down the Great Ocean and spoke thus:

"When the meditative absorption of the ocean
Filled with vajras has become clear,
Travel to the great ocean,
And the sentient beings dwelling in the ocean
Should be liberated by the vajra of meditative absorption."

So he spoke. Then again the sattva Vajragarbha entered into the unobstructed maṇḍala of wind and moon and spoke thus:

"On the liṅga of pure space,
Meditate on a moon maṇḍala at its center;
When the meditative absorption has become firm,
Travel to all the realms."

So he spoke. Then again the sattva Vajragarbha entered into the meditative absorption called the Fully Shining Sun and spoke thus:

"On the liṅga of pure space,
Meditate on a sun maṇḍala at its center;
When the meditative absorption has become firm,
Dispel all the places of darkness."

So he spoke. Then again the sattva Vajragarbha entered into the meditative absorption called Extinguishing the Burning Eon:

"On the tip of the yogin's threatening finger,
A moon maṇḍala blazes with clear light.
Meditate on it, and when the meditative absorption has become firm,
Let a stream of water fall and extinguish the fire."

So he spoke. Then again the sattva Vajragarbha entered into the meditative absorption called Hurling a Thousandfold World into the Distance and spoke thus:

"In the maṇḍala of the yogin's activity,
Meditate very clearly
On a thousandfold world with its encircling ring;
Then, to train thoroughly in skill in meditative absorption,
Hurl it into the realm of space,
And raise it from ground to ground."

So he spoke. Then Sattvavajra entered into the meditative absorption called Spreading a Hundred Thousand Sun Maṇḍalas and spoke thus:

"On the yogin's threatening finger,
From a blazing sun maṇḍala
A hundred thousand blazing light rays radiate;
From each one of those light rays
A hundred thousand sun maṇḍalas radiate,
And thereby all darkness is dispelled."

So he spoke. Then again the sattva Vajragarbha entered into the meditative absorption called the Great Element, the Stream of the Waters of the Eon, and spoke thus:

"From the wheel of the yogin's hand
The essence of the water moon dawns brightly;
As the stream of a river of nectar descends,
It quenches the great fire of the burning eon."

So he spoke. Then again Sattvavajra entered into the meditative absorption called the Blazing Mudrā of Body and spoke thus:

"On the blazing jewel liṅga
Is the glorious body of the wisdom of the buddhas;
On the eight facets of the blazing jewel,
The glorious, blazing mātṛkās of awareness
Shine clearly as eight,
And the root maṇḍala of wisdom is complete."

So he spoke. Then again the sattva Vajragarbha entered into the meditative absorption called the Blazing Mudrā of Speech and spoke thus:

"On the blazing lotus liṅga,
Eight syllables of blazing jewel
Blaze intensely, radiating and gathering:
This is the root mudrā of speech."

So he spoke.

Then again Sattvavajra entered into the meditative absorption called the Blazing Mudrā of Mind and spoke thus:

"On the blazing vajra liṅga,
Encircled by the syllable hūṃ,
And at the outer edge eight jewel syllables
Encircled by a deep blue color:
This is the secret wisdom of mind."

So he spoke. Then Sattvavajra spoke this sūtra of meditative absorption:

"The mind is of the nature of illusion;
As it is imagined, so it appears.
Even if it does not appear as the sūtra says,
Mind itself becomes as it is imagined.

Though those with material bodies and fixed focus do not see it,
Those with higher knowledge and bodies of mind do see it.
If one imagines for a long time in whatever way one imagines,
The fruit of that imagining, grown strong,
Will be found clearly, in direct perception.
The habitual tendencies of virtue and nonvirtue,
And the intrinsic natures of existence and nonexistence,
Are nothing but habitual tendencies grown strong.
Therefore meditative absorption, mind itself, is foremost."

So he spoke. This is the ninth chapter, on continuous meditative absorption, from the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness.

Then the sattva Vajragarbha spoke this practice of the great secret union:

"For the yogins of the Great Assembly,
This most secret practice
Is the trail on which the Sugatas, the Victors, have gone,
And it is also the path for persons of the world.
Not realizing, realizing wrongly,
Realizing partially, not realizing the authentic itself:
Having cleared away these extremes, which are like wrong paths,
One enters the path of the Sugatas, the Victors.
Therefore this supreme path of practice
I shall explain to the gathered assembly.
Listen with the utmost respect."

Then the members of the assembly, having paid homage with the gesture of secret union, made this request: "Blessed One, great Lord of Secrets, please explain to us the secret of secrets, the great secret word, the marvelous wisdom, the authentic meaning of the trail on which the buddhas have gone." When they had requested this, the sattva Vajragarbha entered into the meditative absorption called Delightfully Entering the Assembly of Queens and spoke thus:

"The bhaga, the secret lotus,
Is the palace of the Sugatas, the Victors:
For the Victors of the past, the sphere where they came to rest;
For those present now, the support on which they abide;

For those who will come hereafter, the trail on which they go.
So it appears to the Victors.
Not knowing it thus is the path of saṃsāra;
Yogins, come to know it!
The supreme object to be taken here
Is the secret mother, auspicious and endowed with the marks:
Her eyebrows long, her fingers slender,
Her joints and eyes, it is said, are rounded and fine.
Her mouth bears the fragrance of the utpala;
Lovely, endowed with the marks, slender at the waist;
Her hair soft and sapphire blue, wound in tresses;
Teeth white and closely set, eyebrows long;
Eyes like the full-blown flax flower;
Forehead broad, hairline curving;
Nose fine, complexion clear: she is of the lotus type.
Body upright, neck long, with the bearing of a heroine;
The circles of her breasts like the full moon;
Flesh fair and firm, with graceful curves;
Unhurried, she walks with gentle steps;
Her voice sings like a young goose;
She has every graceful manner and poise.
The supreme man takes her as consort.

Consecrating her as consort:
Upon the aggregate of her form
The five seeds of the Sugatas
Become clear, radiating and gathering;
Having sealed, blessed and empowered her,
The supreme forms of the five Sugata mothers become clear.
For the vajra of method it is likewise.
When they have become clear in this way,
Meditate on a mountain of fire in the mother's space;
On the crescent moon at the center of the secret place,
Radiate and gather the bodhicitta.
Just as a reflection appears clearly,
So it is in the space of passion.
Unborn and unceasing,

Awareness, appearing of itself, is equality.
The sphere of space is utterly pure, the expanse of great bliss;
This is the teaching of non-abiding great bliss.
From the very nature of awareness and method,
Blessing becomes clear spontaneously, by its own power.

Her face is ruddy, likewise her shoulders;
Her forehead broad, her eyebrows long;
The luster of her eyes is bright, their shape long;
Her teeth like great conches, closely set, of crystal hue;
Her face long, her cheeks fine;
A sweet fragrance rises from her body,
And from her mouth rises the scent of camphor;
Her breasts are high at the center, swelling round.
She is known as the lotus woman.

The one taught as the conch woman
Is fair, clear with the luster of the moon;
Her face and body turn to the right like a conch;
Her topknot, sapphire blue, coils to the right;
Her voice is strong, melodious, clear in its words;
Small in stature, her body appears beautiful.

The girl called Long-Eyed
Is clear in wisdom and great in desire,
Firm in her discipline toward her lord;
Her secret moon is white and red, its breath heavy;
Pressing tightly and coiling,
No one can ever have enough of her warmth.
She is skilled in the means of hidden secrecy;
Outwardly and inwardly heavy like gold;
Free of conceptual thought, devoted to the meaning;
Her face is square in shape;
Her eyes long, slender and curving;
She is adorned with lovely ornaments of white and red.

Speaking of the type of the tree:
In the midst of a trunk with many branches,
Thick with leaves, beautiful in its boughs;

Her hair, by nature sapphire blue,
Is described as tresses, like the bodhicitta;
Above and below she is everywhere slender and fine,
Tall in stature and supple.
The signs of the one called Slender Sapling:
Twelve, twenty-five,
Untouched by the vajra weapon,
Endowed with the mula rakta;
Slender and fine, and long of face.

The elephant woman is yellowish and square-built;
Brownish, with bulging eyes and thick eyebrows;
Her hair brownish, her teeth large;
Her nose long, her cheekbones high and long.

The woman with markings
Is dark, triangular, with a coarse-haired head,
Wrinkled with anger, with a crooked manner,
A single trunk entirely without limbs.

"One lacking the cause of birth is inauspicious;
Untouchable, a branch scorched by fire.
Yet, although in general it is taught thus,
Those who have faith and keep the discipline,
Whether pleasing to the mind or not pleasing,
If, devoted in faith, they offer their bodies,
One should treat them all equally, as objects of compassion.
Whoever makes conceptual choices of rejecting and accepting,
Their obscurations are boundless.
In the marvelous secret offering,
Whoever performs the complete secret homage
Clears away all the obscurations of karma
And attains the secret focus of the pith instructions.

For the mother examined in this way,
With fragrant incense, sandalwood and so forth,
And water mixed with aloeswood,
Purify her by the rite of bathing.
With sweet fragrances and other things of many kinds,

Apply various unguents to her body.
Then also the great inner bath
Is to be made utterly pure:
With water of the substances and with mingled substances,
Purify the inner substances.
Sugarcane essence and the like,
All that have become supreme in taste,
Mixing them with elixir or with nectar,
One should combine the inner substances.

When the rite of substances is complete,
Generate the mind set on supreme awakening.
In order to train the intellect in the nonreferential Dharma,
The meaning of the root, the bodhicitta,
I shall explain at great length.
Since the aggregates appear as illusion,
It is certain that mind has no intrinsic nature.
Since appearance and existence are one in space,
It is certain that saṃsāra is illusion.
Since the all-ground is the treasury of phenomena,
It is certain that buddha is nowhere else.
Since there is no attachment even to love,
It is certain that the mind is not disturbed by hatred.
Since there is no fixed abode,
It is certain that there is no traversing of the grounds.
Since the mind has neither birth nor death,
There is no dread of transference and change.
Therefore all appears as illusion.
By knowing illusion to be without intrinsic nature,
All is the essence of the nature of reality.
When the stains of conceiving signs
Are washed in that river of the nature of reality,
The stains of grasping become pure.

Then the rite of adornment:
Since it is the equipment of the substances,
Flowing, fluttering robes and garments,
Jeweled clasps together with earrings,

Pendants, charming necklaces and the like,
Armlets, strings of pearls and garlands,
Adorned with gems, jewels and so forth,
Anklets, bracelets and the like,
Adorned with gold, silver and so forth.
With music, sounds and songs of many kinds,
One should bear various offering substances.

Then the rite of drawing her in:
When mingling through secret words,
By the samaya of the vajra tongue,
Indicate by signs in words.
When one says samaya ho,
Mingle also with samaya stvaṃ.
When one says ragayami,
One should say raho hṃ.
When one says tipasuki,
Indicate with gandecita.
When one says atipuho,
Indicate with pratipuho.
If one moves the right eyebrow,
Indicate with the left eyebrow.
If one signals with the right nostril,
Likewise signal with the left nostril.
If one signals the uṣṇīṣa at the crown,
Likewise signal at the liṅga of the śrīvatsa.
When the vajra liṅga radiates light,
The lotus stamens blaze, radiate and coil.
Thus mingle the meanings of these words.

As for the special rite of urging,
In meaning it is fitting to urge thus:
With the rays of the sun of wisdom,
Urge the light of the moon of supreme method.
When the rite of urging is complete,
Offer the articles of offering."

Then all the buddhas became clear in the state of the moon maṇḍala, and wisdom became clear in the state of the sun maṇḍala. Then with the rays of

the sun they urged thus:

"King of the supreme Unmoving One, please heed us!
Nonconceptual, utterly stainless body,
Face like the full moon, radiant with rays of light,
Please arise for the sake of joyful play!"

When they had urged thus, from the rays of the moon came this urging:

"Lovely and rich one, sphere of the ocean of Victors,
Profound wisdom, radiance of the pure lotus,
Supreme lady of conduct, skilled in the ways of magical display,
Lovely and rich one, display your various miracles!"

So it was said. Then occurred the miracle called the Utter Offering of All the Hosts of Articles, and from the rays of the sun a sound arose:

"This blazing lotus stamen
I offer with the radiance of a smile;
From the miracle of the delighted vajra,
Please let the rain clouds of awakening pour down!"

From the rays of the moon arose the sound of miracles:

"Oh! Pleasure grove of the mind,
Garland of the longing heart, consort of wisdom,
Within the coiled amulet box of the lotus
The vajra of bliss blazes with awakening."

As this sound arose, it became the cause from which miracles of various mudrās arose.

Then the sublime Sattvavajra entered into the meditative absorption called Embracing All Saṃsāra with Compassion, and from the one called Supreme Method, the Moon Vajra, this sound of miracles arose:

"All the lords of desire
Are the mistresses of passion's proud swagger.
In order to purify passion,
Desire should be led into its proper place."

As this arose, all of saṃsāra was held in the alms bowl of great compassion.

Then Sattvavajra entered into the meditative absorption called Burning the Obscurations and spoke thus:

"On the blazing vajra liṅga,
Through the radiating light of the wisdom of a,
The firewood of the obscurations of passion
Is purified by the wisdom of fire."

Then again Sattvavajra entered into the blessing of the bhaga and spoke:

"All the phenomena that appear as saṃsāra
Are vividly clear in the essence of the bhaga;
The limbs of the mother's body
Are clear as the very nature of the five mothers."

So he spoke. Then the sattva Vajragarbha entered into the meditative absorption called Cutting Off All Attachment and spoke thus:

"If the nature of reality is realized as space,
However much union and liberation one performs,
It is a method for guiding passion and aversion,
And not even a particle appears."

So he spoke. Then all the buddhas entered into delighted play with the whole assembly of queens, and did not waver at all from nonreferential bliss. Then the great rain of bodhicitta, the essence of the lotus, fell without interruption. All of saṃsāra was born as heirs of the Victors. The Victors moistened cessation with bodhicitta and caused the sprout of existence to grow. Marvelous articles of offering appeared in an inconceivable, swaying profusion. All the vidyādhara sattvas, having purified the cognitive obscurations, were suffused within the dharmakāya.

Then Sattvavajra entered into the meditative absorption called Empowering All Beings:

"The immeasurable Victors
Arise from the cause, the sentient beings of saṃsāra.
If the stream of saṃsāra's sentient beings were cut off,
The stream of buddhas too would be cut off.
Whoever, knowing saṃsāra
To be of the nature of reality, speaks of it so,
That one is self-arisen wisdom of awareness,
A king of Dharma, an heir of the Victors."

So he spoke. Then the sublime Sattvavajra, knowing that all phenomena are accomplished by entering through the door of aspiration, spoke this path of

the great ground of aspiration:

"These heirs of the Victors in the six classes of beings,
Who wander in non-realization and wrong realization,
Should be generated as heirs of the Victors,
And the streams of saṃsāra should be cut.
Placing them within sun and moon,
They are perfected on the sixteenth ground.
Therefore, with one of noble family and excellent marks,
A learned one endowed with the meaning,
Having perfected all the limbs of union,
On the crescent moon in the mother's sphere of space
Generates the accomplished celestial palace.
Its eight spokes clear as nine crescent moons,
From the bodhicitta the host of mudrās:
Generate the wisdom of the nine deities clearly.
By this, all becomes perfect."

So he spoke. This is the tenth chapter, on the practice of secret union, from the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness.

Then the sattva Vajragarbha entered into the meditative absorption called Unchanging, Never Transferring, and spoke thus:

"Those yogins and vidyādharas
Who wish to abide without transference,
For one year, or for one month,
Or likewise for a number of days,
Fifteen, or else up to seven,
At dawn, at the start of the last watch,
The vidyādhara yogin practitioner,
Facing toward the east,
Draws within all that is gathered by the eastern sky,
Gods, nāgas and yakṣas, together with the world,
And, not letting that breath out again,
Should dissolve it into his own interior.
Finally, mingle it within the nose.
When one has practiced thus many times,
One obtains all great glory and splendor."

So he spoke. Then again the sattva Vajragarbha entered into the meditative absorption called Support and spoke thus:

"Whoever wishes to abide in a support,
In a supreme place with excellent signs,
Having gathered everything needed,
Should set out a platform made of earth.
On an eight-petaled lotus at the center,
A red crescent moon, with four gates,
Encircled at the edge by a vajra fence:
Arrange the glorious mudrā of life.
In a vase of precious design,
Having filled it richly with life substances,
Cover its mouth with a vessel bearing the marks.
Having bound it with the vajra cord,
Enthrone it as boundless life,
And likewise place it at the center.
On the four precious vases,
Arrange and place the four secret maidens.
On the vase that has arisen in wonder,
Draw the buddhas of the four families, father and mother,
And the sattvas of their respective retinues,
Joining method and wisdom,
In clusters in their places in each direction.
At the four gates place the four gatekeepers.
Having arrayed all the mudrās of mind,
In the amulet box of sun and moon, ayu
Should coil, blaze, shimmer and be clear.
ayu melts into bodhicitta.
She who bears the supreme victory banner, treasury of jewels,
She who confers empowerment, glorious, possessing the treasure store:
The secret maidens hold the treasure of life.
ayu radiates into the hearts of the four mothers,
And likewise passes in sequence through the clusters.
Gathering all the supreme vajra life,
Dissolve it into oneself with white and red light.
Then recite the vajra life garland.
In the west, in the supreme sphere of life,

In the realm of the Lotus Power,
Is the Loving One, the wisdom of Amitāyus.
In his heart, the great śrīvatsa,
In an amulet box of the light of the two clarities,
ayu of bodhicitta blazes.
That supreme life, clear red and blazing,
Radiates to the vidyādhara yogins.
Radiating, through the sublime nine openings,
It moistens the breath of the citta to radiance.
Having abandoned all six causes of life's decline,
Meditate on the five causes that give rise to splendor.
That ayu of bodhicitta,
Having been hidden in the unborn sphere,
Is explained at the end by seven mudrās:
The first is the seal of body, speech and mind;
The second, the blazing crossed vajra of suppression;
The third, the seal of glorious Paramāśva;
The fourth is the precious śrīvatsa;
The fifth is the golden guhya;
The sixth, on a red crescent moon;
The seventh blazes in an amulet box of sun and moon.
The three continua as the essence of life,
The celestial palace as the essence of the life force:
In the maṇḍala blazing crimson,
The red ayu radiating light
Establishes deathless life:
It is the unchanging svastika.
Since life is hidden in the sphere of the nature of reality,
Even if the Victors of the three times rose up as enemies,
There it could not be seized or pointed out.
Then one should act however one pleases."

This is the vajra practice of life.

Then the sublime Sattvavajra entered into the meditative absorption called the Vajra Wrathful One Who Steals All Life and spoke thus:

"Having made the maṇḍala of transformation blaze,
From the rays of the śrīvatsa at the heart

Of the blazing wisdom wrathful one,
Many goddesses of power radiate.
In their hands they hold white and red hooks,
Together with caskets.
With these they steal all the life
And all the splendor of the six classes of beings,
And, gathering them into the caskets,
Dissolve them into the vidyādharas of life.
Apply them as desired, as above."

This is the sūtra called Vajra Stealing of Splendor and Radiance. This is the eleventh chapter, called the Vajra Practice of Life, from the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness.

Then the sublime Sattvavajra entered into the meditative absorption called Perfecting All the Assemblies. Having entered into it, he explained at length this maṇḍala called the Supreme Secret of the Charnel Ground:

"This sublime root maṇḍala
Of each and every maṇḍala,
In order to liberate all of saṃsāra,
I shall explain to the yogins.
Listen, host of the Great Assembly!
The supreme, sublime places of practice:
Having examined with certainty
The distinctions of their faults and qualities,
On the basis of that knowledge
One should apply them in two ways, adopting and rejecting.
The summit where great mountains gather,
The great slopes of white snow and crystal,
Is a place where lion cubs roam:
It is a place for pacifying everything.
In the midst of a mass of great vajra crags,
The great cave of a vast wilderness
Is a place where great beasts of prey roam:
It is a place for accomplishing great fierce rites.
A charnel ground, a desolate gorge,
A junction of three ways, a mountain of rugged ravines,
Is a place where charnel-ground beasts roam:

It is a place for accomplishing passion."

"Within a forest canopied with a net of foliage,
On a very fierce and fearsome slope,
Is a place where tigers and leopards roam:
It is auspicious as a place for accomplishing desires.
A confluence of rivers, a fearsome watery place, an island in the ocean,
Encircled on all sides by a fence of water,
Is a place where water beasts roam:
Therefore use it for the activity of non-action.
There, with perfect provisions,
Seeing to whatever is wanted, without hindrance,
Free of anything blameworthy,
With abundance, generate supreme diligence.
In order to repel, with the supreme essence,
The great illnesses that arise from the elements,
Nectars, or sacred essences that liberate,
Should be set out in full readiness.
Because obstacles may arise through the conditions
Of combined illnesses, seasonal illnesses
And illnesses caused by poison,
Arrange to have medicines and a skilled physician.
Skull cups together with braided locks,
Small amulet boxes and other articles,
Having endowed them with the great seal,
Make them supports from which siddhis arise.
The supreme practitioner, the secret yogin,
In order to cleanse minds of weariness
And to destroy the darkness of delusion,
Should gather in full readiness
Conches, staff drums and clay drums,
Hand drums, lutes and kokilas,
All the articles perfect in sweet sound,
Music that brings forth every variety.

The great assembly, utterly replete,
Is the master, the vajra wheel king.
At the great time of secret union,

The yogins practicing the great accomplishment
Generate compassion, love, joy and equanimity,
And the yearning bodhicitta.
Moreover, perfect in great skill in every respect
Through knowing and the knowable,
Vajra essence, supreme syllables:
The assembly, utterly replete,
Is the master, the vajra wheel king,
Who has become a treasury of supreme qualities,
Never exhausted though questioned for as long as existence lasts,
Able to withstand conditions, holding complete empowerments and transmissions,
Bearing the form of all vajras,
Gathering all, producing all, undisturbed,
Pervading all like the expanse of space,
Taking as consort the supreme mother, loving as a mother,
His mind-stream trained, holding the supreme discipline,
Unobstructed, free of doubt and hesitation,
Without grasping or attachment, without adopting and rejecting;
Steadfast, able to retain, a vajra kiṅkara,
Holding the right time of the vajra heat,
Applying the casting out and gathering in of words at the right moments,
Cutting the trajectory with waves of qualities,
Setting the crucial point on good and bad as his focus;
Having the melodious voice of vajra words,
His vajra vision utterly pure,
A lord of speech, skilled in words,
Completing the garland of activities.

As for the great time for applying this:
Examining with certainty and holding to the sūtras,
It should be known from the branches of the Vedas, well composed.
The auspicious days of the gods,
And the good conjunctions and junctures of time,
Are worldly conceptions of signs;
When examined, auspicious signs arise.
The first of the four divisions of time

Is supreme for fierce rites and vetālas.
Summer and autumn are auspicious;
Likewise apply them to pacifying and enriching.
Bringing under control too is power,
Said to belong to the great secret time of the corpse.
The seeking of wealth and all magical powers
Are applied pervading all four divisions.
As for the supreme substances of the great practice,
If their time has come,
This time is the great time of siddhi;
The learned never let this time slip by.
For yogins who are beginners in the activity,
When the desired signs
Arise pleasingly and the tokens are found,
It is the great time of the gathering of samaya and dhāraṇī.
When through training one has reached the culmination of skill,
And the qualities of knowledge and intellect have grown in abundance,
These have reached their full measure:
Examine closely this supreme time.

Thus from the coming together of the four causes
The result is accomplished in fact,
As one obtains jewels by relying
On a boat and a skilled ferryman.
All oceans, for as long as they remain,
All one in being without intrinsic nature,
Selfless, free of sides, spontaneously present:
In the one there are by nature no varieties.
When conventions are fully comprehended as pure,
That itself is the great definitive meaning,
And everything becomes pure.
Since self and other are not two,
Oneself is one's own nature;
What is called buddha is not elsewhere:
Oneself is the spontaneously present great sovereign lord.
Whatever things one desires
Are accomplished just as they are;

As with the turning of a potter's wheel,
However one focuses, so it becomes.
In the realm of beings, great in splendor,
Wielding power over the five great elements,
Special marvelous abilities
Will arise without doubt.
The practices of those who strive thus,
Substances, provisions and so forth,
Knowledge and qualities, are perfect:
Since everything is completely present,
With nothing to be reached for elsewhere,
That is what is called perfect.
These activities of practicing the great secret
Are carried out in accord with the actions of saṃsāra,
And though they appear as conduct of the five afflictions,
Just as light makes darkness visible,
Faults become great qualities,
And deceits and flaws become great siddhi.
Thus, by turning back the channel of saṃsāra,
One swirls into the ocean of non-abiding wisdom.

The great importance of examining the excellent site:
Examine it for resemblance to the sky, a wheel, a vajra,
A jewel with eight facets, the sphere of a lotus,
A crossed vajra and so forth.
The ground too is likewise:
Stacked mountains, receding slopes,
And likewise raised and replete forms:
The learned should examine their resemblance.
Furthermore, the distinctions of the families,
Five and so forth, each in turn:
Having understood their respective places,
Accomplish that precious jewel.

The faulty places to be avoided:
The ridgepole tip of malicious Yama,
The claw scratches of a fierce mātṛkā,
The tear tracks of a weeping rākṣasī,

The rockslide trail of a wrathful yakṣa,
Bhūtas, thieves, dangling growths and the like:
The faults of places, enemies and thieves,
The learned should certainly avoid.
Free of what is blameworthy
And of dangers that arise from broken vows,
Impure provisions, like a malicious one come into one's lap,
Should be cast off with the long cry of the great discipline of the fox.

In the region of a great wilderness,
Or where auspicious signs arise,
Dwelling in a pleasing place
Where joy will arise,
In order to fully pacify disputes,
The yogin endowed with compassion,
So as to bring the steadfast practice to completion,
Commands by the truth, or else requests,
The king of the place together with his retinue:
'Heed us, compassionate Victor deities,
Gods, nāgas and yakṣas with your hosts and armies!
Snow mountain peaks and jewel mountains,
Pleasure gardens of delight and parks,
Lakes, ponds, springs and places of flowing water:
All you who have become lords
Of each and every world,
Since I, the lord of yogins, myself,
Would make this ground spontaneously accomplished,
When I request the ground of accomplishment in Jambudvīpa,
Be seated here with your retinues
And grant the ground of precious treasures!'
Having said this, with various jewels
Placed in the ground, one should please them."

"Through this it becomes one's own,
And one is free of that fault.
In stirring the conduct of awakening
And generating the joy of merit,
O wise son of the one with magical power,

Do not fear, and never let jealousy arise.
When the practitioner of the supreme yoga
Has completed the mudrā of subduing Māra,
Against the assaults of the hosts of Rudra
The man recounts the aims of the activity
And declares it for the sake of the lord of the aim:
'When all the Victor lords
Rightly accomplished the supreme aim,
Through the special prowess of the man,
You who now know and bear witness, who discern the focus:
Just as of old the great glorious Lord of Dance
Liberated the four classes of Rudra,
Spread the secret teaching,
And with compassion liberated the six classes of beings,
So now, when I join the yoga to this ground,
Goddess, take note of it,
And when I travel to the ground of great bliss,
Should assaults of Rudra arise,
You who have eyes, exercise your power!'

With the special supreme activity of practice,
For all the activities to be undertaken,
In order to overcome signs by signs,
Examine the signs of the five tastes.
If they turn out virtuous, dwell there.
If they do not turn out auspicious,
The man skilled in means
Should apply the activity of suppressing or of moving.
There, so that it may hold a treasury of merit,
With substances such as the five precious things
Enrich the ground as a great treasure:
This is praised as supremely auspicious.
With earth, fat and the juices of the five great fragrances
Mixed together, make it square on all sides,
Like the shape of an extensive maṇḍala;
By one endowed with samādhi, mudrā and mantra,
All the objects of signs are purified,

And it is made a support where the Victors dwell.
To make it the source of vajra blessing
And to make the places utterly stable,
Through the pure supreme yoga
Take possession of the ground and bless it.
Having purified the ground there,
On the occasions of marking out the area with lines,
In that palace where the Victors dwell,
The great kiṅkaras of the fierce vajra
Fumigate with the smoke of black lcepok.
Having made it unbroken,
Reciting the mantras of the fierce wrathful ones,
Circle with the stances of the vajra wrathful ones.
With pastes of the two kinds of substance
In the manner of the wisdom mother's flowing,
Mixed with silk cotton,
Make moon drops everywhere.
With the Vajra King and the noble ones,
Applying their respective mantras and root mudrās
And their respective postures and stances,
Bless those places.

In order to enter the secret meaning,
Before the secret activities,
Entrust to the protectors who guard the teaching
The great activities of offering gifts, honoring and protecting.
Outside the place of the celestial palace,
As supports where the protectors dwell,
From precious grains, or from ore,
From wood or from bone,
Make cast images or forms of the mudrās,
Enthrone the protectors as four,
And make them the gatekeepers and guards of the place.
'From each side of Meru and the four continents,
Through the might of the power of Vajra, the Lord of Secrets,
Bound by oath to protect the world,
Four classes of greatly powerful protectors,

Skilled in taming your own kinds of obstructors,
Dharma protectors, enjoyment bodies,
Having perfected the four kinds of activity,
The colors of the four families each distinct,
Bearing the deities' emblems as your own signs,
Magically powerful guardians of the outer circle:
Through our yogic training in skill,
Make each of your retinues hold firm!'
In order to bring this prowess of practice to culmination,
To clear away the obstacles of conditions,
And to practice the secret pith instructions,
Suppress the intruding spirits and the samaya-breaking sri demons.
In the places of the great charnel grounds,
In the secret places of the yogin,
When dust enters the water of siddhi,
Gathering all the wrathful ones of the great hūṃ,
Perform the activities of killing and suppressing:
Cast them beneath the foundation of great Meru,
Give them as food to Yamarāja,
Send them into the mouth of the blazing makara,
Suppress them with the mudrā of the blazing wheel.
Their lineage destroyed to the seventh generation,
They can never rise again.
If the bodhicitta is born in them, release them.
vajra muṣṭi vaṃ
mama vaśaṃ kuru nan
suṃbha ni suṃbhā nāṃ
Thus, through the fierce application,
In the intermediate chamber outside the gate,
Having made a hole like space,
With poison and coarse powders,
Various kinds of blood and human corpses,
Smear thoroughly and suppress.

Then, within the vajra enclosure,
Looking with the lion's gaze,
Moving in the directions with vajra steps,

Looking outward with blazing wrathful eyes,
Majestic in a swaggering manner,
Raising the blazing vajra,
Clear away the great dust outside and inside.
hūṃ In the world of the great trichiliocosm,
Beings, plants, trees and forests,
And whatever exists, is seen, appears or is heard,
All are blazing blood drinkers:
Greatly terrifying, fierce, squat and blazing.
The charnel-ground maṇḍala is spontaneously present.
rakṣa yakṣa heruka
rakta krodhi jvala kha
hala hala tiṣṭha phaṭ
With this, by the stances of wrathful play,
The terrifying manner of the mātṛkās,
And the terrifying stances of the gathered phramen,
Circle the blazing maṇḍala.
Garlands of massed vajras,
Blazing hammers and hooks,
Wheels, swords and other implements:
Surround it with the emblems of all the mudrās.
From those, blazing mudrās,
And fire spreading, blazing from the eyes:
With this garland of blazing firelight,
Applying it in visualization or in actuality,
From the syllables of fierce blaze,
Fill the tent with the great glory of burning.
hūṃ raṃ The vajra mountain of fire:
On the eight blazing peaks of Meru,
Having struck down the eight blazing gods,
Is the abode of the greatly powerful vajra attendants.
With utterly unbearable blaze,
Greatly fierce hala, of terrifying form,
Having flayed the Great God (Śiva) and Viṣṇu,
He wears garments of human skin and hide;
In his hand he brandishes the great corpse club
Of blazing Yama and Matraṃ;

Many phramen, ninety thousand,
A blazing host, packed thick to the very end.
Displaying whatever tames each one,
With garlands of fire of the blazing citta,
Strung with necklaces and garlands at the throat,
The expanse of the blazing fire mass of the eon
Swirls and radiates up to the peak of existence.
All the realms of space are packed with masses of fire;
Vajra wheels radiate tongues of flame.
In the regions of charnel grounds and wilderness,
On the blazing mountain of fire,
None but the fire pretas
Can bear to remain.
The blazing flames above
Radiate and churn downward;
The blazing flames below
Coil over and surge upward.
Nine garlands of blazing flames
Roar and crackle as they fight and churn.
The charnel-ground fire blazes dark maroon:
Destroying aversion, it swirls dark blue;
Burning pride, it radiates dark yellow;
Equalizing desire, it radiates dark red;
Burning jealousy, it coils dark green;
Clearing away delusion, it coils dark maroon.
It is packed with wheels of the expanse of great blaze."

jvala maṇḍala hala hala raṃ
With the mudrā of the fire-mountain hand and of water,
One should encircle the site or the maṇḍala.
On the sky where the nature of reality lies open,
Stack up the great elements of the five wisdoms.
On the sky where the all-ground lies open,
Stack up the five great elements of the generating mothers.
From bruṃ arises a blazing jeweled palace,
Without edge or center, pervading everything,
Rising like a palm tree and hung with golden bells,

With a red crescent moon, the seal of magnetizing.
bruṃ khaṃ traṃ khalati bruṃ
With this, using the ointment of five kinds,
One should sprinkle and anoint all around.

The yogins who guard the supreme accomplishment,
Having set it in place with vajra words,
Bless the children of the Victor, the vidyādharas, the wheel of the command,
So that they may reach the result.
That great Vajra Lord of Victors
Makes the syllables that burn away obscurations
Into a garland and radiates them into the site.
Placing them upon a sun maṇḍala,
Seal them with the signs of male and female vidyādharas.
Sprinkle everything with the ointment of five kinds.
Give the mudrā of the emblem into the hand.
Practice in the manner of Mahāyoga.
Since all the ways of upholding the world
Are illusion, utterly,
Practice the conduct that transcends the world
Just as it arises.

How wonderful! In this marvelous realm,
This pleasure grove of the secret charnel ground,
You fortunate lords, children of the Victor,
Vidyādharas gathered here in assembly,
How wonderful! Companions in supreme joy and great bliss,
Bound by the life-cord of samaya,
Joined in skillful means and wisdom,
Shaking out the wings of emanation and spreading your pinions,
Soaring aloft by the strength of the two accumulations,
It is fitting that you glide in the sky of the nature of reality.
a yaṃ ja laṃ khaṃ together.
From this day on, children of the Victor,
Since you are lords, enjoy as you please.
To produce the enjoyments of yoga
And to turn poisons into nectar,
With the wisdom born from māṃ,

The substance in the copper vessel is to be digested and tamed.

The samaya substances, articles and enjoyments
Should from the outset be prepared in three separate portions,
Each kept apart, unmixed.
With the outer portion,
Prepare the articles for setting out offerings and gifts.
From the second of those two portions,
Make the enjoyment of the royal Dharma at the close.
As for the marvelous inner portions,
Having made them all into one,
Gather them on cloth or a wooden tray
And cover them with the substances of accomplishment.
Sprinkle them with the great ointment.
Fumigate them with the smoke of black incense.
With the mudrā of the vajra dance
And a blazing gaze, make it majestic.
Circle around it with great striding steps.
Drive off the strong odor of the various burnt offerings.
Then, through the blessing of the king,
Those articles are gathered into the essence
Of the five nectars, the samaya substances.
Upon them, from the radiating and gathering of the five seed syllables,
They melt and blaze as the five kinds of hand emblems,
And melt into great, pure nectar.
The wisdom goddesses, the vidyādharīs,
Four of them, or else eight kinds,
Being by nature the substances or articles,
Lift up the supreme food with dance
And present it with this song of displaying enjoyments:

"We vidyādharīs, the wisdom women,
Hold the accomplishment of the deities for the children of the Victor.
Enjoyments that satisfy with delight,
Like a wish-fulfilling jewel,
A wish-granting tree, a wish-granting cow,
Or crops that flourish without plowing:
May these great enjoyments of yoga,

Crowding the whole realm of space,
With all the vajra assemblies of delight gathered together,
Be emanated in abundance by the fortunate!"
Mastering the vajra dance,
The goddesses, in their charming way of bestowing,
Bowing and remaining in attendance,
Delight them with a host of music.
oṃ śrī vajra lāsyai hūṃ hūṃ vajra mālai trāṃ trāṃ vajra gīti hrīḥ hrīḥ vajra nṛtya aḥ aḥ
By the supreme means of vajra activity,
This vajra song brings forth splendor.
This enjoyment of vajra nectar
Is the heart of the essence of the supreme elixir,
The best enhancer of splendor and radiance,
The glory of luster, of supreme form and of mindfulness.
By the power of the blessing of the Vajra Holder,
Let it be food for the fortunate;
For the unfortunate it turns to poison,
Just as milk does for a snake.
samaya jaḥ kusucamama

"Goddess of purple dew, soft and clear,
You who turn all moisture into nectar,
Holder of the accomplishment of streams of nectar,
Send down a stream of water as the karmic share of those who tend you.
You who turn the leaves and petals of trees into nectar,
Holder of the accomplishment of the various grain crops,
Ripen into fruit the karmic share of those who tend you.
Goddess of firm stability, mistress of power,
Through whom juices and essences become nectar,
Holder of the accomplishment of the great molten nectar,
Make firm the karmic share of those who tend you.
Vajra goddess of crystal hue,
You who turn the rays of the sun into nectar,
Holder of the accomplishment of clarity and radiance,
Bring forth splendor in the karmic share of those who tend you.
Goddess of wrathful frown, deep blue,

You who turn the substances of the charnel ground into nectar,
Holder of the accomplishment of the various great meats,
You who send down blessings on the karmic share of those who tend you.
Goddess of elixirs, Intelligent One,
You who turn the elixir harvest into nectar,
Holder of the accomplishment of all supreme elixirs,
You who satisfy the karmic share of those who tend you.
Goddess of medicine, stream of wealth,
You who turn poisons into nectar,
Holder of the accomplishment of nectar medicine:
All these karmic shares of those who tend you,
Relying on the vajra song,
As the articles of Mahāyoga,
Enjoy them in a festival of music!"

Then, at this stage of the activity,
With the Dharma mudrā of Yama,
Who abides by the command, conforming within and without,
Bring him under control to do the work of a servant
And empower him to guard the outer boundary.
Whether in relief, cast, or drawn,
Whatever likeness has been made,
Outside the door of the outer courtyard
Place it upon a buffalo throne,
Please him with the suitable substances,
And then charge him with these words:

"From the palace of great secret spontaneous presence,
From the palace of Yama of karma,
The Blessed One, the Lord of Dharma, has declared:
Likewise, when the vidyādhara practitioner
Accomplishes this great scripture of the secret word
And enters with certainty into the true meaning,
These are precious jewels.
All who oppose and obstruct it,
The eight classes of gods and demons, and all bhūtas,
Are your retinue and servants,
So pronounce on them the Dharma of karmic maturation!

Until the yogin of the supreme secret
Has attained the unsurpassed result,
Do not let them pass beyond this ground;
Do not transgress the command of the Great Glorious Invincible One.
We are nondual from the very beginning,
One in the expanse of meaning just as we are.
At the outer border that you guard,
Hold firm to the vajra pledge!"
vajra yama rāja samaya stvaṃ
With this, Yama is bound by oath and commanded;
Should he transgress, he himself will burn.
The great activity that is to be undertaken,
The support that brings forth accomplishment,

Of the great mudrā and the supreme form,
Is accomplished when the platform has been well prepared.
For the materials compounded of colored powders,
Which serve to guide through symbols,
I shall explain the maṇḍala of images;
I shall explain it, examining each kind in turn.
In a small chamber, stable and smooth-surfaced,
Make a form in five colors,
In relief, evenly proportioned and tall in stature;
That bestows the accomplishment of signs.
If, on tree bark, on cloth, or on the shroud
Of the charnel ground, the great field, one draws in five colors
The blazing form of the mudrā deity,
That too is a support from which signs arise.
From materials such as stone and crystal,
Conch or ivory,
When the skilled have carved it in relief,
It becomes a support from which signs arise.
From materials such as gold, silver and jewels,
Copper, iron and bronze,
If a craftsman casts it without flaw,
That too becomes a support for signs.
From the plakṣa, the bodhi tree and the like,

From the supple branches of trees of good lineage,
If that form of the mudrā deity is well fashioned,
That too the learned declare to be a support.
On the finest of soft and pliant materials,
Well fashioning the face and the rolled folds,
If one makes the form of the great mudrā,
That too becomes fit to be a support.
On materials such as these,
Write upon the substance syllables, or emblems and signs,
Or names, or drops;
When accomplished, it becomes a support for signs.

Of these, what is explained here for now
Is how the signs that rest on the platform
Are examined and taken up for the sake of accomplishment.
The method of undertaking it is this:
On the materials mentioned above,
Make the platform beautiful and level,
Square on all sides with equal portions,
And with a compound of the five nectars
Make its center like a mirror.
With substances that are manifest and arisen, truly blessed,
Substances of self-arisen wisdom, accomplished,
In the marvelous palace of the secret command,
Smear and anoint it with the five substances of the charnel ground.

I shall explain in detail
The rite of laying out the lines with the vajra cord.
Secret willow fibers twisted many times,
Vajra threads and the like,
Long or short, for the encircling of the maṇḍala,
Not tangled into knots,
Triple-twisted, even, and of proper measure,
Are clear as the nature of the five wisdoms.
The method for blessing that material:
From the radiating and gathering of the two syllables
Of skillful means and wisdom joined,
Golden garlands of white and red light radiate.

Now, by the secret vajra method,
The consort who draws forth the bodhicitta and spins the thread
Is examined with certainty and taken here.
The secret consort, auspicious and endowed with the marks,
Has long eyebrow lines and slender fingers;
Her joints and eyes are said to be rounded and fine.
From her mouth rises the fragrance of the utpala,
And her body has the scent of camphor and sandalwood.
Lovely, endowed with the marks, narrow at the waist,
Her hair is soft and deep blue, coiling to the right.
Her teeth are white and close-set, her lips both white and red.
Her eyes are long, her eyebrows finely drawn,
Her eyes like a blooming flax flower.
Her forehead is broad, her hairline curving;
Her nose is fine, her complexion clear: she is of the lotus family.
Her body is straight, her neck long, with the bearing of a heroine.
Her breasts are high and full like the full moon.
Her flesh is fair and firm, inclined to embrace.
She is unhurried within, and her steps are gentle when she walks.
Her voice calls like a young goose.
She has a graceful bearing in every way.
The supreme man takes her as his consort.

As for blessing her as the consort:
In five places of the consort's aggregates,
The five seeds of the sugatas
Become clear through radiating and gathering;
Blessed and empowered by the buddhas,
The supreme bodies of the five sugata consorts become clear.
So too for the vajra father.
When they have become clear in this way,
Meditate on a fire mountain in the consort's space.
In the secret crescent moon of the breath,
Radiate and gather the bodhicitta.
Just as a reflection appears clearly,
So it is in the consort's space.
Then, with these vajra words,
Instruct the consort of the body with certainty:

"Wisdom goddess, secret consort,
Great magical woman who transforms into all desires,
In the manner of passion you bow to skillful means,
Entwining on the left and embracing on the right,
Joining the crescent moon with the radiance of your smile,
Drawing forth the secret bodhicitta.
You, goddess, are a child of the Victor,
Endowed with the marks of the nature of things;
Since you are the consort of vajra activity,
Perform all the secret activities!"

In the palace of the wheel of the hand,
Arrange an assembly of blazing sun and moon,
And set this secret white and red bodhicitta
As the essence of drops and syllables.
With the mudrā of the vajra dance
Of the blazing karma vajra,
Draw out this line of bodhicitta!
Draw out this secret vajra activity!
Perform this secret vajra activity!
Through the application of the secret method
Called oṃ candradhara hrī,
With the drop of the blazing supreme substance,
Make the drop of the secret method
In the palaces of the five places.
When that application of the cord is complete,
Lay out this vajra line of the Middle Way,
Free from the faults of deviation, obscuration, eternalism and nihilism,
Neither too large nor too small, without crookedness.

In the palace of the dharmadhātu,
On the open maṇḍala beyond reference,
As the lines of the five wisdoms radiate,
There is the assembly of the mudrās of great bliss and liberation.
In the palace of the space of the all-ground,
On the maṇḍala of afflicted thoughts,
As the lines of the light rays of samādhi radiate,
There is the assembly of the blazing vajra mudrās.
In the secret palace of the expanse of space,

From the maṇḍala of the crescent moon and lotus,
As the lines of bodhicitta radiate,
There is the assembly of radiant wisdom beings.
In the palace of auspicious solitude,
On the maṇḍala that supports the signs,
As the lines of the vajra cord radiate,
The miraculous images, the mudrā deities, blaze.
When the marvelous vajra line is stretched out
In the secret maṇḍala of the trichiliocosm,
For one who abides by the secret pledge,
Against bhūtas and vile beings,
From the long hūṃ of vajra power
A storm of vajra weapons whirls.
The directions, intermediate directions, above and below are filled with wrathful ones.
Seizing the blazing secret boundary,
Cut off the disruptions of the outsiders.
The assembly of blazing vajra weapons,
Fierce in burning and crushing,
Is to strike here with the vajra tongue.

In the vajra palace of the sun,
The yogin should lay down the line of light of the vajra śrīvatsa,
Having the nature of mirror-like wisdom.
Likewise, in the blazing jeweled palace,
And in the immeasurable sky palaces
Of the lotus, the moon and the wheel,
The yogin should lay down the line of light of the śrīvatsa of each family,
Having the nature of the four wisdoms.
In vajra space turn the wheel.
With the four pairs of skillful means and wisdom
Each stationed at its own hand,
At the heart of the center of space,
Snap the four cords crosswise.
Then the vajra ground of stability,
The ninth palace, the central one,
And, with the great line of the vajra cord,

All the places where the mudrā deities reside

Should be made even, neither too large nor too small.
Here there are seven vajra enclosures;
Up to the sixth stage of the elements,
Six stacked wheels blaze at the core.
At the cut corners and between the spokes, fire mountains radiate.
Three rings of enclosure form garlands of blaze,
Adorned by four intermediate courtyards and an outer courtyard,
And nine doors rise in clear tiers toward the east.
In each place of that palace,
The forms of the mudrā deities appear thus:
Out to the very last enclosure,
The sixty-four fathers and mothers,
Their measureless miracles and samayas,
Their play, the Terrifier and the Great Terrifier,
Are to be drawn on kacali and the like.
Likewise the four devouring fathers and mothers,
The deities of activity, the Herukas,
Are to be placed on the spokes of the last wheel.
The mudrā deities of the sacred places and lands
Are to be arranged outside and inside the cut corners.
The fathers and mothers of the ten great Hūṃ deities,
Very beautiful, are on the first;
On that same one, the eight mothers
And the eighteen great kiṅkaras are to be set out in full.
In the second courtyard, the eight ḍākinīs,
And likewise the eight swift-goers.
In the third courtyard, draw the eight phramen
And likewise the eight blazing goddesses.
In the fourth courtyard, the eight cup-bearers,
And likewise the eight rākṣasīs bearing troughs;
They are to be drawn beautiful in every way.
In the fifth courtyard, the last,
Arrange in full the vajra attendants, the maidservants,
The messengers and the rest.
As for setting them out in the proper way:

The ones above are drawn from the materials,
On kacali and the like,
According to what one can afford.
All the articles of offering
And the marvelous supreme substances
Are to be arranged in the vajra secret sequence.
Having opened the vajra secret door
And completed the whole maṇḍala of samādhi,
Bring it down from its natural domain
And complete it there in the maṇḍala of accomplishment.

Here too, by a distinction of meaning,
Raising them to the ground of the great vidyādharas:
On the special seat of the east,
A wheel borne up by vajra lions,
With moon and sun to the right and left
Serving as footrests, the maṇḍala
Where the Vajra King, father and mother, sits.
On the special seat of the south,
A wheel borne up by vajra elephants,
With lotuses to the right and left serving as footrests,
Where the Vajra Victor, father and mother, sits.
On the special seat of the north,
A crossed vajra borne up by lotus and vajra,
Where Vajrakarma, father and mother, sits.
In the west, or in a direction or another intermediate direction,
Where the bases have become one,
On an unbroken maṇḍala
Filled and linked with vajras,
A lotus blazes greatly on one side,
Wreathed in the light of blazing colors.
By the distinction of greater or lesser capacity,
For some, whether fortunate or not,
The sign of the seat
Is a full moon.
And again, according to greater or lesser capacity,
Some are marked with a three-pointed vajra,

Some are marked with a half vajra,
Some are to be marked with a crescent moon not yet full,
Its opening shown facing inward.
Some are marked with a piercing point,
Some are marked with stacked lotuses,
And for some there is no mark.
Some do not sit upon that seat;
The long human substance of a person
Is arranged as a means for each one's comfort.
To make it comfortable in every way,
It is known as the pipar cushion,
Arranged so that it fully supports the body in comfort.

In the marvelous maṇḍala of accomplishment,
Perform the activities of entering,
Of requesting accomplishment,
And of empowerment.
For accomplishing what is desired,
The substances such as torma
Are divided into three portions:
One for the supreme activity of the fire offering,
One as a treasure of the enjoyments of yoga,
And one to nourish the retinue and assembly of ḍākinīs.
At the site, with auspicious verses and the like,
When the accomplishment is complete, bring it to a close.

In the very expanse of the supreme secret charnel ground,
The nine stacked maṇḍalas are the seal of glory;
The inner space of the nine wisdoms is clear;
The lines and cords of fire-mountain light are laid down.
The ground where the great gathering of the wheel is accomplished,
The abode of those with supreme yogic power:
That root maṇḍala of accomplishment
Is the sūtra of the supreme secret charnel ground.

This was the twelfth chapter, on the method of accomplishment of the Great Gathering Assembly, from the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness.

Then the sublime Sattvavajra declared: "Assembly of the Great Assembly, if all vidyādharas wish to attain accomplishment with certainty, they should understand it thus:

Likewise, when all has been completed,
Distinguish these particulars of family,
And accomplish in each one's own family.
For the Vajra Holder, the śrīvatsa,
And the maṇḍala is a blazing vajra.
Likewise for the jewel, a jewel,
And for the red lotus, a center of light.
For activity, a crossed vajra blazing on all sides.
Likewise the jewel blazes as a wheel.
Set each family as the principal,
And the retinue likewise, unchanged;
Having arranged them and applied them well,
Accomplish completely the approach and the close approach,
The accomplishment and the great accomplishment.
As for the particulars of the power of samādhi:
Whatever one's own family may be,
On its many particular samādhis
Make the application of mind clear.
By that, whatever vidyādhara state is desired
And prayed for will certainly be accomplished."
Thus he spoke.

This was the thirteenth chapter, on accomplishing the vajra vidyādhara, from the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness.

Then again Sattvavajra said: "Assembly of the Great Assembly, all phenomena should be understood as without acceptance or rejection.

In the nature of the equality of the nature of reality,
There are no words that conceive of good and bad;
There is no division into self and other,
And no duality of pure and impure."
Thus he spoke.

Then many vidyādharas bearing human skulls, who were gathered in that retinue, rose in array from their rows of yoga, uttered the great sound alala ho,

and said, "We wish to abide fully in what the Blessed One has declared, yet the Blessed One has not spoken of our samayas."

The Blessed One declared, "You bearers of human skulls, take courage and offer your samayas, each as it pleases you."

Then the vidyādhara of desire, the brahmin bearer of a human skull called Melody of Vajra Ash, said this: "Blessed One, our samaya is this:

Mother, sister, daughter,
All the women of the world
Of moving and unmoving beings, every one:
Whatever passion of desire one may enjoy with them,
If one understands correctly, one is not stained."
So he said.

Then the vidyādhara called Rakṣa, bearer of a human skull, said this:

"Blessed One, my samaya is this:
I delight in killing.
Having killed all sentient beings,
To eat the defilements, the impure dregs,
Human flesh and all the rest, everything,
Is the supreme samaya,
And power and splendor will increase.
That is my samaya."
So he said.

Then again the yakṣa vidyādhara called Yakṣa, bearer of a human skull, said this: "Blessed One, my samaya is this:

Though one robs all the lords of men
Of everything they desire,
And steals gold and the like and enjoys it,
If one understands correctly, one is not stained,
And it becomes the supreme fulfillment of desire.
That is my samaya."
So he said.

Then again the tīrthika vidyādhara called Kāśyapa of the Matted Locks said this: "Blessed One, my samaya is this:

Having cut off human heads,
One should examine with awareness

And come to know their differences, good and bad,
And make use of those that bear the good signs:
White, with a goat's-hair crown and willow-like locks.
Whoever always wears these
Will accomplish every desire
And be able to vanquish every opponent.
Like a wish-fulfilling jewel,
Their virtues arise from this.
That is my samaya."
So he said.

Then again the brahmins who delight in flesh and the piśācī vidyādharas said this: "Blessed One, our samaya is this:

The flesh of cattle, dogs and horses,
Human flesh, elephant flesh and the rest:
All flesh is alike, neither pure nor defiled.
If one eats it, various virtues are accomplished.
That is our samaya."
So they said.

Then again the rākṣasī vidyādharas, the one called Blood Snatcher and the others, said this: "Blessed One, our samaya is this:

The warm blood
Of all living beings who have been slain,
If one drinks it, splendor will blaze.
That is our samaya."
So they said.

The goddesses, the nāginīs, the low-caste women and all the hosts of women said this: "Our samaya is this:

Dance and great songs
Are supreme among all things to rely on.
With the graceful ways and great movements of dance,
With the sweetness of song and the proclaiming of the meaning of its words,
We steal away all the faculties of the mind.
Engaging in sexual union as the means of reliance:
This is the samaya of delight;
It is our samaya."

So they said.

Then all those vidyādharas said this: "Blessed One, our common samaya is this:

Whatever white or black action one may do,
There is no difference or distinction
Of higher, middling or lower
In the result of its karmic maturation.
Likewise, in this there is no dispute
About happiness and suffering, or virtue and nonvirtue.
It cannot be cut with a sharp weapon.
Why? Because it is empty in seven ways,
For it is unobstructed.
Life, too, cannot be cut off or killed.
Why? Because this substance perishes anyway.
All actions of great evil,
Whether done by oneself or caused to be done by another,
If one gives gifts to beings
As many as the sands of the Ganges,
And likewise kills all beings
As many as the sands of the Ganges,
For one who understands correctly, the two are no different,
Just as dust and water
Do not cling to the sky.
Whoever has shame and scruple,
By holding to doubting thoughts,
Will fall into the great hell.
Those beings who torment their bodies
With practices of abstaining from passion and the like
Are of small understanding."
So they said.

Then the Blessed One Sattvavajra said this:
"How wonderful! Host of skull-bearers,
These words that you have spoken
Are words bound up in knots;
You will not become free of the burden.
Saying 'Correct, correct!'

Is the knot of correctness itself.
If you do not untie the knot,
You will not be released."

"Those who engage in the acts of passion,
If they engage in them under the power of passion,
Will migrate into its city
And become beings of that realm.
As for the great acts that transform perception,
If the mind slips under the power of hatred,
They are a mountain of evil
That makes one fall as a vidyādhara of slaughtering butchers.
Since the Victors are pure,
When the face of the Sugata, the Victor,
Is served with impurities
Of every various kind,
Then, through the maturation of that karma,
Seized by an incurable disease,
Will one not sink into the mire?
Food such as flesh and blood
Is a great food of rank stench;
On the bodies of those who eat it,
Bhūtas and gandharvas all gather
And draw out the stench, the taste and the essence.
If by this splendor and radiance fade,
Why then should one eat these things?
While the mind itself is a precious jewel,
To make use of another's jewel
Is a practice of taking the wrong by the wrong;
These are tight knots.
To say there is no difference between white and black actions
And to conduct everything in a mixed way
Is the perverse action of those without lineage or with lineage cut off;
Its result becomes a perverse realm.
In the acts meant to please the Sugatas,
If limbs and words are not pure,
Through that cause, the act of wrongdoing,

At all times
One's faculties and limbs will be incomplete
And the heart of mindfulness will decline.
If the yogin who holds awareness,
Meditating on and reciting the Sugata, the Victor,
Takes it there as a mere sign,
Like the display of a miraculous wrathful manner,
He is a vidyādhara of the rākṣasas of karma.
If all ornaments and attire
Are conceived as mere signs,
They become a great stake of grasping
That conceives of and clings to everything.
If all the causal syllables,
Such as a and hūṃ,
Are conceived there as mere signs,
They are a great obstacle of conceptual thought
That makes one fall among the venomous snakes of the sandalwood tree and the like.
If the five great substances such as blood
Are conceived as real things in themselves,
Then whoever understands them there conceptually
Takes on a body of the kind that bhūtas have, stinking of blood,
In the fierce guise of the seven mothers:
Rākṣasīs and ugly piśācīs,
They wander in the land of Laṅkā.
Those whose ransom rites rest on signs, with effigy heads,
Fixating on 'Here it is strong, here it is seized,'
Will become the class of great predators that haunt the toll gates,
Grasping and conceiving in those places.
If the host of maidservants mighty in activity
Are conceived as being just so,
One will become one of the host of great yakṣiṇīs
Who harm the lives of others.
Therefore this great knot
Is a load carried as a burden;
Through corruption, the eye of the view is blind,
And that precious jewel of the mind

Will be lost in the realms of eternalism and nihilism.
Abandon such great faults!"

When he had declared this, the hosts of skull-bearers were seized by the perception of realization, and weariness with their own conduct arose in them. Then they said this to the Blessed One: "How wonderful, Blessed One! Since our samayas have turned into perverse austerities, and we wish to abide in true austerity: all phenomena are like illusions and can become anything at all. The door of the great secret mantra is like the fire mass at the end of the eon. Please explain it according to each of our conceptions and according to our inclinations."

The Blessed One laughed with great delight and said, "Sons of good family, it is good that you ask in this way. Listen well! Without forbidding your conduct, each of your intentions shall be satisfied as it pleases you; the inconceivable conduct of the world, bound to signs, shall be made into the great austerity of secret mantra. Without restraining your own conduct, act with your three doors at ease."

Then Sattvavajra again said this:
"Oh! Host of skull-bearers,
Women, all women without exception,
Are the support of generation
And also the field where the fruit ripens.
They are the place of liberating and drawing forth,
And the object of the joy of wisdom.

In this three minds abide:
The mind of the nature of reality, pure from the very beginning;
The mind of awakening, united with space;
And liberation through compassion. Joining these three,
The secret nature of reality pervades like the rising sun.
Liberation through compassion is joined by three:
By samādhi, by blessing, and by wisdom,
One liberates into space, the charnel ground of the nature of reality.

From the supreme cause of liberation on down,
The great crystal, the tsara, and the rest,
In these plant the seeds of the six causes,
And destroy them as they are, in their primordial nature.

The five syllables beyond all distinction,
Set in their places and radiating, fill the limitless.
Having emptied and exhausted everything,
They shine clearly as the five gathered syllables.
From them the hand emblems, the five wisdoms,
Dissolve into the state of non-abiding wisdom.
That which has ripened into an aggregate of obscuration
Should be joined, by the fierce host of vajra play,
With dance steps in the manner of drawing forth.
With the khaṭvāṅga and the rest, together with mantras,
Strike it down and open the door of ignorance.
Draw the consciousness out of the box of breath,
Gather it into the wind box of the Vajra King,
And for the one with vajra breath
Make hūṃ and blend it into that rolled pellet.
In the maṇḍala of the secret mind
Dissolve it as light a span in size.
Kindle it with yuti ahaṃ;
If it is clear, it shines together with that.
Blend it with vajra life.
With vajra wind kindle the breath,
And from the heart join it to the path of the wind box.
In the celestial palace of the Dharma, space,
Upon a sun it shines as hūṃ.
The wisdom being, a span in size,
Shines within the amulet box of sun and moon.
The a as well, propelled and hurled by phaṭ,
Radiates into the heart of Vajrasattva.
As it shines as the wisdom being,
Free of grasping at appearances as real things,
While moving, stirring, leaping and quivering do not cease,
Confer the vajra name empowerment,
And give the deity of the family and its heart mantra.
Singing the vajra song of longing,
Make the aspiration of the place of the pith instruction.

Having cut it cleanly into four parts,
Apply medicine and search through the remains.
Gather those aggregates of saṃsāra,
And purify them with vajra steps and song.
Dedicate them to each of the sacred places,
And dissolve the aggregates into offering substances.
Perform the vajra rites of bra.
By this come pleasing and fulfilling,
And the vajra activities are accomplished.

The yogin, great lord of activity,
From the lofty, pure snowy recess of wisdom,
With the claws of awareness, sharp and rending,
Destroys the elephant of pride and arrogance.
You lion cubs, yogins of full-grown prowess,
By training in this great vajra prowess,
The support to which the supreme deities of yoga come,
The jewel from which accomplishments arise,
The great means by which power and strength are born,
By this supreme empowerment through which blessings descend,
From the accomplishment of the Victors on down,
All the miracles of the ḍākinīs,
And the classes of savage, haughty spirits,
Since all of them will surely come under your power,
What need is there to speak of other bhūtas?

On the great dry island of saṃsāra,
The sentient beings circling through the six classes,
Their consciousness and life passed through the six streams,
Since they are slain by the weapon of the three times,
From the corpse island of those who died in the extremes of permanence and annihilation,
Taking up the great rotting corpse of delusion,
With wisdom, the great medicine of amṛta,
Taking up the corpses from the extremes of permanence and annihilation,
In order that they may shine as the mind of awakening,
One should seek the substances of the corpse.

Taking oneself to be the fierce wrathful host,
From within the blazing vajra eyes

Great lions of dark blue hūṃ
Are emanated into the realm of the corpse island of saṃsāra.
All the charnel grounds of liberation without exception
Should be seen as fields of the play of wisdom.
With the throwing techniques of the wrathful wrestlers,
In the fierce manner of great majesty,
Apply the sidelong gait of the vajra hero,
And apply the eighteen great methods as dance steps.
With the gait of the method of drawing forth,
Gaze warily and frolic;
Change the voice and shout he he;
Be fierce in fighting and contending.
Gaze in the stance of a female yak and act as one startled;
Look to the right and turn to the left;
Not trusting, look back again;
With angry eyes look all around to either side.
Run and go with the vajra gait;
Cry out the fierce sound ha ha ru lu;
Utter each its own symbolic call,
And leap and run in the manner of a kicking beast.

Having opened the great wish-fulfilling treasure,
That heap of jewels that grant all desires,
Having torn out by the root the ripening of saṃsāra,
Having shaken out for good the three great poisons,
With the gaping maw of fierce compassion
And the great host of blazing vajras,
Having reaped the harvest of accomplishments as well,
Without mistaking the direction the vajra face is turned,
Hold the secret place with two crystal daggers.
Upon the base of the one who is surely dead,
Kick it a little and turn it about.
By whichever way the face looks, examine good and bad.
That very good or ill outwardly
Is sure to be clearly shown within.
If signs of fault arise, the learned suppress them.

If one raises the matter by questioning,
To clear away the doubts about it:
Those who have entered conduct with real things
Put these conceptions about signs
To me, the lord of desire, bound by the command of Bhairava:
"Explain what was spoken,
And make clear the substances of signs.
Protector of the world, listen to me!
We shall ask about our conduct."

"Through the good or bad characteristics of the vessel,
Fault and good arise from this.
The signs of defect are sevenfold:
Lying face down, and moving from its seat;
The lineage not increasing, and cracking at the seams;
Hindrances arising, and obstructors rising up;
And bad signs appearing.
The learned never hold to these.
The causes of good are eleven:
Attaining the accomplishments of the three;
Going on the path of the vidyādharas and flying in the sky;
Bringing the three realms under power; the vajra eye;
Turning back enemy armies and overpowering them with splendor;
Power and blessing; increase of life;
Clear signs appearing;
The lineage of disciples increasing like water;
The intended aim being accomplished;
Swift buddhahood hereafter;
And attaining the three kinds of accomplishment:
It is accomplished in accordance with one's aspiration.
Moreover, the particulars are these:
If it turns out half, that is the share obtained;
With only a third, it is neutral."

Moreover, as for their individual marks and signs,
Which are to be examined and named:
The white one is the Dharma body free of elaboration;
The one with locks, complete in all, is endowed with enjoyment;
It is the stream of future emanation deeds.

The family of those of past, present and future
Who go to the grounds of yoga
Is the sign that the sugatas of the three times appear.
This amulet box of a treasure of jewels,
King of methods, wealth of glory,
Palace endowed with signs, complete as vessel and contents,
Magical face, a wish-fulfilling cow that yields all desires,
Supreme one that goes through the sky without legs,
Wondrous, with a palate that resounds,
Its marvelous secret self-sounds
Proclaim to all the vidyādharas of prowess:
"Since I am the marvelous substance of practice
Of the supreme being of prowess,
Whoever wants whatever accomplishment,
Take it now, without doubt!
Those who do not act according to the command,
Whoever does not abide by the commitments,
Will be burned merely by seeing my form,
And destroyed merely by hearing my sound."
The miracle of this sound arising
Resounds from all the palaces of the Victors.
Use these in keeping with their meaning.

The definitive meaning of what is thus renowned
Should be known by yogins:
All are glorious and bear locks.
Some have auspicious marks,
And likewise there is the paṃcakula.
Some are the naśa of examination,
Likewise unchanging and hard.
The mahākesa is endowed with glory,
And is called endowed with the five wisdoms.
The āyuḥphala is supreme for life.
Some are the mele debyi, stable;
Some likewise the khasvakha,
Endowed with the glory of the khahupa.
Such are those from which auspicious aims arise.

It is complete, endowed with the marks of the Sugata.
The crown knot, the virtuous crown, is endowed with glory,
And so is the jñānamurtti.
Some are the jñānakuṇḍali,
Likewise the wrathful kuṇḍali.
The ekajaṭi is endowed with marks,
And the abimuka is complete.
Stable in desire, it gives rise to bliss;
The meaningful nondual is attained.
The putra increases greatly; the Slender Sapling flourishes.
The vajra lacquered bowl, complete in its marks,
The crystal bowl from which the secret aim arises,
The kapāla of spontaneously present body and speech,
Fulfills all hopes as one wishes.
Likewise one complete in qualities is complete in all.
One that has all the auspicious marks
Is likewise the unchanging, stable svastika,
An indestructible treasury, the source of all.
The sublime one that brings forth signs of miracles appears;
It is supreme for the rite of wholly liberating existence,
Special for bringing the three realms under power,
And supreme for the rite that shakes out the six and the three for good.

The definitive meaning, free of the elaborations of signs:
The six classes, the six colors and the six shapes,
And the qualities and faults, should be matched together.
The secret of many and few:
Increase of the white with its accompaniments, and the head not appearing.
Avoid faults such as imitations.
The word of the Victors that empties the three poisons
Is the svastika sign that ripens the three bodies.
This secret pith instruction on the means of concealment
Is for fortunate yogins.
For all the unfortunate it is the māra of conceptual thought;
How could those who grasp mere names rely on it?
The learned examine and rely on what is good.
As for the great times when accomplishment arises,

One and three are taught as the best;
Likewise five and seven are known as middling;
Nine is the lowest accomplishment,
And from eleven onward it is said to fade away.
Therefore yogins of prowess
Should strive diligently and examine.
Thus spoke the lord of desire.

Because they are signs, they are certain in that;
In order to accord with those attached to signs,
By skillful means act in accord with them,
And steer them toward the true meaning.
To purify them thoroughly,
Drawing in the minds of the six classes of beings, who are greatly distracted,
And having them rely on it,
These are words that join them to the aim of skillful means:
On the ground where the six causes gather,
With the play of song, dance and performance,
Overpowering the three realms of existence and bringing them under power,
One should engage in conduct that accords with the world.
For example, in the world systems,
Beings tame beings:
One enters into the activity they enjoy,
And by acting in harmony with their intentions,
Becomes familiar with them and pleases them.
Then, having won their warmth,
These are the words that change their way of perceiving:
"Before, my friend, my entering into your activity
Was a great mistake.
Count here the accumulation of wrongful deeds.
Though it was wrong, I pleased you.
Now, in this activity that pleases me,
You, my friend, must fully engage."
By doing so, since their former mind has been won,
Their later mind is held as well,
And they enter into the activity that pleases.

The activity of conduct is as follows:
Upon the aggregate in which the six causes gather,
The vajra sign that destroys the abodes of the lower realms,
The melodious song of wisdom and skillful means,
Words proclaiming the marvelous great secret.
On the ground of the five afflictions,
Since the syllables of the five wisdoms shine forth,
Like banks of clouds of blazing blood-drinking herukas,
They play with the steps of the five bulls,
The fierce song of the lion's roar,
Words proclaiming the supreme vajra meaning.
The meaning of marvelous play has come forth:
How wonderful! Marvelous and greatly amazing!
From the blessing of play in delight,
The six streams are cut at the root; greatly wondrous!
From the sky of great equality
The blazing fire of wisdom arose,
And so the ocean of the blood of saṃsāra dried up,
And suffering was brought to exhaustion in the expanse.

From the non-abiding expanse, as a miraculous display,
It blazes in the very essence of fierce and terrifying turmoil.
As clouds of blazing blood-drinkers radiate,
The lake of blood of the three realms of existence is scorched dry.
The steps of the hero, the majestic wrestler;
The wrathful song of the rākṣasa Matraṃ;
The marvelous secret words of the Great Vehicle:
The tethering stake of attachment is pulled out from its depths.
From the blissful expanse of the sphere of the four spaces
Miracles in a hundred thousand clusters radiate.
From the enlightened activity of supremely delighted play,
Some play in wisdom and skillful means;
Some play in the activity of compassion;
Some play in the domain of those to be tamed;
Some play in the expanse of wisdom.
The empowerment of realizing the king of methods,
Through the distinction of the greatness of scripture,
Joins one equally with all the Victors.

The steps of vajra and lotus play;
Words shining in unattached space;
The song that overpowers the three poisons:
In order to purify the world step by step,
Play arose in the world systems.
They play in the heart of the six worlds.
Having overpowered the lord and chief,
The retinue is attended with pleasing words.
Having cut the continuum of the five paths of saṃsāra,
One blends into the state of liberation, space.
The supreme dance moves like lightning.
From the marvelous secret maṇḍala
Miracles of blazing syllables radiate.
From their turbulent radiating and gathering, like stars,
The three realms are reduced, like firewood, to ash.
The steps of the vajra whirlwind and the shooting star;
The song of the great vajra dragon thundering;
The secret words of the vajra that accomplishes the aim:
The armies of the vicious are utterly destroyed.
From the maṇḍala of vajra emanation
Clouds of the mind of awakening, which is skillful means, are sent forth.
Through the special quality of the attachment that magnetizes,
They play with the six maidens of the world.
The steps of the lion's play;
The vajra song of changing calls;
Words that cut attachment at the root:
This is the great meaning of vajra play.
From the maṇḍala of the blazing wheel
Syllables of blazing weapons radiate.
The very essence of the six causes is cut at the root;
The heap of the five poisons is scattered.
The great weapon of the sharp blade of wisdom
Radiates from the expanse where the nature of reality is spread out.
From the force and power of the wealth of supreme skillful means,
Blazing weapons fall like rain.
The rain of syllables, the weapons of wisdom,
Should be made to fall by the force of the vajra tongue.

The enjoyments of the treasure of jewels:
In order to destroy the mountain of conceptual thought
And demolish the heap of the three poisons,
The wheels, the hooks and the rest,
The supports, the great secret, the supreme sesame,
The refined essence and all the other doors,
Having divided them into their respective portions,
As the share allotted to each task
Of purifying afflictions through compassion,
Set out the mudrās, each in its own place.
When it has thus been completed,
Of a size like all the maṇḍal,
In the center, four lines and nine compartments;
Around the perimeter make the eight spokes of a wheel.
On it, four gates together with their gate surrounds;
Draw the mountains of fire of the eon that ends all.
In the center draw the white and the red in union.
In the eight directions and intermediate directions draw eight khaṃ.
On the circular border between the wheel's spokes
Clearly draw eight khaṃ facing inward:
Eight facing inward on the spokes,
And on the eight borders, eight facing outward.
On the four corners, facing inward,
Four kinds of bindu should be drawn.
On the outer courtyards between them,
Twenty-eight bindus
Facing outward should be drawn.
On the fire courtyard of the great eon,
Clearly draw ten bindus facing outward.
On it set out the mudrās in order.
At the gate of the maṇḍal, one great corpse,
Thoroughly purified with song, dance and performance,
Is placed in the center and turned to face the east.
Its aggregates as the celestial palace,
Generated from bhuṃ, should be visualized clearly.
There meditate on the great host of mudrās.
On each of the places of the substances,

Set out the deities of the families in order.
Then perform the vajra approach.
When the signs of the descent of blessing and the indications are satisfied,
Liberate that corpse in the northeast corner.
Having dedicated the substances one by one,
In the places where the mudrās reside,
Set them out and join them again without error.
On the nine glorious vessels
Arrange the nine marvels,
And in each place of great blazing
Meditate on them clearly in a majestic manner.
Set out the other mudrās completely as well.
In the maṇḍala of complete wisdom
Spread out the mighty crescent moons and hosts of stars.
The indestructible vajra blazes ninefold.
Through the distinction of the nine greatnesses,
The nine great glorious ones are complete in the body;
The nine great mothers play in the expanse;
The nine śrīvatsas blaze in the heart;
The nine great elements swirl in the expanse;
The nine cuckoos complete their own calls;
The nine bandha are endowed with glory;
The nine crescent moons are the mother's expanse;
The nine bindus are the mind of awakening;
The nine suns and moons blaze, radiating light.
Thus shining clearly in nines upon nines,
The nine expanses of a single bhaga,
And nine closed, one opened: the meaning of the bindu.
Making all abundance flourish,
Join from nine corpses onward as medicine.
Take the accomplishments of the substances and make use of them.

Thus spoke the Blessed One Sattvavajra.

This is the fourteenth chapter, on the marvelous substances, from the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness.

Then again Sattvavajra spoke thus: "The host of the Great Assembly should know and understand all phenomena directly. What is direct? It is knowing

directly, by making mindfulness present, all phenomena that do not abide in objects, all phenomena that will arise later, and all phenomena that arose before. Why is that? Because knowing directly is the cause of great wisdom. And how is that? If one makes mindfulness present of all phenomena as having the nature of an illusion, that is unerring knowledge of the nature of reality made manifest. When the nature of reality unerringly becomes manifest, that is great non-abiding wisdom itself. Therefore, attend to the higher knowledges with mindfulness, directly!"

When he had said this, the great sages of the awareness of higher knowledge (abhijñā) said: "Blessed One, higher knowledge is our commitment. Blessed One, please explain our commitments." To this request, the Blessed One declared: "Great vidyādharas, the higher knowledges, the cause of great wisdom, should be known to be fivefold.

From all the eye faculties
Make a finely ground powder.
Having mixed it into the essence of the elixir,
If one recites the heart mantra of seeing a hundred thousand times,
One will see everything without exception.
This is the higher knowledge of the eye.
The words spoken with the vajra tongue
Should be recited at the proper times or continuously.

vajra cakṣu garbha vidyā hūṃ.
All the ear faculties, too,
Having ground them or made them into powder,
Mix into the essence of the elixir;
If one recites the heart mantra of hearing a hundred thousand times,
One hears all the varieties of sound.
This is the higher knowledge of the ear.
Its examination in vajra words is:
vajra garbha stam si ho.
All the nose faculties, every one,
Having dried them or made them into powder,
Mix into the essence of the elixir;
Having blended them with various fragrances,
If one recites the heart mantra of sensation a hundred thousand times,
One will attain the higher knowledge of the nose.
What is to be held in vajra words is:

vajra na ma si taṃ hūṃ.
All the tongue faculties, every one,
Having dried them or made them into powder,
Mix into the essence of the elixir;
From the supreme of flavors and the rest,
Recite the heart mantra of taste a hundred thousand times.
The maṇḍala of the tongue that speaks:
On a square platform one cubit in size,
In the center draw the secret vajra,
And surround its edge with the lotus of the tongue.
From the tongue rays of light of words radiate.
When this is completed through the practice of speech,
The faculty of speech opens,
And one comes to know all flavors.
This is the higher knowledge of the tongue.
Its examination in vajra words is:
vajra pāśa sityā hūṃ.
All the heart faculties, every one,
Having dried them or made them into powder as well,
Mix with the supreme essence,
And recite the heart mantra of mindfulness a hundred thousand times.
From the maṇḍala of the śrīvatsa, the citta,
Surrounded entirely by the supports of mindfulness,
When the maṇḍala of the heart is complete,
All the faculties become clear,
And one comes to know everything without exception.
This is the supreme knowledge of the minds of others.
vajra citta si dyā hūṃ.
All the body faculties, every one,
Having ground them or made them into powder,
Mix with the ten hard substances;
If one recites the heart mantra of touch a hundred thousand times,
One will attain the higher knowledge of the body.
When these higher knowledges are all complete,
They are the cause of great non-abiding wisdom.
Divination too should be done with the utmost care.

Thus he spoke.

This is the fifteenth chapter, called the method of accomplishing the awareness of higher knowledge, from the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness.

Then Sattvavajra spoke thus: "Host of the Great Assembly, the supreme great method of accomplishment should be understood as follows.

The yogin who strives for the aim
Should make a platform for the rite, broken in half,
Surrounded with lines of fire, and set it blazing.
The maṇḍal of that maṇḍala
Is made in three tiers, its center
Adorned with eight crescent moons.
Its outer edge is ringed with a garland of skulls;
Around that edge it is ringed with blazing masses of fire;
On its outer edge the great red offering is spread.
In the center of the crescent the great glorious one blazes.
On the eight crescents are the eight lords of places,
Dark blue, the yatha, blazing in mountains of fire.
Below that, three rows of skulls,
And the gate courtyards are ringed with substances of the charnel ground.
The tiered gates, the gate surrounds, and lastly the servants:
Arrange everything just as it should be.
When it has become perfectly complete,
Begin the maṇḍal of the four kinds of rites.
In the maṇḍala of the eon of Bhairava,
With the blazing mudrā of the devourer,
In order to liberate the tsara of liberation,
The one who holds the pith instruction and has gained warmth
Should establish the supreme blessing.
Having made the procedure straight through the three purities,
The supreme place is a solitary mountain peak,
Free of eavesdroppers and slanderers,
Where bustle and coming and going have ceased:
That is auspicious as a place for the conduct of the great secret.
Though the signs of the four kinds of rites be few,
If one or two are present, it is said to be middling.
The king of practitioners, endowed with confidence,

Very majestic and steadfast,
Free of hesitation and doubt, holding to the yogic discipline,
His garland of rites without excess or lack,
With fragrant, pure medicines
Washes the outside, and from the śi ne da hu
Makes the inside greatly pure.
Endowed with the command applied as valid authority,
He sets the time and begins in earnest.
And what is of great importance to examine is this:
One who is auspicious and becomes endowed with beauty,
Of full build and in the prime of youth,
Endowed with the marks of the five families,
Suitable as the substance for liberation:
Having sought one who is attractive and prosperous,
That one is made the substance of practice.
One who has such marks and signs
Has trained in the grounds and reached a ground.
As for those supreme causes of practice,
Beyond the hu and below, transform the faculties.
Having brought down the vajra diviner,
One should ask about all of appearance and existence,
Or ask about all that is good and bad.
In the maṇḍala of the five sense doors
Place the bindus of the five kinds of amṛta.
At the five doors from which consciousness arises
Place the substances that arise from each.
Seal each with the mudrā of its own family.
Having set out the mudrās, liberate the afflictions.
Having purified all that is liberated and joined,
Offering, pleasing and fulfilling the commitments,
Take whichever of the three kinds of accomplishment is attained.
Having attained them, use everything as one pleases."

Thus he spoke.

Then Sattvavajra again spoke thus: "Host of the Great Assembly, the great practice that turns back all that obstructs should be understood as follows.

Having begun the rite as above,
Those supreme causes of liberation,
The bones, are accomplished as vajra ash.
The whole mass of bones, every one,
Is burned and mixed with black tongue incense.
Placed inside a Viṣṇu amulet box with its lid joined,
Having accomplished it with the mudrā of destruction
And with wrathful mantras,
When it is accomplished, apply it as the remedy
That turns back the obstacles of the yogin who pursues the aim."

Thus he spoke.

This is the sixteenth chapter, on the sādhana of the great vajra ash, from the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness.

Then again Sattvavajra spoke thus: "Host of the Great Assembly, all the bra should be understood as follows.

On a single square maṇḍal,
With crescent moons and one gate, encircled by vajras,
Draw a border endowed with four gates.
The supreme cause, with half its faculties, is auspicious.
Having performed the outer ablutions,
Place it in the center, facing the east.
Tie a five-colored dhāraṇī cord to the tongue;
The yogins should circle around it.
Lay out the mudrās together with the substances.
Within it generate the celestial palace.
The maṇḍala stacked in tiers:
The five blazing ones, the blazing great elements,
Shine clearly as the five goddesses of meaning.
The ground of all shines clearly as Samantabhadrī.
At the very core of her heart,
On a bindu, a full moon,
The wisdom being, a span in size;
At its heart a precious jewel blazes.
In the center, in an amulet box of the sun,
In a śrīvatsa vase the size of a mustard seed,

A red hūṃ the size of a sesame seed abides:
It is called the mind of awakening of great bliss.
Do not cut the flow of the secret vajra cord.
Perform the vajra mouth divination.
Then, if signs have appeared,
Take the accomplishment and liberate it;
Dry it and make it the root of amṛta.

Thus he spoke.

This is the seventeenth chapter, on the method of accomplishing the lesser supreme through skillful means, from the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness.

Then again Sattvavajra spoke thus: "Host of the Great Assembly, all phenomena should be known to have the nature of an illusion. Why is that? An illusion, though it appears as a thing, is without intrinsic nature, and the meaning of being without intrinsic nature is the vajra of the nature of reality. Therefore all the phenomena of illusion should be understood."

Then the Gaṇapati of the asuras who had gathered in that assembly, called Māyākāra (the Illusionist), said this: "Blessed One, our commitment is to abide in the miraculous display of illusion and to make illusions deliberately. Therefore, for our sake, please explain all the phenomena of illusion."

To this request, the Blessed One declared: "Great Gaṇapati, the miraculous display of illusion should be understood as follows.

All phenomena appear as illusions;
The nature of illusion is emptiness;
And whatever the meanings of emptiness are,
They are the meaning of the unchanging, indestructible vajra.
Within emptiness many millions
Of miraculous displays of illusion arise.
Likewise, the miraculous displays of illusion too,
From mere trifling causes and conditions,
Appear as distinct miraculous forms.
Though they appear, they are not established as things;
Being without change or destruction, they are the meaning of vajra.
The characteristic of conventional illusion, too, is this:
From causes such as pebbles and sticks,

Conditions are joined by means of medicines and mantras,
And the result, the miraculous display of illusion, arises.
As for applying the secret words of illusion,
The lord of illusion explained it thus:
Make the desired form from the cause,
Apply the śeu reu medicine to it,
And perform the application of this secret mantra:
śeu reu i na ya
a mo kha a gussa gus.
If one strikes it with switches,
One may produce various things just as one wishes.
If one wishes to gather it back, reverse it.
Therefore those distracted by illusion
Should be guided by means that draw them in."

This is the eighteenth chapter, on the method of accomplishing the illusion vajra, from the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness.

Then again Sattvavajra spoke thus: "Host of the Great Assembly, if you wish to have power over all phenomena, understand it as follows.

Being endowed with every excellence,
On a platform square on all sides,
Encircled by a single border,
Join it in the shape of a full moon disk.
Provide it with four gates and four corners.
On the bindu, round in shape,
Encircle it with vajras and suns.
In the center, on a glorious bandha,
Place the Great Glorious One, father and mother in union.
On the eight segments set the eight places,
Circling the hub, placed in order.
At the eastern gate of the bindu,
Write the secret name of the vajra yogin
And the accomplishment to be requested, and place it there.
In what has become the offering courtyard,
Lay out the substances of practice and the offerings
Beautifully, in their proper order.

Those vajra yogins
Are marked with the sign of the vajra's descent.
Having completed the maṇḍala of samādhi,
Invite the deities and gather all the offerings;
Having completed the entry, the request for accomplishments,
And all the rites of empowerment,
The marvelous tormas
Are divided in three portions: the first is made into a fire offering;
The middle one is hidden as an inexhaustible treasure:
In the river of the mind of awakening,
In the great expanse of the space of the nature of reality,
And in the ground of the bhaga of the mother,
Place it in a manner that is well hidden.
For one portion, from the eastern gate of the palace,
Make a platform at a distance of thirteen measures.
There the chiefs of the seven places too,
Likewise once for each of the thirteen,
And the mothers and sisters, guests of the places,
Should all be completed, up to seventy.
Lastly, on the crescent maṇḍal,
If one is able, the sky offering of the ḍākinīs:
Complete it without remainder and please them.
Complete all that remains.
All that has become dregs
Hide, or burn, or cast into a river.
Guard that great vajra place;
In order to hide the place, keep it secret from all.
Since it is not fitting, the signs
Should go each to its own place.
Whenever they gather, it is likewise.
This is the method of accomplishing the single bindu,
So the Victor taught.
The person who accomplishes these,
Abiding on the wheel of the moon,
And holding aloft the wheel of the sun,
Becomes a king who has power
Over the true expanse of phenomena itself."

Thus he spoke.

Again Sattvavajra spoke thus:
"Yogins of the Great Assembly,
This too, step by step as above,
Having arranged everything properly,
On the outside, square on all sides,
Make a single moon bindu.
By crossing four threads upon it,
Make it into nine compartments.
Encircle the outer border with skulls,
And adorn the square and its corners with great beauty.
On the single courtyard at its outer edge,
The face of the gate looks toward the practitioner.
In the center, on the white and red bindus
In union, joined between by a vajra,
There the Great Glorious One, father and mother, resides.
On those eight outer compartments
Make eight outstretched crescent moons,
And set out the eight mothers of the places of wisdom.
On that outer courtyard with its single gate
Lay out the substances of practice beautifully.
What is to be visualized, the practice and all the rest,
Should all be applied here in the same way.
Whatever person accomplishes it in this way
Becomes a king of the Dharma;
He becomes a great being
Who has power over all things."

Thus he spoke.

Then again Sattvavajra spoke this, called "Mastery over All Miracles":

"Yogin of the Great Assembly,
Apply this too entirely in the same way.
Making it square on every side,
Make a wheel of eight spokes.
Outside its four corner sections
Furnish it with four gates.
The outer courtyard, an expanse of dark red mountains of fire,

Draw exceedingly majestic and terrifying.
On the heart at the center of the bindu
Mark it with a blazing crescent moon.
On the eight supreme spokes draw
Those eight crescent moons facing inward.
On the eight spaces between the spokes, the same;
And the four vajra gatekeeper goddesses.
Having laid out the mudrās in their order,
Complete all the activities of practice.
The yogin who accomplishes it thus
Becomes a king who holds mastery
Over all miracles, both worldly
And beyond the world."

Thus he spoke.

From the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness, this is the nineteenth chapter, called "Accomplishing the Bindu."

Then Sattvavajra spoke these words: "Yogins of the Great Assembly, if you wish to have mastery over all the hosts of the haughty ones, you should understand it as follows:

The activities of what is to be done and so forth,
With whatever wealth and excellence there is,
Skill in means and the implements,
Should be gathered here as one understands them.
Then, on something like a maṇḍala plate,
Make the charnel ground with a head as well.
At the four corners make four maṇḍalas,
And from the four, those four are praised in turn.
Make that same one in the form of a mātaṅga,
Crossed at the center from the heart downward,
And place it beneath the great maṇḍala.
Lay down the lines of a blazing wheel
And make the mudrās of the five Great Glorious Ones.
On that which is beautified by two courtyards
Set out the mudrās of the sacred places and lands.
At the four gates, the four vajra gatekeepers;

There stand the effigies of the emanated limbs.
Make the outer courtyard a vajra mountain of fire;
Outside it, fill it with great garlands,
And encircle it with ramparts, dry and moist.
Outside that, sparks of fire swirl;
Draw the whirlwind at the end of the aeon.
At the vajra gate-arches and gatehouses
Draw coils of guggulu and latticework,
Corpses and bundles of snakes.
Then, on a glorious skull bowl,
Write the letters of Vajraśrī,
Join it mouth to mouth, and set it face down.
On small amulet boxes draw
Eight matted-haired ones and place them in the place of the elements.
For eight or twelve agents,
Draw twelve agents and arrange them.
In the maṇḍala of the place of liberation,
The outcastes, the haughty bhūtas,
The cause of corruption by attachment and aversion:
In order to destroy their three poisons,
The great accomplishment of the meaning is taught.
The great host of the five Rudras,
Vanquished by the five wisdoms of samādhi,
Are thoroughly joined with vajra heat,
On the ground of the sūtra, at a single stroke.
The obstructors of obstructors, the great obstructors,
Are born from the five poisons, from conceptuality itself.
In the two and a half charnel grounds,
The base and root are speech, and body and mind.
Majestic Great Glorious One, lord of the charnel ground,
Through the samādhi that crushes self-conception and conception,
In the charnel ground of Rudra of the three realms of existence,
Make those eight great Gaṇapatis.
Opening the door of the dark house of ignorance,
Seizing that mad elephant,
Cut the tether rope of rigid apprehended and apprehender,
Pull out the tethering stake of the three poisons and conceptual thought.

Having drawn them out of the mire of the lower realms,
Having subdued that wild army of afflictions,
Thoroughly purified by wisdom and means,
In the expanse of space, without reference point,
The great hosts of offerings of great bliss,
Joined evenly with the five supreme tastes,
Spread out the enjoyment of the Dharma.
Through the compassion of equality and bliss,
To crush the great haughty ones
And to cut the net of saṃsāra,
Clouds of blazing wrathful hosts radiate,
Hosts fierce, short, terrifying and swift.
Having let fall a great rain of emissaries,
Having cast off the dust of saṃsāra,
Plowing the field of great bliss,
Making the sprout of awakening grow,
Raise the harvest of bodhisattvas.
As for the facing of the great charnel ground,
Its head is laid toward the southwest,
Its feet are laid toward the northeast.
I am the great Īśvara of the charnel ground,
The body of the buddhas, which is wisdom.
Against the army, with sharp compassion,
With the weapon of sharp wisdom,
I cut the stream of saṃsāra of wrong conception.
Having built a hearth, square with four sides,
Shaped like a vajra,
Make it the hearth of the wheel at the heart.
Stack up the kindling of the five families,
Build the great activity joined with the five homas.
In the homa pit of the five great means,
On the kindling of the suffering of saṃsāra,
In the fiery expanse of great wisdom,
Complete the burning and purifying of the five afflictions.
All the applications of the activities without exception
Should be done as resources allow and as is fitting."

Thus he spoke.

From the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness, this is the twentieth chapter, called "Suppressing the Haughty Ones."

Then again Sattvavajra spoke these words: "Host of the Great Assembly, the meaning of the practice called the Maṇḍala of the Mouth That Exhausts the Ocean of Saṃsāra should be understood as follows:

"Having applied this too entirely in the same way,
In a celestial palace with surrounding chambers,
Of the measure of one cubit, square,
The four are those surrounding chambers and courtyards:
Construct them in the four directions.
Strew sweet-smelling sandalwood and paste;
Fragrances, incense, heaps of jewels:
Set out these gifts and offerings in abundance.
The four kinds of divine lay devotees
Command to the tasks of guarding the directions and intermediate directions.
In the inner tier of the courtyard, in the directions and intermediate directions,
Ten half-sized platforms;
Draw the blazing mass of fire at the end of the aeon,
And, empowering ten suitable images
Made of various materials,
Seal the inner boundary with the dance of the wrathful ones.
Then Matraṃ is to be suppressed.
This haughty, sinful Rudra
Is ever a fit object for liberation.
jaḥ hūṃ baṃ hoḥ mahā śrī heruka matraṃ rudra ha ha phra be śa phaṭ
Having toppled him with the mudrā of the khaṭvāṅga,
Having opened the door of the darkness of ignorance,
Blessing his consciousness as the letter A,
Dissolve it into the expanse of the mind of the great secret.
Make the interior a blazing palace.
On the platform resembling the form of Matraṃ,
Set it toward whatever direction suits the manner of his toppling.
Its color blue-grey, in the manner of lying on his back,
Its size without fixed measure, adapted to the place.
At its heart, three tiers:

First build a red square,
Second make a dark blue triangle,
Third make a dark maroon crescent.
On the four limbs, the head and the genitals, six,
And the two secret openings, eight in all,
Eight half-sized square platforms.
On its outermost tier, all around,
Make a maṇḍala of clear crescent moons,
And surround them with blazing expanses of fire.
On top, upon the crescent moons,
The glorious supreme deity resides.
On the dark blue triangle draw a mass of fire.
On the red square tier
Place the glorious supreme deities of the four families.
On the eight, right and left, of the limbs, head and genitals,
The eight mistresses of the places of Īśvara:
Draw them, or else set down their symbols.
On the eight great joints, the eight lords of the lands:
Do as is fitting.
At the four gates set the secret meditation enclosures.
On the crescent moon of the outermost rim
Place twenty-eight women,
Placing them by name or with a symbol as support.
At its mouth build a hearth,
A hearth shaped like a lotus, a śrīvatsa or the expanse.
The skilled should prepare the kindling.
All the tasks that are to be done,
Apply just as they were applied above."

Thus he spoke.

From the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness, this is the twenty-first chapter, called "The Practice That Liberates All Saṃsāra."

Then again Sattvavajra spoke this sūtra called "Mastering the Three Poisons as Enlightened Mind":

"Yogin of the Great Assembly,
The mastering of the three poisons, too,
Should be understood in this way.
Whatever is the nature of the three poisons
Is the very essence of the three bodies;
There is nothing at all to seek elsewhere.
When it has come to be understood thus,
In the conventional way transform it thus.
Applying everything as above,
On a platform one fathom in size,
Make the outside red and broad.
Then build a dark blue triangle,
Then make a dark red crescent.
In the center of the crescent the Great Glorious One blazes;
The eight places of Īśvara on the crescent's rim;
Between the tiers the charnel grounds blaze.
Last, on the red square,
Make four gates with their gatekeepers.
Surround its outer edge with mountains of fire,
And set out the emblems of the ten blazing wrathful ones.
The practice, the entry and the empowerments
Should be bestowed as above.
By this everything is complete,
And all three poisons are overwhelmed."

Thus he spoke.

From the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness, this is the twenty-second chapter, the chapter of the practice called "Mastering the Three Poisons."

Then the sublime Sattvavajra spoke this great maṇḍala called "Mastery over All Women": "Host of the Great Assembly, if you wish to bring all who are attached under your power, you should understand it as follows:

Woman is the nature of attachment;
Attachment is the ocean of blood.
Sentient beings in saṃsāra, through their karma,
Sink in the ocean of the blood of attachment.
Liberation from attachment is cessation;

That very attachment is called blood.
In order to dry up the ocean of blood,
The oceans of women's blood
Are transformed into the ocean of the nectar of life.
When it has come to be understood thus,
In the conventional way apply it thus:
Having undertaken, in proper order,
The perfect undertaking of the activity,
On a square maṇḍala one fathom in size
Lay down the lines of four wheels.
On the outer tier of the rim, four corner sections;
Then make the gate courtyards red.
The outermost tier of all is sealed off
By blazing mountains of the fire of lakchuhwa.
In the center draw a crescent facing east,
And set out the glorious skull bowl, father and mother.
The four wheels hold the four families.
On the two intermediate courtyards, the sacred places and lands,
Make them furnished with crescent and bindu.
The gate courtyards: four gates with crescents.
The outer courtyard: the fire of lakchuhwa,
And the wrathful ones of fire, with bindus.
Adorn it all with the ornaments of the charnel ground.
The completion of samādhi, the actual practice and faith,
The entry, the empowerment, the accomplishments,
Guarding the place and the rest: complete them all."

Thus he spoke.

From the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness, this is the twenty-third chapter, on the method of practice of mastery through the wheel.

Then the sublime Sattvavajra declared these words: "Host of the Great Assembly, all phenomena should be known to have the nature of nectar medicine. Why is that? If one realizes the meaning of all these phenomena that appear in this way, it is life, the elixir of the nature of reality. If one does not realize it, it is death, the poison of saṃsāra. Therefore all these phenomena should be known to have the nature of nectar. Having known this,

one should practice conventionally as follows:

Having arranged it comfortably, with whatever is available,
At the heart of Matraṃ's torso,
In keeping with the measure of one fathom,
Lay out a blazing wheel of eight spokes,
And surround it with the light of fire.
Its edge, encircled by a vajra fence,
Make with blazing gate-arches.
In the center make an eight-faceted jewel,
And there set out the blazing mudrā.
In this supreme place where Laṅkā was liberated,
The hosts of the matted-haired ones gather;
All the great powers that crush the Rakṣa
Liberate the whole of the three realms of existence here.

"With the sacred substances offered in the four seasons,
Make offerings to them as is fitting.
With the essence of the ripened nourishment of the four seasons,
Make the substances of the great accomplishment.
The great substances of the four directions and the center:
The wondrous matted-haired ones
Hold mastery over the five elements
And accomplish the miracles of the five elements:
Summer water, autumn fire, winter earth,
Spring wind, and space, joined in secret.
Having gained mastery over those miracles,
Practice them as the matted-haired ones.
Through the clarity of the five kinds of samādhi,
The five kinds of meat that arise from the five elements,
Dog meat, ox, horse meat,
And various birds and wild animals,
Are the substances for swiftly accomplishing miraculous powers.
The great substances of practice, the five great elements,
Give mastery over all the world.
When the substances are thus to hand,
Having meditated in samādhi and practiced,
And applied everything in keeping with the above,
The entry, the accomplishments and the great empowerments

Apply with ease, as is fitting."

Thus he spoke. This is the explanation of the sūtra called "The Self-Arisen Maṇḍala of Nectar."

Then again Sattvavajra spoke these words:

"Yogin of the Great Assembly,
Furthermore, for the great nectar,
Having properly applied everything as above,
On a maṇḍala of the fitting size,
A red lotus, a sky of light;
On the outer tier, four red crescents,
Beautifully encircled by blazing vajras.
A garland of blazing tongues of flame
Should be drawn all around the crescents.
With a garland of jewel anthers
Encircle the petals of the lotus.
Make the four gates of blazing jewels.
When the deities of the blazing mudrās are arranged:
In the center, in a smooth golden bowl,
Set a great conch with a spiral.
In the east, in a crystal bowl with upright fluting,
Set a clear jewel ūrṇā.
In the south, in a jeweled bowl with many flutings,
Set lush jewel leaves.
In the west, in a porcelain bowl shaped like a crescent,
Set two jewel swellings at the space between the brows.
In the north, in a lacquer bowl shaped like a cross,
An uṣṇīṣa swelling with four jewel knobs.
Apply the five roots to their respective directions,
And the chiefs of the five gates according to family.
From the center, then east, south, west and north,
Kakkola and turuṣka,
Jātiphala, fragrant kha,
And white chebok: apply them in this order.
Likewise, in the same order as above,
Myrobalan and camphor,
Saffron, lotus and ligadur:

These are the rasāyanas.
All of them should be applied in keeping
With family, color and activity.
Apply the five seeds in order.
Inside the glorious vessel
Place the essences of father and mother in sequence,
Setting them in the center and on the lotus petals.
Set out the sacred places, lands and the rest beautifully.
Arrange the charnel-ground substances and auspicious substances,
And all the implements that are to hand.
Then bring down the blessing and request the accomplishments;
Everything should be thoroughly applied.
That very sublime one, of the great secret,
Through the hundred families, the five families and the one family,
Should be made the supreme purifier of all.
Then, when the ingredients are purified,
Clearing, dedicating, gathering and separating,
Bathing and confession,
Proclaiming the qualities and bringing down the blessing are to be done.
Then join them for an instant, a moment,
Or a single day.
If signs appear, it is mastered there.
As for preparing the supreme powder:
The medicines in the vessel are gathered by the wisdom consort;
In the rite of grinding them too,
The mother holds and the father grinds.
Bring down and invite the skillful vidyādharas,
And recite the mantras of each activity.
The grinding stone and the pestle are means and wisdom;
Prepare the medicine itself as the mind of awakening.
The goddess takes up this vajra song:
'In the palace of Samantabhadrī,
From the union of means and wisdom,
Saṃsāra is prepared as nectar medicine.
From its clarity as the five wisdoms,
The fruit, the three bodies, is perfected as enlightened mind.
With the deathless nectar, chronic illness is cured.'

To examine the signs, having weighed it,
Pour it into the glorious vajra vessels joined mouth to mouth.
Wrap it in cloth of the colors of the five families,
Seal it with the seal of vajra power,
And bind it with the dhāraṇī of the vajra mantra.
Enthrone it as the five bodies of the Great Glorious One,
And confer the empowerment of the five wisdoms.
It is to be set upon the maṇḍala.
All circle around it and bring down the accomplishments.
The lords of elixirs and medicines,
And the subtle vidyādharas bearing signs,
Attend upon it with many instruments and costumes.
Fill the practice with the finest grain;
Cover it lavishly with auspicious cloth;
Offer knotted dhāraṇī cords according to family.
Purify it thoroughly with the fire of samādhi.
Whichever of the five great signs appears,
Be quick to take the accomplishments.
Having drawn the nectar forth from sound,
In the glorious one endowed with the lotus,
All is nectar, the samaya.
In the vast expanse of space great bliss is perfected.
One's own self is the perfect maṇḍala of nectar;
There is nothing whatever to accomplish elsewhere.
The entry and all the rest, too,
Should be done extensively, in the proper way."

Thus he spoke. This is the explanation of the practice of nectar powder.

Then again Sattvavajra spoke these words:

"Yogin of the Great Assembly,
Having applied everything in the same way,
On the maṇḍala, a wheel of eight spokes,
Having completed the deities of the mudrās,
And having purified, ground, sifted and weighed the medicines,
Make pellets with mead and milk.
Place them inside a lacquer bowl bearing the marks.
Join it well mouth to mouth and wrap it in cloth.

Having applied everything as above,
Make the supreme accomplishments your own."

Thus he spoke. This is the explanation of the rite of nectar pills.

Then again Sattvavajra spoke these words:

"Yogin of the Great Assembly,
The rite of the nectar paste is as follows.
Having applied everything as above,
When clear signs appear,
Take the powder out from within the water strainer.
That which has become the finest of powders,
Those queens of powders,
Pour into lacquer bowls joined mouth to mouth.
Having sealed, blessed and empowered them,
Recite, with emanating and gathering, without interruption.
Mead, rice beer, molasses beer,
Grape wine, milk and the like,
All the nourishing juices, mix them in.
Pour it into a jeweled amulet box bearing the marks,
Join it mouth to mouth and seal it,
And, having done the emanating and gathering and the recitation as above,
When signs appear,
Take the great accomplishment.
Those substances of the powder practice
Divide into five portions;
From the portions of the individual yogins,
One portion, as much as suffices,
And from the mixing beer divided into five portions,
From the portions of the individual yogins,
Mix them and make them the support of the accomplishments.
By eating it for one month
The body hair grows full and the wrinkles smooth out.
If it is eaten for two months
All one's splendor blazes forth.
By the benefit of three months
One is freed from aeons of illness.
From four months on, a person who,

Not mixing it with food, practices diligently,
Is able to destroy the illnesses of others.
In the sixth, the seventh and the eighth,
One lives on the essence of nectar.
In the ninth and the tenth, the outflows are exhausted.
In the eleventh, the vidyādhara flies into the sky."

Thus he spoke. This is the explanation of the practice of nectar paste.

Then again Sattvavajra spoke these words:

"Yogin of the Great Assembly,
The food of the vajra vidyādharas of the five skills,
The great rite of the nectar dough,
Should be understood in this way.
Honey, molasses and grapes
Having been prepared as a year's sustenance,
A red cow of fine color, bearing the marks,
Is to be taken and kept as a year's sustenance.
The milk of that cow, fed continually
On the king of medicines, or something close to it,
Becomes the supreme food of vidyādharas.
The queen of nectars, or something close to it,
Having been made into the finest powder
And prepared as a year's sustenance,
In a place where no one will see,
Having spread out those substances of practice,
Practice the nectar in the same way.
At the proper times as the seasons come,
All of those substances of practice
Make into a dough with cow's milk;
Increase it portion by portion and eat it.
The qualities of eating it are inconceivable:
With the outflows exhausted, one goes into the sky."

Thus he spoke. This is the explanation of the practice of nectar dough.

Then again Sattvavajra spoke these words:

"Yogin of the Great Assembly,
Doing this too as above,

The various substances of practice, unlike those,
All the medicines that turn into nectar,
Every single one, should be gathered.
The finest of rendered oils, great sesame and the rest,
Having gathered them all and mixed them,
And having sought out a place as above,
Spread out the nectar and practice.
Do not break the stream of emanating, gathering and recitation.
When it has become an accomplished substance,
The medicines should be ground into powder.
When they have become powder,
They should be mixed with the great rendered oils.
When the rite of preparation is complete,
The supreme accomplishment should be taken.
With others, or those of other factions,
Keep apart for a year and do not meet.
Live on nectar mixed with rendered oil.
The great signs that the nectar is accomplished:
The hair stands on end and one's splendor blazes;
Free of coarse food, one lives in bliss;
Wisdom is clear and unobstructed;
With the outflows exhausted, one goes into the sky."

Thus he spoke. This is the explanation of the practice of the great rendered essence of nectar.

Then again Sattvavajra spoke these words:

"Yogin of the Great Assembly,
If you practice medicine with moist substances,
Having applied everything as above,
On a maṇḍala of five lines,
Having set down the five glorious auspicious ones,
The five chief ones and the five fruits,
Arranged while moist, purify them with the syllables.
By kindling the fire of samādhi and recitation,
First the juices come out and they are dried;
Then grind and sift them as above,
Mix them, and purify them by the approach of the family.

When signs appear from this,
Likewise use them at ease, as above."

Thus he spoke. This is the explanation of the practice of the moist preparation of nectar.

From the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness, this is the twenty-fourth chapter, the chapter on the practice of nectar medicine.

Then the great Sattvavajra explained this, called "The Practice of the Mind of the Great Secret, the Essence of All Practices":

"Yogins of the Great Assembly, everything should be understood in terms of the expanse. All the phenomena of saṃsāra are gathered in the expanse, and all the phenomena of nirvāṇa are gathered in wisdom. Know that the nonduality of these two is gathered in the great bliss of the nature of reality, the mind of awakening. Therefore all phenomena are gathered into the nature of the wisdom mind, and are nondual. That being so, conventionally one should understand it as follows, and so enter into the meaning of nonduality.

Yogin of the Great Assembly,
All the phenomena of the ultimate,
Every one, are complete in one's own mind.
Whatever conventional phenomena there are
Are taught to be complete in body and speech.
Therefore all these phenomena
Are complete in one's own root.
And the supreme method for practicing them:
Having cleared away the dust of conceptual thought,
The two kings of practice, father and mother,
Having become skilled in the meaning,
On the heart of each, bindus
On white and red crescents should be placed.
Its great and supreme substances,
The great camphor of means
And the secret sandalwood of wisdom, the two,
Should be made into great white and red crescents.
On the white one at the father's heart,
The mouth of the bindu faces downward.

On the red one at the mother's heart,
The mouth of the bindu faces upward.

In the center of the father's bindu,
Within a śrīvatsa, draw a sun;
At its center a clear oṃ, and within it hūṃ.
In the center of the mother's bindu,
Within a lotus, draw a moon;
At its center a clear a, and within it hūṃ.
When it has become clear in this way,
As Samantabhadra, father and mother,
Transform it into nonduality.
When the samādhi has become clear,
With the nectar that arises from oneself
Make the offering of the two secrets.
The accomplishments that arise from oneself
Should be dissolved into oneself.
If one makes this practice the principal one,
All the requisites of nectar
And whatever has become the finest of essences
Having been prepared as a year's sustenance,
Of the four branches of approach and accomplishment,
At the time of the approach
The person relies on human food.
That, too, is applied for one year's span,
Or for up to two or three.
For the span of a year
One relies on the requisites of nectar.
Then, for a year's span,
For one or for two,
With the five kinds of substances that arise from oneself
One offers to the noble ones and eats them oneself.
By this one comes to abide in warmth.
From the time warmth is attained,
In a year's span, in a moment,
Having found the taste of the food of samādhi,
One becomes free of coarse food.

Having perfected the three kinds of great warmth,
One attains the great signs.
The miraculous signs that appear are these:
If one wishes for heaps of jewels,
They are accomplished from earth, stones and the like.
If one wishes to travel on water or in the sky,
By setting out, one does not sink and goes unhindered.
If one wishes to quell a mass of fire,
By raising the threatening forefinger
And giving a command of truth, it is accomplished.
One is able to do all these and more.
From the attainment of the signs onward, one is a buddha.

Thus he spoke. This is the explanation of the practice of the mind of the great secret.

From the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Tantra of the All-Gathering Awareness, this is the twenty-fifth chapter, the chapter on the practice of the wheel of the secret word.

Then the Blessed One Sattvavajra entered into the samādhi called "The Blazing Vajra Expanse of Fire." Then all the hosts of the assembly saw all phenomena appear as having the nature of fire. Then the retinue offered high praise:

"How wonderful! Great being, great one,
Great samādhi, great radiance,
Great miracle, great variety,
Supreme means, homage to you!
All phenomena appear as an expanse of fire;
Fire itself is the expanse of clear wisdom.
Since it has blazed, radiated and become clear,
Darkness is dispelled and all things are burned.
That all is perfected in the expanse of great bliss
Is your deed, O hero.
Great compassion, a la la!
Great accomplishment of aims, a la la!
Great grace, a la la!
Great Bhairava, a la la!

Great delight, a la la!
Great haughty one, a la la!
O hero, by your blessing,
Give us an explanation.
The great nature of fire,
Please explain it to us."

When they had made this request, Sattvavajra was pleased and declared these words:

"Yogins of the Great Assembly,
I shall explain the nature of vajra fire;
Listen, all of you, with respect.
Through this supreme activity of vajra fire,
By applying it with ease as the method of yoga,
All the victors are pleased, and all is fulfilled by burning;
It is taught as the supreme activity that accomplishes aims.
In the homa pit of unborn purity,
On the kindling of the birth of phenomena,
With the fire of unelaborated wisdom of awakening,
The habitual tendencies of signs are burned, purified and dissolved.
In the homa pit of the pure bhaga,
On the heaped kindling of desire,
Kindling the fire of the awakening of great bliss,
The things of saṃsāra are burned, purified and dissolved.
In the homa pit of the Great Glorious One's mouth,
On the kindling of the five afflictions,
Kindling the fire of the five wisdoms,
The substances of apprehended and apprehender are burned, purified and dissolved.
In the homa pit of the sky of appearance and existence,
On the kindling of the four elements,
Kindling the fire of the host of mudrās,
The things of appearance and existence are burned, purified and dissolved.
According to the particulars of each of the four activities,
Apply direction, color, shape and substance
Just as they are.
East, south, west and north, apply white, yellow, red,

Dark blue-black and ash color.
Round, with lotus petals, for pacifying;
A wheel, square, with eight corners, for enriching;
A crescent, a segment, the shape of a bow, for magnetizing;
A triangle, with the mouth of a bhaga, for wrathful action.
It is beautiful with three tiers, with luster and designs.
The kindling of the activity is enriched with substances.
Endowed with the activity lineage of the wisdom vajra,
The supreme method is applied by the three masters,
Holding the limit of purity, holding the supreme.
With song, music and dance of the vajra secret,
The secret offerings are joined to the times,
And the aspiration of the vajra path is applied.
Those endowed with the secret activity lineage,
By setting out the deity lineage of pacifying,
And setting out the lineages of enriching and magnetizing,
Should be furnished with deity, mantra and mudrā,
And likewise with the lineage.
The five lineages of the deities of the families
Are set out in their respective families,
And in the homa pit of the vast swirling expanse,
With the blazing nectar of the sacred substances,
It is fitting to burn them, for purification and attainment.
The substances burned are phenomena of birth.
All phenomena that appear to be born
Here appear as if they were real things.
Phenomena, from conditions and from arising,
And miraculous display, from nature itself,
Are held to be birth itself.
These are phenomena of birth;
The self-arisen substances burned dissolve into their own peace.
The sacred substances of the five afflictions
Are offered into the expanse of the five wisdoms.
The sacred substances of the five aggregates
Dissolve into the bodies of the five fathers, the supreme means.
The substances burned that are gathered by the five elements
Are offered into the expanse of the five mothers, wisdom.

The substances burned of the eight consciousnesses
Are the eight mothers of the places of wisdom.

The eight kinds of distraction by objects
Are the eight divisions of the nonreferential expanse.
The substances burned, the karma of the four modes of birth,
Dissolve into the expanse of the four doors of liberation.
The supreme means and the rest, the ocean-like host,
All of their individual qualities
Are proclaimed with vajra songs, and then
One undertakes the offerings that please them.
When all the offerings are complete,
The great matters of whether obscurations are purified or not,
And the matters of whether accomplishment is gained or not,
The learned one should examine in the fire.
Two sounds of the fire and two colors,
Two ways of blazing and six shapes:
These should be thoroughly known.
If the signs are unpleasant,
Since that is an omen of ill fortune,
The great burning purification should be performed extensively.
Then, if the desired signs appear,
Of the accomplishments desired in the fire,
Take whichever of the three kinds has been accomplished.
Having purified by burning the substances of the corpse,
And having applied mantras to the corpse,
With a variety of very fragrant scents
One should anoint and wash the corpse.
With the fluid of the great melted nectar
Smeared on cloth, the corpse is wrapped,
And on whatever places of the corpse there are,
Having arranged all the applications of mantra,
One should seal them with the signs of the mudrās.
Of whichever maṇḍala of the Victors
Is the basis of the rite, its mudrās,
However many they are, equal to that
Should the number of stakes be made.

On each stake, the root heart mantras
Of the deities, without error,
Are written on large cloths and hung.
When the preparation of the corpse is complete,
On all the outer coverings of the corpse
Set out all the habitual tendencies of saṃsāra;
On cloth, birch bark, or paper
Set down all the seeds of saṃsāra.
The five afflictions together with the three poisons,
And the six lineages on the path of birth,
Made into names or into forms,
Should be placed each at its own place.
The elements, the sense sources, the five aggregates,
Along with apprehended and apprehender, as names,
Written in the manner of symbols,
Should be placed specially on the corpses.
Then that body of the corpse
Upon a support, a board, or a platform
The learned one should place.
To undertake the rite of the hearth:
On a maṇḍala base about an arm span around,
Of whichever maṇḍala it may be,
The palaces where the mudrās reside
Should each be marked out with lines.
On top of it, wood is stacked
In a square shape, filled in,
And the four corners are made firm with four pillars.
Three-storied, with an upper floor and a middle chamber,
Its outer edges should be closed in with wood.
On the board of the middle chamber
The corpse's face is turned toward the east.
In the chamber above the corpse,
Drawn on cloth or on paper,
Clearly set out the maṇḍala of the mudrās.
Open four windows in the corpse chamber,
Tie on four dhāraṇī cords of compassion,
And present them to four masters in the four directions.

When the rite of the wood is complete,
On the platform at the outer edge of the wood
Set out the mudrā deities in their order.
When the platform has been completed,
The vajra duties are assigned:
To the master, the Vajra King,
Entrust the office of burning saṃsāra;
With samādhi and wisdom, single-pointed,
He should continually gather and radiate the fire.
To the vajra action master, the Karma,
Entrust the office of completing the activities;
He should complete the sequence of activities.
A great vajra master,
Taking up the full extent of the corpse's misdeeds,
Enumerates and confesses the accumulations of karma.
The vajra master who links the stages
Strings together the nectar offerings for each stage.
With vajra dances and words of song,
The song and dance offerings for each stage,
Led by music, should be presented.
The aspiration of the vajra abode
Is made at the end of each stage and each activity.
The keeper of the vajra-action tallies
Keeps count with the hundred and eight activities
And offers the white tablets into the master's hands.
The keeper of the tallies of the corpse's evil karma,
Having counted the countless,
Burns the tablets of black signs
In the expanse of the fire of wisdom.
Perform the rite of joining with fire.
As for who the deity of fire is:
The buddha of fire is Amitābha;
The goddess of fire is Pāṇḍaravāsinī (the White-Robed One),
The supreme light of all the Victors.
She holds mastery over the element of fire
And is the lord of the warmth of all things.
She has pledged to burn the three realms of existence;

From the activity of burning saṃsāra
She never departs, by the power of her sacred vow.
All the rites of fire
Are entrusted to the Great Mother, the White One herself.
Then, when all the rites are complete,
Whether the corpse's obscurations are purified or not,
Whether the accomplishment of fire is gained or not,
The learned one examines in the fire, as before.
When unpleasant signs occur,
The rite of burning purification should be performed extensively.
If the signs are pleasing, accomplishment is gained.
The great ashes of the corpse
Are ground, and accomplished as the nectar of ashes.
Through that, great merit
Beyond measure will be obtained.

Thus he spoke. From the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness, this is the twenty-sixth chapter, on accomplishing the vajra fire rite.

Then the sublime Sattvavajra spoke these words of vajra mantra, called Blessing All Maṇḍalas.

sarvatathāgata mahāśrīheruka vajracaṇḍa sarva duṣṭāṃ saṃ śrī haṃ ru kāṃ ta ka ha na va ca hūṃ hūṃ sa sa sa sa samaya sa nu ne sa no rva ra vajragarbha ratnagarbha padmagarbha karmagarbha maitrigarbha kāruṇagarbha lokagarbha vidumagarbha yakṣa rākṣasa viśva teśva keśva vaśva viśva trakṣva hriśva kaśva pakṣa ruti rakti khāhi saha sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa rva rva rva rva rva rva rva rva rva rva rva rva rva rva rva rva rva rva rva rva rva rva rva rva rva rva rva rva rva rva rva rva rva rva rva ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta thā thā thā thā thā thā thā thā thā thā thā thā thā thā thā thā thā thā thā thā thā thā thā thā thā thā thā thā thā thā thā thā thā thā ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ga ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ma ma ma ma ma ma ma ma ma ma ma ma ma ma ma ma ma ma ma ma ma ma ma ma ma ma ma ma ma ma ma ma ma ma ma ma hā hā hā

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And join means and wisdom without duality.
Abiding in the manner of evenness,
Place A itself above the fire:
This is the seal free of all activity.
The ten seeds of A and MA
Radiate and gather, and are turned in every way,
Coiling to the right and embracing to the left:
This is the seal from which miracles arise.
The ten seeds of A and MA,
Each held separately, are made into sprouts,
Raised up high and turned in every way:
This is the cause of becoming the essence.
With MA, in the manner of giving generosity,
And with A, protecting all:
This is the great immeasurable;
It is the mudrā of equanimity toward all.
MA itself is the vessel that snatches blood;
A itself is formed into rows of teeth and fangs:
This is the mudrā that displays
The terrifying manner, the play of all.
Joining the two, A and MA, at the base,
In the manner of rows of teeth and fangs,
In the manner of a mouth gaping wide:
This is the seal of the great Bhairava.
Seizing with MA and pulling,
Rearing up with A and crushing:
This is the mudrā of the great destroyer.
With MA and A, from head and tail,
Making as if to seize,
Drawing and pulling with the mouth:
This is the mudrā of the great devourer.
From the wisdom of A and MA,
Moving them in the manner of right and left,
Apply the means just as each one is;
As the principle of place and object,
The movements are taught as the mudrās of dance.
The hero rises from the seat,

Gazes toward all the directions and intermediate directions,
And bears himself with great poise and majesty.
The seeds of A and MA,
Each struck, are set upon the hips.
Moving in a stately manner,
Circle all around with the stride of the tiger.
Then with the stride of the heavy bird
Circle as before.
Likewise with the strides of tortoise, leopard and tiger,
Of wolf, lion and bear,
Of great boar and brown bear,
Circle with each and every one.
Likewise, having completed the strides
In the gaits of all the birds,
All the maṇḍalas become complete.

Thus he spoke. From the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness, this is the twenty-eighth chapter, on the mudrās of movement.

Then Sattvavajra spoke this chapter on the secret sublime offering.

hūṃ
The great element, space,
Is the treasury of the five great elements.
From space arise the things desired;
May offerings of the things desired arise!
The supreme essences, the full moon and the rest,
The fivefold substances, maṃsa and the rest,
Flowers and the rest, and garlands of sandalwood:
May a variety of offerings arise!
The supreme touch of women,
The great dhāraṇī women who embrace and caress,
The delightful offering of the joining of the organs:
May you be satisfied by the offering of bliss!
Through vajra play, may this supreme feast
Spread everywhere as clouds of offerings!
This mountain heaped up from the three poisons
Is offered into the expanse of body, speech and mind.

This supreme feast, the play of the five poisons,
Dissolves into the five wisdoms.
This sign, the conceptuality of apprehended and apprehender,
Dissolves into the expanse of space and wisdom.
This saṃsāra, made of the phenomena of signs,
Dissolves into the state of the expanse of dharmatā.
This limb, the gathering of the aggregates,
Dissolves into the five aggregates of liberation.
This sign, the great elements as cause,
Dissolves into the five blazing expanses of space.
In this offering and gift of great play
The ocean-like hosts of Victors take their delight.
This unsurpassed offering of the feast
Is the path the Victors traveled in the past,
The means of slaying the three poisons from their depths:
Accept it in keeping with your former vows!
The deathless nectar, the water of the eternal swastika,
Rouses the elements of the corpse;
This that crushes the heap of poisons,
Accept as the offering of medicine, the supreme elixir!

When he had said this, the hosts of offerings arose in billowing abundance, and the ocean-like hosts of Victors were pleased by that enjoyment.

From the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness, this is the twenty-ninth chapter, on the secret sublime offering.

Then Sattvavajra spoke this chapter on vajra song.

Here, the vajra yogins,
Having received the empowerment that appears as approach,
Send forth the eight syllables of meditative melody.
Syllables are the ornament of song;
From the sixteen syllables of song,
Transforming and combining the syllables as its limbs,
The varieties of song are beyond conception.
First, when the meaning of song arose,
With oṃ the songs are led forth.
oṃ too is a miraculous display of a;

a is the syllable of Dharma.
From a arises oṃ, the mind of the Victors;
The Victors arise from the dharmadhātu.
From a arises aṃ, the supreme of speech;
From speech arise the limbs of song,
Renowned as the sixty limbs of melody.
The qualities of song are beyond conception.
The Victors of the past accomplished through song;
The vajra vidyādharas are drawn forth by song;
The lords of yoga achieve accomplishment through song;
The ocean of the teaching is spread through song;
The daughters of existence are attended through song;
Māras and rākṣasas are tamed through song;
An ocean of siddhis is called down through song.
From the center of the expanse of dharmatā
The nine suns of the śrīvatsa have risen,
And though the four doors of liberation are utterly clear,
They are obscured by the dense black darkness of ignorance:
Open the door of awareness!
In the deep pit of saṃsāra's black darkness
The moon of bodhicitta has risen,
So the darkness is dispelled, and the four doors of liberation appear.
The suns of blazing jewels:
As light rises from the heart of the Great Glorious One,
Through the openings in the clouds of habitual tendencies
Its rays fall upon the yogin's heart;
The darkness is dispelled, the door of awareness is opened,
And one should enter into the meaning of yoga.
From the maṇḍala of the heart of awareness,
As the light rays of rulu open the door,
Various miracles arise through emanation,
Making the distinctions of the three realms of existence,
Drying up the ocean of saṃsāra from its depths,
Freeing the six causes of affliction from their places,
Cutting the root of the three poisons at its source,
Taming malicious māras and rākṣasas,
And raining down blessings and siddhis like rain.

Just as, when the doors of the senses open,
The radiance of a smile clearly appears,
So, as the door of the heart of the śrīvatsa opens,
The syllables, the light rays of rulu, arise.
Dark blue, dark yellow, dark red, green,
And dark purple blazing syllables
Are drawn out as garlands, family by family of syllables.
With the drawn-out tone one urges them on, and with the white tone one brings them down.
When the tenkö comes near,
Make the jimgö clearly manifest.
In the birkwa, which is without duality,
With the drenkö draw out the garland of syllables.
In that itself there are six songs:
Shatapa and Gartapa,
Changkadeu and Bangkadeu,
Drengngewa and Dungngewa.
With three hundred limbs of song
They become the supreme delight of the Victors.
Through these six kings of song
The six aims are perfectly fulfilled.
By singing the song Shatapa,
All the malicious ones lose heart.
By singing the song Gartapa,
All who do harm are ground to dust.
By singing the song Changkadeu,
The blazing maṇḍala is offered like fire.
By singing the song Bangkadeu,
The violent and fierce are made to settle down.
By singing the song Drengngewa,
All the miracles of emanation are spread forth.
By singing the song Dungngewa,
The daughters of existence are brought under control.
In the nature of the nine syllables
All the maṇḍalas of the mudrās are complete;
Likewise the wheel with its rim,
And the courtyards and the gateways around them, are clear.

Whatever exists, all that is seen, appears and is heard,
Is all complete as the words of mantra.
The syllables are linked with all the Victors;
They are close to the ground of the wheel.

Through the syllables, all that is aimed at is accomplished,
The great aim, free of attachment and spontaneously present.
Even the distinctions of the four kinds of activity
Become meaningful without any action.
Through the radiating and gathering of the secret syllables
All the Victors and heroes are pleased.
Though all of that is emanated by the syllables,
Its nature is the dharmadhātu, without substance.
From the miraculous display of the blazing syllables
Various sublime wonders arise.
Likewise they burn the firewood of the obscurations;
Wisdom blazes, dispelling the darkness of delusion;
The sun of awareness shines down clearly.
Oneself is the blazing heart of the Great Glorious One:
The citta, an eight-cornered śrīvatsa, blazes,
And the eight jewel syllables are clear.
From the blazing jewel heart of the Great Glorious One,
From the eight-cornered purple śrīvatsa,
Nine golden suns have risen.
The light rays, the eight syllables of rulu,
In a blazing vajra box of wind,
Intensely blazing, radiating and churning,
Are emanated, and through the right nostril
Of the lord of yoga they should be drawn out.
In a palace of gorocana
The size of a rounded fingernail,
Nine golden suns as caskets
Have risen, and in their center nine syllables
Are clear; thus the palace of light
Burns all the habitual tendencies toward things,
And the mind, like molten liquid gold,
Shimmers and glistens, blazing with light.

From its dynamic energy, a moon disk;
Above the sun a śrīvatsa blazes,
And upon it rulu radiates and gathers.
This maṇḍala of the śrīvatsa citta
Is clear as a casket of blazing syllables.
This casket of the blazing lotus
Is the place where the garland of syllables coils.
For example, just as from a blazing flower
Nectar-gathering bees take its essence
And collect it into honey,
So from the heart maṇḍala of the śrīvatsa
Flowers of jewel light blaze forth,
And the syllables of rulu swell with essence.
Formed from the yogin's mind,
Many bees that draw out the essence radiate forth;
Soaring out, they draw out the essence of the syllables,
Soaring back, they dissolve it into the casket of the mind.
First, in the color of crystal,
Utterly clear, glistening and blazing,
In the nine places, on the śrīvatsa
At the center of the moon bindus,
The arrangement of syllables becomes clear,
And many crystal bees,
The size of a great garuḍa in flight,
Soar out, draw the essence, and gather back in.
As the syllables blaze with the fire of wisdom,
The heaped firewood of habitual tendencies is burned.
Sent outward, through compassion they exhort the grounds.
Just like the scorching rays of the sun,
They blaze single-pointedly without interruption.
In the middle, in the color of coral,
The arrangement is clear as above,
And many coral bees,
Flying and soaring as above,
Draw out the essence, dissolve it, and radiate once more.
Like a whirling firebrand,
They dissolve into the expanse of the purple śrīvatsa.

The gathering at the very end:
All of the arrangement above
Is transformed into blazing dark blue,
And like great garuḍas swooping on their prey,
Sounding hūṃ, they soar back and forth,
Draw out the essence of rulu, and confer siddhi.
From the center of mindfulness ja is drawn forth,
With blazing hooks and caskets;
Heaped in the center of the śrīvatsa,
The heaps of rulu jewels
Are gathered, drawn in, and dissolved into their place.
The force of their descent, or the blessing,
Is like a great hailstorm rolling down upon a lake.
When joined to the syllables in this way,
It is not the yogin alone:
Even the supreme deities dwelling in the expanse,
Though they are nonreferential in the nature of reality,
When urged by the supreme yogin,
Send forth the radiance of loving compassion,
Like life-force and exertion, like mindful awareness speaking aloud,
Like the voice of the throat and the limbs in motion,
Like syllables blazing as vajra letters,
Down to the vowel hooks, the circles and the dots,
Without blur or haze, unobscured;
Knowledge and awareness expand in the meaning of wisdom.
Even so, by the power of those to be tamed,
One abides at the stage of urging the Victors
And performs the rite that nourishes yoga.
In order to become one with the deity,
Through the count of recitations, through approach,
And through application, one comes close to the goal.
Thus, at the times of practice,
The signs, the warmth, or the marks
That the blessing has come or is near
Arise in the yogin himself, in the substances of accomplishment,
And in all that exists, that is seen, and that is heard.
They are clear in the warmth of the body, in dreams,

And as signs in the mind,
And they arise with certainty in the breath as well.
The body is light as cotton,
And free from the harm of discomfort;
In touch, samādhi is clear;
Even in dreams one becomes intoxicated;
Faith, joy and delight arise;
Yearning bodhicitta arises,
And wonder arises: this is it.
One gains mastery over the moving breath,
Holding it and releasing it just as one wishes.
The substances blaze and leap up,
Fragrance and light arise, and the supreme taste is born;
They increase abundantly without being exhausted;
Sweet, soft and clear, the supreme taste is found.
They harm neither the stomach nor the throat;
When they are eaten, the face is transformed and the body grows robust.
Cymbals sound sweetly, pleasing melodies and forms appear,
And fragrant scents arise: such are the signs.
When the vajra divination images are good,
The signs and marks have come:
Make haste, and take the siddhis.
With the mudrās of the śrīvatsa and the casket,
And with the radiating and gathering of the vajra vase,
Bring the siddhis down into the space of the consort.
Until the higher intention of the union of father and mother
Has come,
The four goddesses of clear wisdom,
With hasta, mirror and bhandha,
With garlands of great fields and the rest,
And with silk streamers of five colors,
Wave them and summon many vidyādharas.
With many musical instruments,
With vajra dance and melodious song,
Relying on all the mātṛkās of existence,
Bring down the great blessing,
And dissolve the siddhis into those who have come.

This is the wheel of vajra song,
The activity of the ornament of wisdom.

Thus spoke Sattvavajra.

From the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness, this is the thirtieth chapter, called vajra song.

Then, again, Sattvavajra spoke this chapter called Entering Vajra Yoga.

The yogin of the Great Assembly,
Gathering together all the sons of noble family of yoga
Who are to enter
Into this sublime secret maṇḍala,
All who have become worthy vessels,
Has them generate the mind of supreme awakening,
And they should remain, speaking these words:
"How wonderful! Into this pleasure grove of supreme bliss
We wish to enter completely.
Having generated the joyful mind of awakening,
We shall practice this secret meaning."
When they have made this request,
The Lord of the Supreme Secret
Purifies their streams and closes the doors of the six realms.
All the yogins who are vidyādharas
Bring forth the great maṇḍala clearly,
And with the mudrās and empowerments
They should purify the streams of saṃsāra.
In the five places of the one who enters,
Having produced the seeds of the six realms,
One should press them down with five hūṃ syllables.
On the crown of the one who has entered,
Fashioned from the wisdom of ba,
A four-petaled lotus: at its center
Place the seeds of humans and gods;
In the east, south, west and north
Plant the seeds of the asuras, the animals, the pretas
And the hells.
With hūṃ the doors of their paths should be closed.

With both hands, press the little fingers with the thumbs,
Join the three fingers and cross them at the forehead:
This is the mudrā of averting, which does not let one go
To the abodes of gods and asuras.
Cross both hands and clasp the armpits:
This is the seal of averting from the human realm.
Make fists, raise the thumbs,
And press the right upon the left:
This is the seal of averting from the abode of animals.
Join the palms evenly and touch the tips of the middle fingers,
Cross the ring fingers behind the middle fingers,
And embrace them from the base with the index fingers:
This is the seal of averting from the realm of the pretas.
Place the back of the right hand upon the left,
And with ring, middle and index fingers, one with another,
Interlock them: this is the seal that closes the door of hell.
Having made these mudrās of the hand,
One utters the vajra seal of speech:
Alas! rudra krodha kyi hūṃ hri samapaca hūṃ hrispaja hūṃ
When this has become clear,
In order to purify the obscurations,
Comes the mudrā of joining in yoga:
"Supreme deity of vajra yoga,
Glorious one who guides the six classes of beings,
Homage to the Vajra Holder!
Protector Maitreya, I go to you for refuge!"
When this supplication has been made,
The one who enters touches with the crown of his head
The very feet of the great yogin.
"Arisen from the three supreme vajra speeches
Of all the buddhas of supreme bliss,
Honored by the three realms of existence,
The great permission of empowerment is bestowed."
atihostahṛdakhaṃ
Then, when they have become vessels,
The secret eye should be opened,
And the deity on whom the flower fell is also given.

Then the great samaya is proclaimed:
"Whoever transgresses this samaya
Of union equal with all the Victors
Has deceived all the Victors.
The hosts of blood-drinking, blazing-mouthed goddesses,
Enraged, will seize his heart blood and drink it."
vajra samaya idanathenarakan varahṛdayanamavastināna samaya rakṣa siddhi vadyi vajra amṛtodakaṃ
Having given the water of the vajra oath to drink,
The great and weighty vajra oath is sworn.
All the vows of vajra samaya,
Each and every one, should be conferred,
And the duties of a disciple should also be conferred.
"O vidyādhara, supreme vajra son,
You are a son of the Victors of yoga.
Do not speak of the secret to others;
If you speak of it, you will burn in hell.
You are Vajra So-and-so,
Son of the Victors, holder of the lineage.
Through the giving of the supreme secret name,
You will enjoy bliss in all the buddha fields."
Through this, one is born in a buddha field.

Thus he spoke. From the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness, this is the thirty-first chapter, called entering vajra yoga.

Then, again, Sattvavajra spoke this chapter on the complete empowerment.

The yogin of the Great Assembly,
Honored by the three realms of existence,
Who abides at the level of the master,
Has the thirty-six supreme secrets:
The outer empowerment and the inner empowerment,
The empowerment of accomplishment and the secret empowerment;
With ten, eleven and thirteen,
They are made complete in two ways.
First among them, this is the empowerment of giving:
oṃ hūṃ sa hrīḥ h

Hard for anyone to transgress,
With mighty words that hold sway over the land,
The empowerment of the mudrā, the king's seal of command:
The five kāyas become complete.
Holding the lineages of each of the families,
The great mark of the symbols
Is the hand emblem of the great union:
The samaya mudrā becomes complete.
The supreme secret of the dhāraṇī of wisdom,
Which has become endowed with meaning,
Which does not go to the two extremes,
Is the great queen of consorts.
When nonduality is completely fulfilled,
All is the state of great bliss,
Joined in meaning with the mind of awakening:
This is the empowerment that completes great wisdom.
The vase of great auspiciousness
Is the palace where the Sugatas dwell;
The great empowerment of the completed maṇḍala
Should be given to him.
So that the secret teaching may spread
And remain for a long time,
The supreme empowerment of the auspicious substances
Should also be given as the great permission.
So that all aims may be accomplished,
With the wish-fulfilling jewel that grants all desires
And the seven precious possessions of royal rule,
He is empowered as supreme king.

A precious lion throne of lotus,
That supreme seat which has become the highest,
Is the empowerment of great distinction:
He should be set upon the great throne.
With diadem, garlands of flowers, and the rest,
He is clothed in the splendid ornaments of supreme empowerment.
Crown ornament, long necklace and short necklace,
Armlets, anklets and bracelets:

The king who has gained empowerment gives these to him.
That king, majestic with the beauty of the empowerment he has gained,
Is a mighty lord, and so all bow down to him.
"He is the Vajra Lord, the King!":
So all should cry out with a great voice and proclaim.
Placing in the hand of that king
A golden wheel with spokes and rim,
This supreme royal empowerment
Of steering the whole world should also be given.
From the time he has become a king who guards the outer circle,
Since he comes to possess the signs of the unsurpassed and supreme,
The secret door should be opened and he should be brought inside.
Having come to possess the most secret substances,
Through the secret door he requests whatever aims he wishes.
It is blessed as the sign of the great permission.
The empowerment to listen to and learn the secret meaning
Should be given to that fortunate one who has gained empowerment.
With this nectar water the secret door of the ears is opened:
sarva tathāgata stamati ho
All the profound volumes and the rest
Should be given to that supreme son of good family.
Since he is able to act for the benefit of beings,
As the sign of accomplishing the whole ocean of activities,
The substances of the four kinds, the crossed vajra and the rest,
Should be given with skill to that supreme son.
That supreme son, who fulfills the hopes and wishes of others,
Just as a king is born in the line of a royal caste,
Has been born as regent in the line of the Dharma;
Therefore the three sublime treasuries, the tantras and the rest, are given.
Because he is able to care for the whole assembly of disciples,
And so that he may abide on the ground of proclaiming the teaching,
This glorious supreme empowerment of the Vajra King
Is given together with the signs and attire of the nine great vehicles.
Since he becomes an unsurpassed king,
The empowerment of seat and throne, supreme sign of having mastered the grounds:
The Great God (Śiva) and the others, the great corpses, together with sun and

moon,
Bull, lion, buffalo, leopard and tiger,
Raised up by a fierce bear, should be given.
The signs of being a king are of seven kinds:
The dhāraṇī that holds sway over people and delights the king,
Crushing the armies of others and holding sovereignty,
Possessing the miraculous legs that accomplish the aims of self and others,
And the jewel that fulfills every need and wish like a wish-granting gem:
These should be given with skill to that king.
Since he is a supreme heir of the Victors,
The supreme empowerment of the great seal (mahāmudrā) should be given.
An image of the mudrā, painted on cloth, modeled in relief, or cast in metal,
Should be placed on the crown of his head.
Since he is endowed with the meaning of great wisdom,
With the mudrā, the supreme sign of the five wisdoms,
Touching the five places, the supreme empowerment of mind is given:
oṃ mahā śūnyatā jñāna vajra svabhāva ātmako'haṃ
oṃ mhā ādarśa jña na vajra svabhāva ātmako'haṃ
oṃ mahā samatā jñāna vajra svabhāva ātmako'haṃ
oṃ mahā pratyavekṣaṇa jñāna vajra svabhāva ātmako'haṃ
oṃ mahā kṛtyānuṣṭhana jñāna vajra svabhāva ātmako'haṃ
Since he is the supreme bliss
Of the yoga of vajra body, speech and mind,
This supreme secret of body, speech and mind
Should be given to the Vajra Holder:
oṃ sarva tathāgata kāya vajra svabhāva ātmako'haṃ
oṃ sarva tathāgata vāka vajra svabhāva ātmako'haṃ
oṃ sarva tathāgata citta vajra svabhāva ātmako'haṃ
oṃ sarva tathāgata anurāgaṇa jñāna vajra svabhāva ātmako'haṃ
oṃ sarva tathāgata pūja vajra svabhāva ātmako'haṃ
For that supreme son who has gained the supreme empowerment,
So that all his aims may be auspiciously accomplished,
The supreme auspicious substances that subdue Māra,
Adorned with their emblems, should be given.
When that supreme son who has accomplished all aims
Has gained the supreme vajra empowerment,
The vajra, the drop of mastery,
Renowned throughout all the buddha fields, is given.

Having gained the empowerment of entering within,
The sublime supreme empowerment
To practice and accomplish all of these should be given.
In the unborn expanse of phenomena itself,
Where mind has obtained empowerment,
The empowerment of awareness, of great wisdom,
The decisive key of the meaning by which mind is understood, is given.
The mind of awakening, free of all signs of activity,
Abiding without being sought,
Through great compassion and supreme bliss,
Bestows mastery over all the three realms.
As the sublime supreme empowerment of the sign
Of being able to bring entirely to completion
All the aims of the beings of the three worlds of existence,
A blazing plow is given.
As the great sign of shaking out the three poisons from their depths,
Three amulet boxes,
Filled with the great red,
Are placed in the hand of the one who has gained the great empowerment.
To bestow the great supreme empowerment
Of liberating the three worlds of existence,
Weapons such as the curved knife
Are placed in the hand of that empowered one.
As the great seal of the sign
That whatever one engages in among the phenomena of saṃsāra,
One is not stained by faults,
A lotus of pure substance is given.
As the great sign of having gained the supreme empowerment
In which all activities are brought to completion,
Great staffs of stira
Are placed in the hand of that empowered one.
As the sign of nondual embrace with the consort,
Nondual with the meaning of the nature of reality,
This cluster of coiling black snakes
Is placed in the hand of that empowered one.
A wisdom woman of secret union,
Stainless, utterly pure and lovely to behold,

Endowed with the marks and finely adorned,
Should be given to that empowered one.
Since that great king who has gained empowerment
Is the lord of all,
Music, scents and food,
The five sense pleasures and the rest,
And all the ornaments and articles of enjoyment,
All of them, all, should be given.
To that king of practice,
So that he gains mastery over the activities of practice,
Saying, "Accomplish all the Victors,
Vajrasattva and the rest,
And vajra longevity, medicine and the rest:
Accomplish every practice without exception!",
All the substances for practice should be given.
Because all the victorious buddhas
And that empowered one are one,
The empowerment of the vajra mastery of a vidyādhara,
The vajra name, should be given.
Since he is lord of the empowerment of practice, of the supreme substances,
And of the secret,
The supreme secret empowerment should be given.
The great mind of awakening of joy,
Which satisfies completely,
The remaining white and red mind of awakening
Is placed on the tongue of that empowered one.
The great mind of awakening that is not sought,
Through the power of great wisdom,
Has mastery over the dharmakāya as illusion;
Since this is the empowerment that perfects great mastery,
Even if one has not gained those conventional empowerments
Of substances, words and persons,
If one has gained the mind's empowerment over phenomena,

All the vidyādharas of the Victors
And all the mighty ones of the three worlds of existence
Will confer empowerment upon him.

The measure of empowerment is this:
On one who has faith and reverence,
The great empowerment of hearing the secret is conferred.
If the meaning of the four kinds of activity is complete,
One has gained the empowerment to perform the activities.
If one sees the Dharma through the key point of the view,
One has gained the empowerment to expound with the royal seal.
If one withstands conditions and possesses the three valid means,
One has the empowerment of guru and vajra master.
Knowing how to expound all three sublime treasuries
Without partiality,
One gains the empowerment of king of the boundless.
If one cuts the blindfold cloth for a pretender
Who lacks faith, is dull of mind and very coarse,
It is taught that he is burned by the empowerment.
In one who keeps no secrecy and is forgetful, empowerment does not take hold.
On one who is faithless, lazy and torpid, empowerment does not rub off.
One who is no vessel, devoid of essence, wholly empty,
Has not gained empowerment.
If one who is a fit vessel, with the essence complete, gains empowerment,
That is taught to be the cause of gaining the supreme empowerment.
Thus he spoke.

From the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness, this is the thirty-second chapter, called "The Vajra Empowerment."

Then the vast gathered assembly, having understood that the Blessed One, the Lord of the Supreme Secret, and the sublime Sattvavajra, together with the great king of tantras, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness, are the mirror of all phenomena, were deeply moved and filled with wonder, and spoke this song of praise of exceeding great joy:

How wonderful!
Vanquisher of faults, endowed with excellence, signs stilled, beyond the extremes,
Immeasurable, impartial in love, by your meaning the glory of self and others,
Ultimate, hidden and secret, coiled in the center of space,
Supreme great vajra, mighty lord, master of all,

Free of grasping thought, you revel in flesh, bone and blood;
The cord of your heart's love holds sway to the very ends of saṃsāra;
Objectless and unborn, you are victorious in the battle with signs:
King of supreme bliss, to you I bow and offer praise.
Great wisdom shines as the sun in the sky;
The rays of the mind of awakening dawn in the expanse;
By the force of swift heroism you free the six classes of beings;
Crushing thought, the miraculous displays of the wisdom vajra radiate;
Speaking the sublime meaning, embodiment of the Teacher of nonduality,
Lion of Speech, to you I bow.
Holding precious treasure, you fulfill every wish;
Treasury of all scripture, reasoning and proof,
Clear mirror for those who know the symbols to take up correctly:
The tantra of the Vajra All-Gathering, King Bhairava,
To this mirror of Dharma we bow.

From the great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness, this is the thirty-third chapter, the praise of wonder.

The great king of tantras, the Vajra Array, the Sūtra of the All-Gathering Awareness, is complete.

Translator's Notes

• Several names in the assembly could not be identified with confidence and are translated by meaning (Vajra Regent, Vajra Crow, Vajra Juncture of Time, and the buddhas and yoginīs of the four retinues); Vajra Gophur is left in its Tibetan form because its sense (go phur) is unclear, and rdo rje ging is taken as Vajra Kiṃkara, the ging being a class of attendant dancers. In the description of the palace, ma tang gi gnas and pris ma are obscure: they are taken as "places of outcastes" and "raised mounds"; ga bu, taken as "skulls," and the list of women (slas, byi mo, bran mo, rendered household women, courtesans, and servant women) are also uncertain. The Sanskrit-derived names Saṅa, Bhigśa, and Śorikā are given as the Tibetan spells them.
• Several retinue names are transliterated Sanskrit-like syllables (Teśa, Tragśa, Ruti, and so on) given here as the Tibetan spells them; their underlying Sanskrit is unclear. Among the secret maidens, "Gathering of Mothers" translates an unidentified name; Pukkasī reads the Tibetan spelling as a variant of the usual form. Among the maidens of joy and the devoted maidens, names that could not be confidently matched to a standard Sanskrit form (Charnel-Bird-Faced, Darkness-Faced, Horse-Faced, Pig-Faced, Monkey-Faced, She Who Grinds to Dust) are translated literally, as are the animal-necked slayers other than Hayagrīva and the vajra slayer goddesses. The second line of the song, literally "from like space, come near to the pledge", is terse and its construction uncertain.
• The list of plays in the first paragraph contains several rare words (rendered "flirting", "lying close", "chewing", "savoring") whose exact sense is uncertain. In the first song, "you, my lord"

may also be read as "glorious lord" addressing Vajrasattva as master. The line "Sugata, maker of the going in bliss" renders a terse phrase playing on the meaning of Sugata, "one gone in bliss".
• In the list of beings destroyed, several items are unidentified and are translated literally or transliterated: "Craving to Enter" and "Without Craving" may conceal names of Hindu deities, "Bala" renders "the Powerful One", "ludé" is an unknown term, and "fire-bearers" is literal. In Vajrasattva's verse, the Tibetan normally used for the god Gaṇapati is here plainly an epithet of the Buddha being addressed, so it is rendered "Lord of the Assembly". "Grandmother of all awakening minds" renders the Tibetan literally; the sense is "progenitor".
• The ten examples listed and then expounded do not match their stated correspondents one for one; the text is translated as it stands. "Examining it in a wavering way" renders an obscure word whose sense is uncertain. "The sublime Vajra" at the start appears to be Sattvavajra.
• The names in "Vajrasattva, the stainless Jewel, and the Giver of Courage; likewise the Vajra Immeasurable and the Various Victor" seem to refer to the buddhas of the five families, but the Tibetan forms are unusual, so they are translated literally. Several lines are terse and their construction uncertain: "To practice afflicted effort where there is no doing is delusion" and "For hell, the great buddha, suffering is the very path of awakening" render obscure verses as literally as sense allows. "The path of the close placements" is read as referring to the mindfulness practices of the śrāvaka path.
• The passage opens mid-sentence, completing the preceding line: all doing and striving is delusion and a great obstacle to unsurpassed awakening. The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("essence of space") here describes the all-ground and is not the bodhisattva Ākāśagarbha. Several rare or uncertain words: □□□□ is read as □□□□ ("apart from"); □□□□□□□ is taken as a tiny aperture such as the eye of a needle, as the following lines suggest; □□□□ is rendered "undone"; □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as "the antics of a jester"; □□□ is read as "gratified"; and the line □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is obscure and rendered tentatively. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is the epithet "lord of yogins" (yogeśvara), not the god Īśvara.
• A few lines are terse and rendered with some uncertainty: □□□□□□□□□□ is taken as "wrong conceptions"; the line □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as denying any need to adjust the body for a pleasant place, though □□□□□□□ could also mean "unsurpassed"; and the closing lines on "guarding" appear to reinterpret the secrecy of the commitments (samaya) as the mind hidden in emptiness. The verses on the celestial palace, the assembly and the substances reinterpret the outer supports of tantric practice (palace, gaṇacakra gathering, ritual substances) as the mind itself.
• □□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□ ("intermingled"), which the sense requires. The "eight" signs of warmth and the "three meanings" are not enumerated here and are rendered as they stand. The "two faults, a quiescent body and final cessation" probably refer to the two kinds of nirvāṇa of the lower vehicles, with and without remainder. The closing prose begins a series of names for the mind that continues in the next piece.
• The text reads □□□□□□□□□□ ("emptiness") in "the Teachers of the present, too, go by this path"; this makes little sense here and is taken as a slip for □□□□□□ ("Teacher"). In the list of reasons, "great power" (□□□□□□□□□□) corresponds to the name "lord," not to tantric empowerment. Several items in the explanations of the afflictions, causes and conditions are cryptic; "weighed down as by a tree trunk" and "hardened by being unbreakable" are literal renderings of what appear to be images for particular afflictions. The explanations of the twelve conditions and twelve births list eleven items each, and are translated as they stand.
• The list of conditions names "six awarenesses" with the spelling □□□□□□□□□ (normally "six classes of beings"), but the explanation below calls them □□□□□□□□□, "six awarenesses", so that sense is followed. The six abodes (Endurance, the Mindful, the Equal, Desire, Strife, Tuṣita) are rendered literally; some may be names of world-systems or ages (Strife suggests the Kali

age). In the twelve great deeds, the text lists taming Māra twice, and the eighteen wisdoms enumerate only sixteen items without a closing formula; these are translated as they stand. The three modes combine the logician's three characteristics of a valid reason with the imputed and dependent natures.

• The first paragraph lists the four classic kinds of indirect intention (sameness, another time, another meaning), though here the third is "another enumeration" rather than the usual "the thought of the person"; translated as it stands. The text's own counts differ from the items listed in places (seventeen wisdoms where eighteen were announced, twelve yogas where eleven were announced); the lists are given as they stand. "Tshom ngam chen po" in the modes of arising is obscure; rendered "great majesty" tentatively. In the ten trainings, "'dis bzung" is read as "gyis bzung" (through samaya), and "la ... dor" and "thag ... gcod" are idioms of completing and deciding; rendered closely. "Pa spu" is read as "ba spu", hair. "Wheel of time" here is a cosmic image, not the tantra of that name.

• The ninth class in the doors of downfall, "shog ma gcan chen," is obscure; "gcan" is read as in "gcan gzan," wild beasts of prey, and "shog ma" is left untranslated as unclear. "The five that are close to them" are the five deeds close to those of immediate retribution; "the four grave ones" and "the eight wrong ones" are given literally. The paradoxical statements that the Buddha's dharmas are "accompanied by" the afflictions and nonvirtues reflect this tantra's nondual view and are translated as they stand. "The Guide" (Tibetan 'dren pa, Skt. nāyaka) is an epithet of the Buddha.

• "Cang shes gyi ling ngag" is read as the limbs of a thoroughbred horse; the exact sense of "ling ngag" is uncertain. "Mkhar lding" in the garuḍa simile is read as "mkha' la lding," soaring in the sky. "Sbrang ma" (bees, flies) in the ocean simile is rendered "stinging insects." "Guide and lead" (bkri zhing drang ba) may also carry the sense of provisional teaching (drang don, neyārtha) as against the one definitive intent.

• This passage is dense and terse, and several lines are uncertain. "Chung zhig bshad thabs 'gro" (of the elephants) is rendered "go only a little, as best they can." "Kun du rgyu dang gzhon nu" is taken literally as "wanderer and youth"; these may be the wandering ascetic (parivrājaka) and the youth (kumāra) of some known illustration. "Gnyis kyi chos" ("dharmas of the two") and the following lines on the three that benefit beings are translated literally. "Bcos ma phra men" is read as "contrived and mixed," and "sgrib las zhes rtsi" as "counted as obscurations and actions." The names of the grounds follow the list given earlier in the text, though the order and names here differ slightly from that list.

• "Rkun mo byi la btags" is read as setting a cat on the thief; here "rkun mo" is the ordinary word "thief" in a simile, not the goddess named Caurī elsewhere in the text. The images of the monkey, the thief, and the empty house are terse and their exact sense uncertain. "Byung tshor," rendered "sudden awareness," denotes the abrupt noticing of what has arisen. "The four of the desire realm" is translated as it stands. "Nam mkha'i snying po" here is "the essence of space," not the bodhisattva Ākāśagarbha.

• "Appearances" renders □□□, literally "omens, portents"; the sense here seems to be the appearing signs from which thought arises. "Mindfulness" in "the stirrings of mindfulness" (□□□□□□□□□□□□) refers to roaming recollection or memory, which the text treats as a fault to be recognized. In "with the mind, instant by instant," the words □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ are obscure; I have rendered only the clear sense. "Being one who has reached the ground" renders the terse □□□□□□□□□ and is tentative. "Sudden awareness" renders □□□□□□□□, as in the preceding passage.

• "The hips" renders the uncertain □□□□□□. The syllable there is written □□□□□□, which I take as the syllable ra fused with the word "syllable," matching the pattern of the surrounding lines. "The navel, the midpoint of the body" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, whose first part is obscure. The ranges of breath, scent and hearing measure how far the visualized syllables

radiate on each successive ground.
• "Turns into anything at all" reads □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ for the text's □□□, an evident slip. The sequence of syllable doors repeats some glosses (for example ṇa and na, ma and ya, e and o share the same door); these are given as the text has them.
• Tvarana is a Sanskrit word given in Tibetan letters for a class of water creature; I have not been able to identify it with certainty. "Making the yogic salutation with the whole body" renders the obscure phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□

read "nang par". "Great downfalls" reads "ltang chen" as "ltung chen". "The Lord of the World" translates 'jig rten dbang po literally; this may refer to Lokeśvara.

• The eight bodhisattvas appear only as abbreviations (sa, nam mkha', spyan, rdo rje, byams, rdo rje, kun bzang, dpal). They are read as Kṣitigarbha, Ākāśagarbha, Avalokiteśvara, Vajrapāṇi, Maitreya, Samantabhadra and Mañjuśrī. The second "rdo rje" is left as "Vajra" because the list does not name the eighth figure clearly.

• "Royal seal of light" reads □□□□□□□□ as written; it may be a scribal slip for □□□□□□□, "seal". "The ground of the thirteen" probably means the thirteenth ground, Vajradhara, in the Nyingma system.

• Several names in this passage cannot be identified with confidence and are translated by their meaning: the aeon All-Arrayed, the Buddha King of Manifest Arising (perhaps Abhyudgatarāja), the yogin Excellent Ornament, the monk Stainless Conduct, the yogin Bliss-Endowed Knower and the woman Excellent One. "Na Zhinépa" is given phonetically because its meaning is unclear. "Pramade" is transliterated as written. The line "One mind is drawn out by another" is obscure.

• The persons in these stories cannot be identified. Their names are translated by meaning: Giver of Bliss, Pure Intellect, Fearless Intellect, King Holder of Great Clarity, Radiant, Loving One, King of Virtue and Jewel Radiance. "Penaya" is transliterated as written. "The abode of the Thirty-Three gods" translates lha gnas gsum, read as the Trāyastriṃśa heaven.

• □□□□□□□□□□ here is read as "those who actually practice" (the king of the following story) rather than "fierce rite," since the story contrasts the practitioner with the one who rejoices in his practice. The brahmin names Kunri and Kaini appear to be sound-spellings and are given phonetically; Virtuous Disciple, Luminous Gift, Virtuous and Luminous are literal renderings of names not confidently identified. Kalyana is given as spelled.

• The phrase rendered "the armored ranks of emanations in equal troops" (sprul pa'i go tshags ru mnyam) and "the great hunting drive of saṃsāra" (skyas lings) are obscure; the renderings are tentative. "Rites of fulfillment" translates skong, the ritual mending or restoration of commitments.

• Several lines are obscure, notably "whatever has come upon the turtle's head" and the opening "articles that have come from them" (apparently referring to the Lesser Vehicle people just mentioned); these are rendered literally. "The wheel of the seasons" renders dus kyi 'khor lo, read here as the cycle of periodic offerings rather than the Kālacakra Tantra. The figures for the recitation counts follow a consistent pattern (530,000; 53,000; 5,300; 530) and are read accordingly.

• The count for the incidental breach, "fifteen, one and three," is given as written; the pattern of the preceding counts (530,000; 53,000; 5,300; 530) might suggest fifty-three. "Supreme bliss" (bde mchog) is taken here as a descriptive term rather than the deity Cakrasaṃvara. The similes "as the moon is hidden by a mountain" and "as a sword's edge is blunted" interpret terse and difficult lines.

• 'phral ba, in the line on the sign before the desire-family rite, is read as dpral ba, "forehead," since the hand signs follow parts of the body (heart, forehead, tongue, body); this is the evident reading. In the list of the five families only vajra, jewel, lotus and action are named, the first presumably understood.

• "Birthplace of punishment" reads □□□□ in the first question, evidently for □□□□ "penalty, punishment," as the text itself writes it in what follows. "The condition of the rite" (□□□□□□□□□□□□) most likely refers to the restoring rites of purification and fulfillment just described, though it could also be read as "a karmic condition." "Continuum of great wisdom" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, which could also be taken as "the tantra of great wisdom." The final verses are spoken by the vidyādharas collectively; the first-person singular follows the Tibetan.

• Several phrases in the confession verses are obscure: □□□□□□□□ ("watch over") and □□□□□□□□ ("swore to keep") are taken in their likely senses, and □□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□□, "having said this." The line □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as the speakers' description of themselves; it could instead address the deity as "Vajra Skull-Bearer, compassionate heir." "Loving protector" (□□□□□□□□□) is read as an epithet of the Sugata addressed, not as Maitreya. The sattva Vajragarbha (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) may be the interlocutor otherwise called Sattvavajra.
• The five consorts are named with the Dhātvīśvarī pattern (Ākāśa-, Karma-, Dharma-, Ratna- and Vajradhātvīśvarī), reconstructed from the Tibetan "Lady of the Expanse of" space, action, dharma, jewel and vajra. In the earth section the text plays on □ as both "earth" (the last element of the sequence space, wind, fire, water) and "ground" (the ten grounds); "grounds" is used throughout. "Taming on the nine grounds" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is obscure. "Four gatekeepers" reads □□□□□□□□ as □□□□□□□□□. "Upaya" is the class of tantra between Kriyā and Yoga (often Ubhaya or Caryā).
• "Ten sorceresses brandishing staffs" reads □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ as □□□□□□□□□□□, matching the parallel phrases. "Swift-goers" translates □□□□□□□□□, a class of goddess not identified with confidence. "Liberation" (□□□□□□□) is the tantric term for liberating beings through wrathful means.
• "Fields" (□□□) in the first verse is the technical term for beings who are proper objects of wrathful liberation. "Bhandha" (the Sanskrit word as spelled in the Tibetan) here denotes the skull or cranium of the corpse. "Before the men's hands have lost their warmth" is a tentative reading of □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□; the sense is "in no time at all."
• This section describes the classical types of women (lotus, conch, elephant, marked) as consorts for the practice of union; several physiognomic terms are rare and their renderings are tentative, in particular "sog ka" (taken as shoulders), "kos ko" (taken as cheeks), "rlung kar lci" (rendered "its breath heavy"), "gel bag" (crooked manner) and "rtsid mgo" (coarse-haired head). "The woman with markings" (ri mo can) and "the elephant woman" (ban glang) likely correspond to the Citriṇī and Hastinī types, and "the lotus woman" and "the conch woman" to Padminī and Śaṅkhinī, but I have translated the Tibetan descriptively. "Twelve, twenty-five" is probably an age reference; "mula rakta" (root blood) is left as written. "Sattvavajra" here and "the sattva Vajragarbha" in the same passage appear to refer to the same speaker.
• "There is no dread of transference and change" renders the line ending □□□□□□, which is a syllable short and unclear as written; I have read it as □□□□□□□□ "without dread", which fits the verse's pattern of negations. The coded words exchanged in the rite of drawing in are kept as written. "Union and liberation" (sbyor sgrol) are the tantric practices of sexual union and ritual "liberation". The swaying profusion of offerings (ling long) is a tentative rendering.
• "The sublime nine openings" renders dgu lung, which is obscure; "nine openings" (the bodily orifices) is a tentative reading. "Charnel-ground beasts" renders dur gcan, and "desolate gorge" renders ngam grog bshung; both are tentative. The "Loving One" (byams ldan) is kept as earlier in the text.
• Several lines are compressed and their renderings tentative: "sacred essences that liberate" (bcu dam thar pa), "skull cups together with braided locks" (ka pā la dang lcang lor bcas), "cutting the trajectory with waves of qualities", "the great secret time of the corpse" (bam chen), and the line about the fox (wa), whose image of driving off impure provisions with the fox's cry or whistle is uncertain. Kokila is kept as the name of a musical instrument. "Great sovereign lord" renders dbang phyug che, said here of one's own nature.
• The goddess addressed as the one who "knows and bears witness" appears to be the earth goddess, invoked as witness when the site is claimed. "Lcepok" is an unidentified plant used for fumigation. The intruding spirits and samaya-breaking sri demons render 'jug srid and dam sri;

the phramen are the animal-headed female attendants of the charnel-ground maṇḍala. "Matraṃ" is the name of the demon Rudra in Nyingma myth. Several descriptive lines (the "five tastes", the pastes "in the manner of the wisdom mother's flowing") are tentative.

• The line "a yaṃ ja laṃ khaṃ" ends with the Tibetan word lhan, read here as "together"; it may instead be part of the seed-syllable run. The phrase dri chen in "drive off the strong odor of the various burnt offerings" is taken in its sense of "strong smell" (of the sur offerings) rather than the ritual sense "excrement," which does not fit the construction. "The Great Glorious Invincible One" (dpal chen mi pham) is an epithet that could not be identified with confidence as a specific Sanskrit name and is translated literally. "Yal dam" in the vajra pledge line is obscure; rendered by context as "pledge."

• "Bearing of a heroine" renders sems ma, whose exact sense here is not certain. The line about drawing the cord against "bhūtas and vile beings" is grammatically loose in the Tibetan; it is read as the protective boundary set against obstructing spirits. "Disruptions" renders 'drul, possibly for 'khrul.

• Kacali is kept as written; it appears to be a material (perhaps a kind of cloth) on which the deities are drawn. "Sixty-four" reads rtsa zhi as rtsa bzhi. "Melody of Vajra Ash" is a literal rendering of a name that could not be identified with a Sanskrit form. The lines on the seat ("the long human substance of a person," "the pipar cushion") are obscure and rendered literally.

• "Blood Snatcher" renders the name khrag 'phrog ma literally; it could not be identified with confidence. Kāśyapa of the Matted Locks renders 'od srung ral pa can. The line "with practices of abstaining from passion" reads chags pa'i spyod pa in context as ascetic restraint; it may simply mean "passionate conduct." "Empty in seven ways" is literal; the seven are not specified.

• "Is a load carried as a burden" renders khur du bshal ba'i gdos, whose exact sense is unclear. "A great food of rank stench" renders dku ba'i rngad zas, also uncertain. "The great predators that haunt the toll gates" renders sho gam gnas kyi gcan chen, a class of spirits not identified with confidence.

• Several ritual terms are obscure and rendered literally: "the great crystal, the tsara" (shel chen tsa ra), "the manner of drawing forth" ('jo tshul, possibly a manner of gait), "the vajra rites of bra", "great majesty" (tsham ngam chen po), and "the gaping maw" (kha long kha). "The one with vajra breath", "rolled pellet" (sgril ma) and "a span in size" (mtshon gang / tshon gang) follow the most likely readings. The passage describes a liberation rite and the subsequent examination of signs on the effigy or remains; the speaker of the lines about "me, the lord of desire" is taken as the narrator of the dialogue.

• This passage lists the types and signs of skull cups used in practice. The Sanskrit-looking type names (paṃcakula, naśa, mahākesa, āyuḥphala, mele debyi, khasvakha, khahupa, jñānamurtti, jñānakuṇḍali, kuṇḍali, ekajaṭi, abimuka, putra) are given as spelled; several are not securely identifiable. "Fulfills all hopes" reads skor as skong. The line "increase of the white with its accompaniments, and the head not appearing" (bcas dkar 'phel dang mgo mi 'byung) is obscure. "Slender Sapling" (lcug phran) is kept as in earlier pieces, though here it may simply name a skull type.

• Several terms of the maṇḍala construction are obscure: "compartments" (le tshe), "eight facing inward on the spokes" (reading rtsi bsal as rtsibs), and "the white and the red in union". "The mighty crescent moons" renders dbang chen zla gam. "The vajra song of changing calls" renders the obscure khyud skad. The line on the nine expanses of a single bhaga and "nine closed, one opened" is cryptic and rendered literally. "Armies" reads dbung as dpung.

• Several terms are obscure and rendered literally or left as spelled: "the yatha" (ya tha), "lastly the servants" (tha ma bran), "the tsara of liberation" (thar pa tsa ra), "śi ne da hu", "beyond the hu and below" ('da' hu man 'das), "black tongue incense" (lce pog nag po), "Viṣṇu

amulet box", and "bra" (also met in the earlier "vajra rites of bra"). "Divination" renders pra, as in the "vajra diviner" (rdo rje pra mkhan), i.e. prasena-type divination.

• "The lesser supreme" (mchog phran) in the seventeenth chapter title is uncertain. "Mouth divination" renders kha pra. "Mere trifling causes and conditions" renders gyin da tsam, which is obscure. The asura figure is called the Gaṇapati (tshogs bdag) of the asuras, named Sgyu ma mkhan, rendered as Māyākāra; he is then addressed as "Great Gaṇapati". "The sky offering" reads hom as homa. "Thirteen measures" supplies an unstated unit.

• Several ritual lines in chapter twenty are obscure and rendered literally: "make the charnel ground with a head as well" (dur khrod mgo ma yang du bya), "from the four, those four are praised in turn" (bzhi las de bzhis chag res bstod), "ramparts, dry and moist" (skam dang ra ri rlon pas, ra ri read as an enclosing ridge), and "coils of guggulu and latticework, corpses" (gu gu thul dang za ra tshags, zhing; gu gu read as guggulu, zhing as the tantric term for a corpse). "Spaces between the spokes" reads rtsibs mchan as rtsibs mtshams. "Emissaries" renders phyag brnyan (servants, attendants). "Mātaṅga" renders ma tang, an outcaste figure.

• "Lakchuhwa" (lag chu hwa) is unidentified, apparently a kind of fire or a fiery substance, and is kept in phonetics. "Half-sized platforms" renders the obscure chag phyed. In the "six" and "eight" of Matraṃ's body, mtshan is read as the genitals (four limbs, head and genitals make six; with the two secret openings, eight). The final verses of the piece continue into the next passage.

• Several of the medicinal ingredients are uncertain: "fragrant kha" (kha dri zhim), "white chebok" (lce bog dkar) and "ligadur" (li ga dur) are not securely identified and are given literally or in phonetics. "Myrobalan" renders a ru ra (harītakī); "turuṣka" renders du ru ska. "Bring down and invite" (dbab cing drang) takes the vidyādharas as invoked beings. "Bathing and confession" reads deng as dang.

• "Nectar paste" renders skyo ma (a thick liquid preparation) and "nectar dough" renders lde gu. "King of medicines, or something close to it" reads ram nye ba as the particle "or" plus "close"; it could instead name an unidentified plant. "Keep apart for a year" renders the obscure lo yis bshugs te. "The five glorious auspicious ones" is given literally; their identity is not specified.

• "A year's span" renders lo yi skad cig, literally "a year-instant," apparently a measured period of practice. "Dissolved into oneself" reads rang nyid sa as rang nyid la. "Five aggregates" reads lung bo as phung po. The colophon here calls the work a "tantra" (rgyud) rather than a "sūtra." The line "holding the limit of purity, holding the supreme" (dag pa'i mtha' 'dzin nyes mchog 'dzin) is obscure and rendered tentatively.

• "Stakes" renders □□□□□□□, here evidently the posts or sticks on which the cloths bearing heart mantras are hung. □□□, rendered "tallies," is uncertain; the context suggests the official who keeps count of the ritual actions with tablets (white for the 108 activities, black for the deceased's evil deeds, which are burned). "The White One" (□□□□□□) refers back to Pāṇḍaravāsinī.

• In the chapter on mudrās, A and MA appear to stand for the two hands (means and wisdom), and their "ten seeds" for the ten fingers. "The heavy bird" renders □□□□□□□, a bird I cannot identify with confidence; the name is translated literally. The line "This is the cause of becoming the essence" follows the text's □□□□ "cause"; it may be a slip for □□□ "seal," which the parallel lines use.

• Several terms in the chapter on vajra song are technical names for vocal techniques and melodies in Tibetan chant that I cannot securely identify; they are given in phonetics: tenkö (□□□□□□□□□□), jimgö (□□□□□□□□□), birkwa (□□□□□□□□), drenkö (□□□□□□□□□□), and the six songs Shatapa, Gartapa, Changkadeu, Bangkadeu, Drengngewa and Dungngewa. "The drawn-out tone" and "the white tone" render □□□□□ and □□□, likewise uncertain. "Offering of the feast" renders □□□□□□□, a doubtful expression. "Rouses the elements of the corpse" could also mean

"rouses the elements of taste" (□□); the funerary context of the preceding chapters favors "corpse". "Full moon" and maṃsa "meat" are coded names of the sacramental substances.
• "At the times of practice" reads □□□□□□□ "application" for the text's □□□□□□ "losing," which does not fit. "The mudrās of the śrīvatsa" reads □□□□ for the text's □□□, which yields no clear sense here; this is conjectural. hasta "hand" and bhandha "skull cup" are among the goddesses' implements; "great fields" (□□□□□□□) is a tantric code term for human flesh or corpses. The line "One abides at the stage of urging the Victors" takes the obscure □□□□ as "abide" from context.
• □□□□□□□□ is rendered "supreme bliss" rather than as the name Cakrasaṃvara, since in this Nyingma context it qualifies the pleasure grove and the buddhas generally. ba in "the wisdom of ba" is read as a seed syllable; the line is obscure. "Thumbs" renders □□□□, here evidently a finger. "Vajra So-and-so" renders □□□□□□□□, the placeholder for the secret name given to the initiate.
• Here □□□□□□□□ is read as "supreme bliss," a quality of the yoga and of compassion, not the deity Cakrasaṃvara. □□□□□□□ ("great field") is taken in its tantric sense of human corpses forming part of the throne. □□□□□ in "staffs of stira" is unidentified (possibly Sanskrit sthira, "firm"); it is kept as a sound. □□□□ is taken as the curved knife (kartari). "The great red" (□□□□□□□) is the tantric substance of blood (rakta).
• □□□□□□□□ is uncertain; it is rendered "royal seal," though it may be a slip for □□□□□□□, "regent," which appears earlier in this rite. "Cuts the blindfold cloth" takes □□□□□□□ as the ritual removal of the blindfold during the empowerment. □□□□□□□□ is read as "supreme bliss," an epithet of the one praised, not the deity Cakrasaṃvara. The subject of "having understood" is taken to be the assembly, marked by the instrumental.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.